

(19) **United States**

(12) **Patent Application Publication**

Ferone

(10) **Pub. No.: US 2024/0112227 A1**

(43) **Pub. Date: Apr. 4, 2024**

(54) **VEHICLE CARBON USE LIMITATION**

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(21) Appl. No.: **17/957,485**

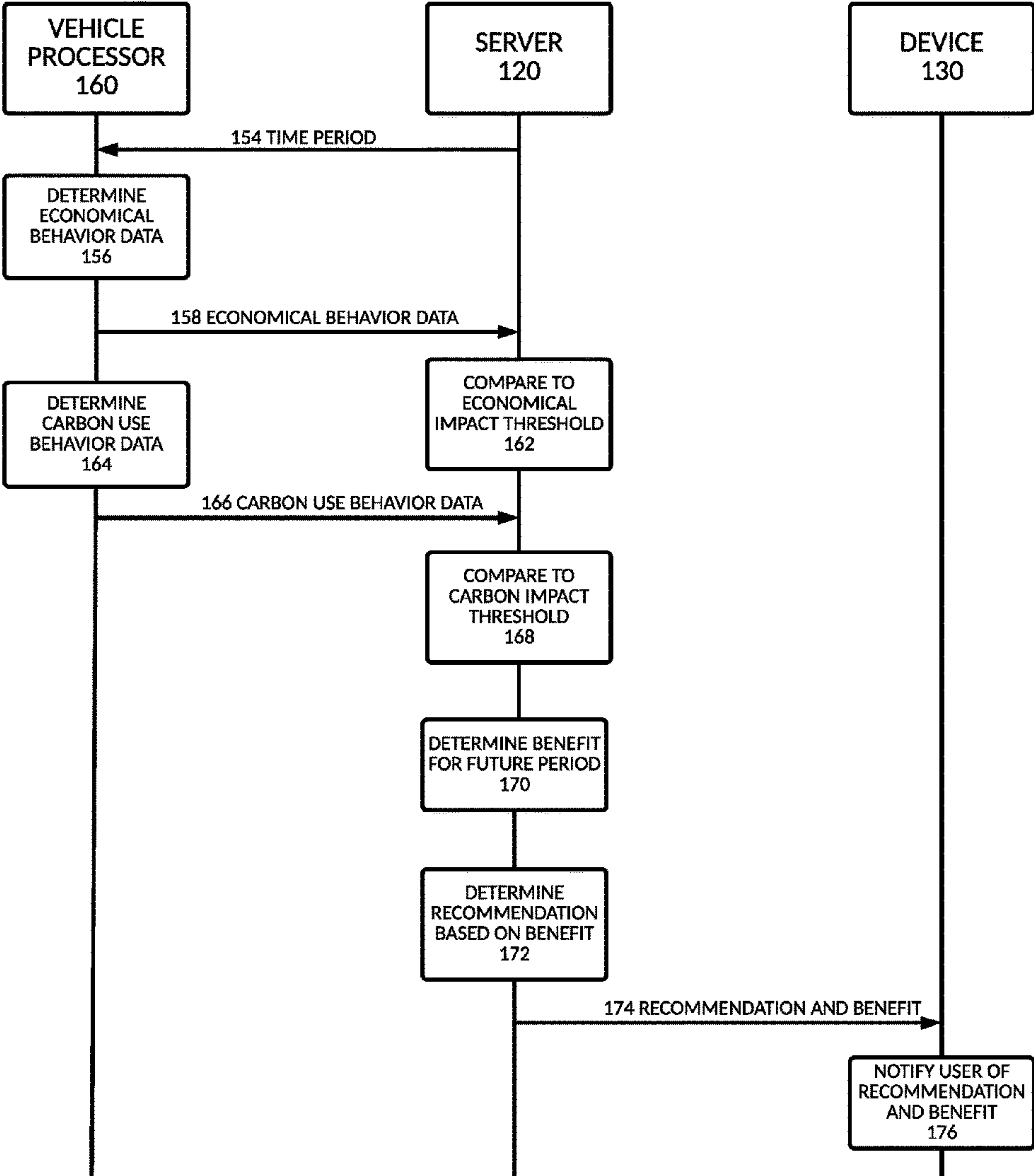
(22) Filed: **Sep. 30, 2022**

(51) **Int. Cl.**
G06Q 30/02 (2006.01)
G06Q 30/00 (2006.01)

(52) **U.S. Cl.**
CPC **G06Q 30/0282** (2013.01); **G06Q 30/018** (2013.01)

(57) **ABSTRACT**
An example operation includes one or more of determining an economical impact and a carbon impact based on a use of a vehicle over a period, determining a benefit received in a future period similar to the period of one or more of altering the use of the vehicle and using another vehicle, where the other vehicle uses less carbon, determining a recommendation, based on the benefit, and notifying a device associated with the vehicle, of the recommendation and the benefit.

150



100

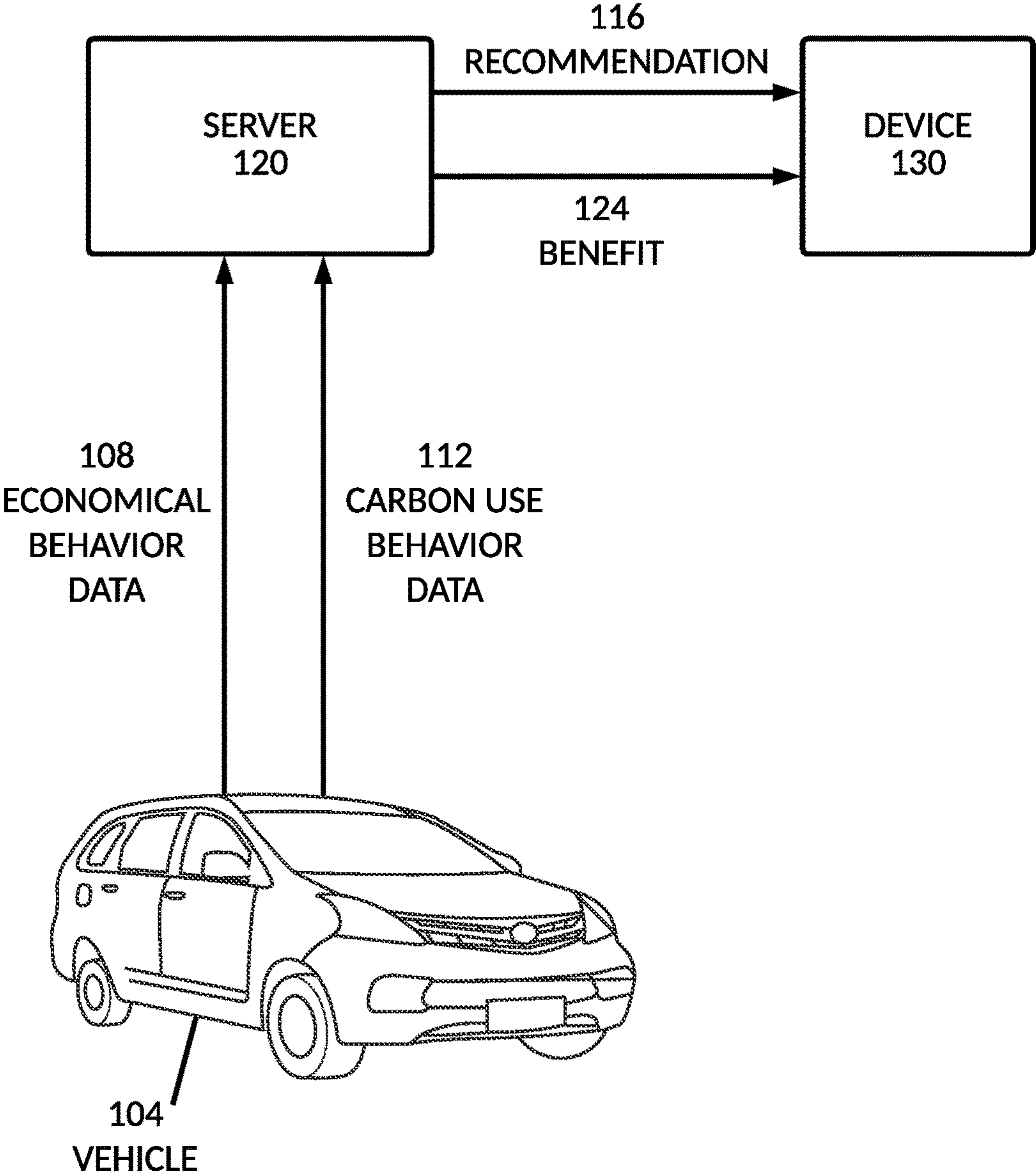


FIG. 1A

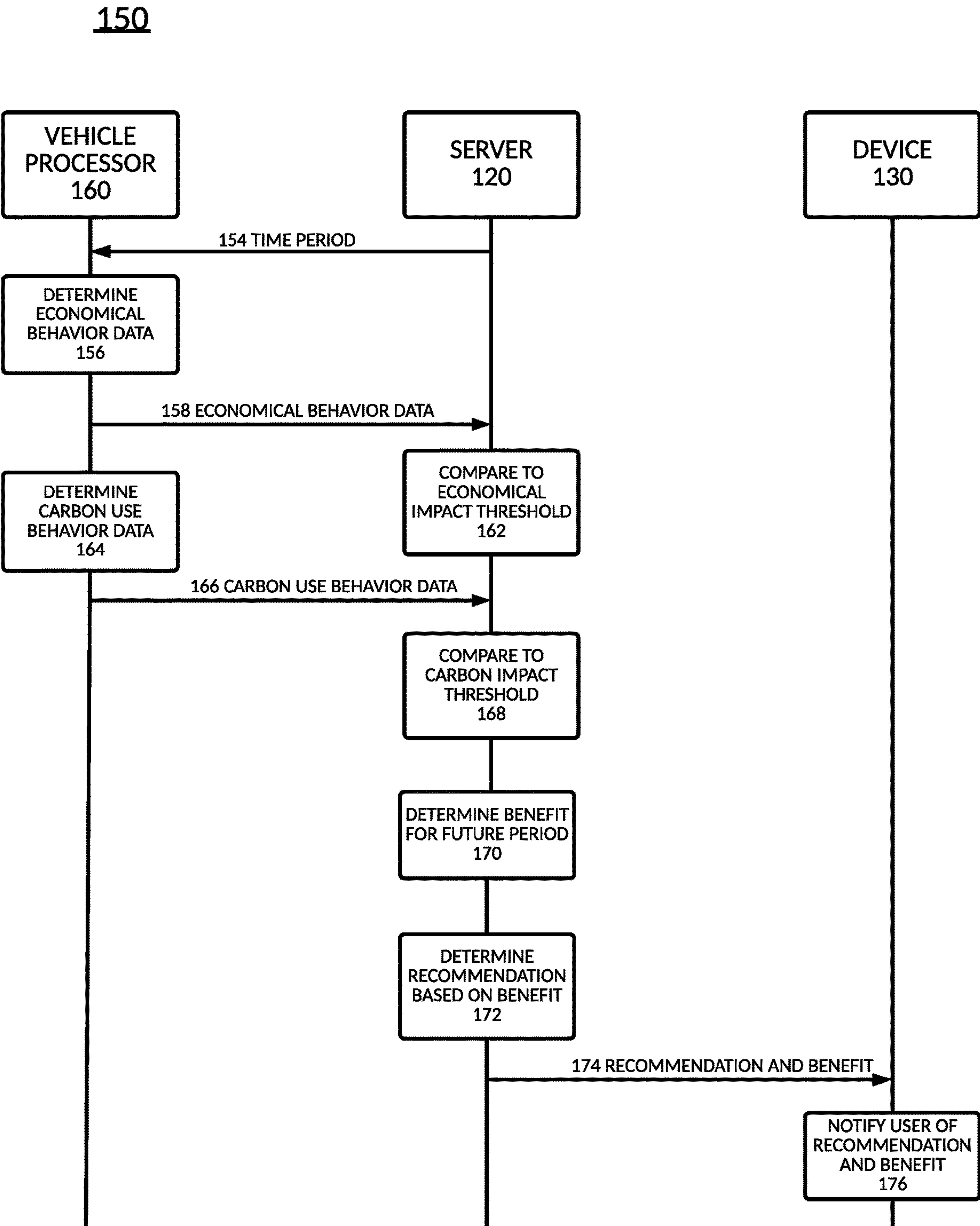


FIG. 1B

200

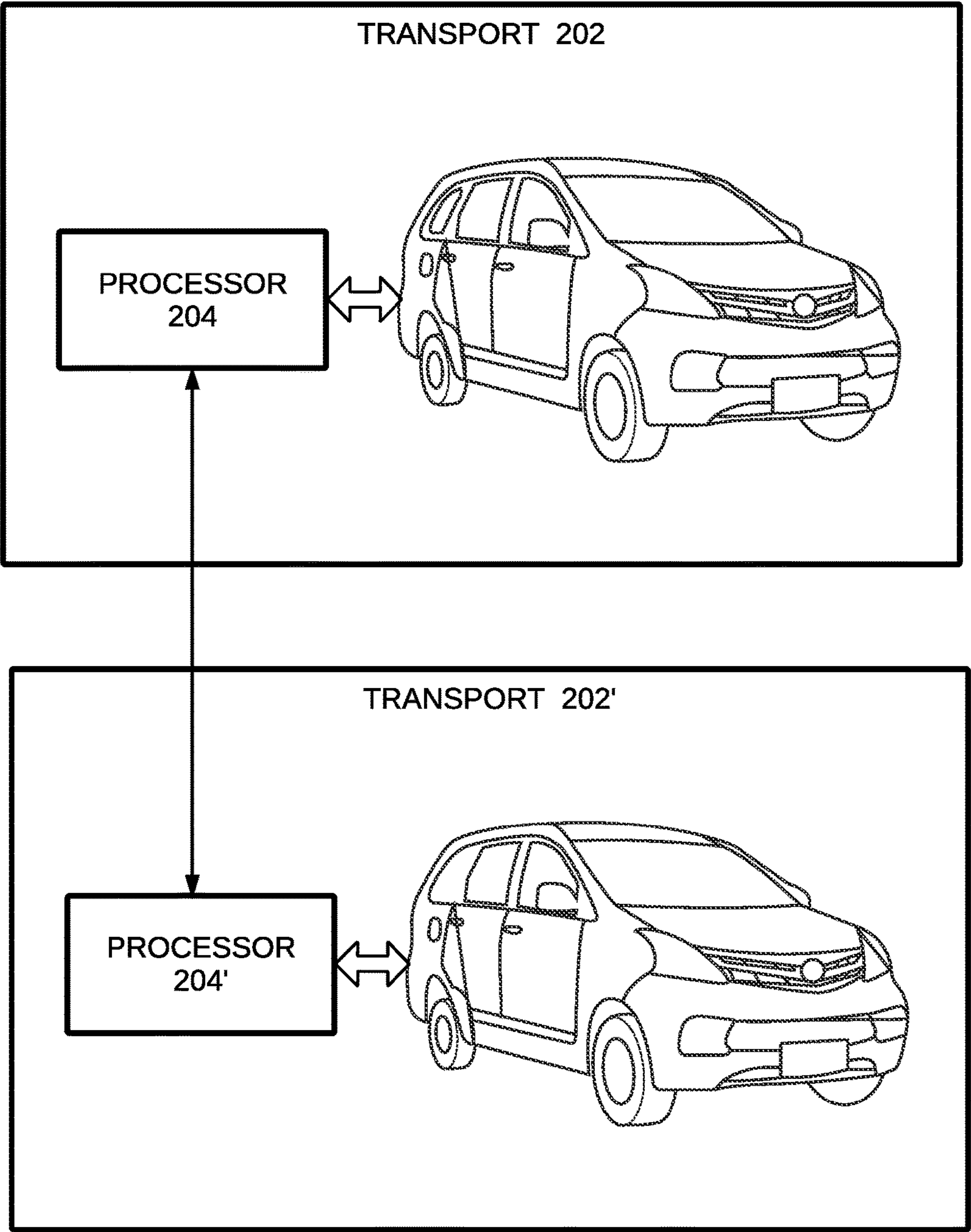


FIG. 2A

210

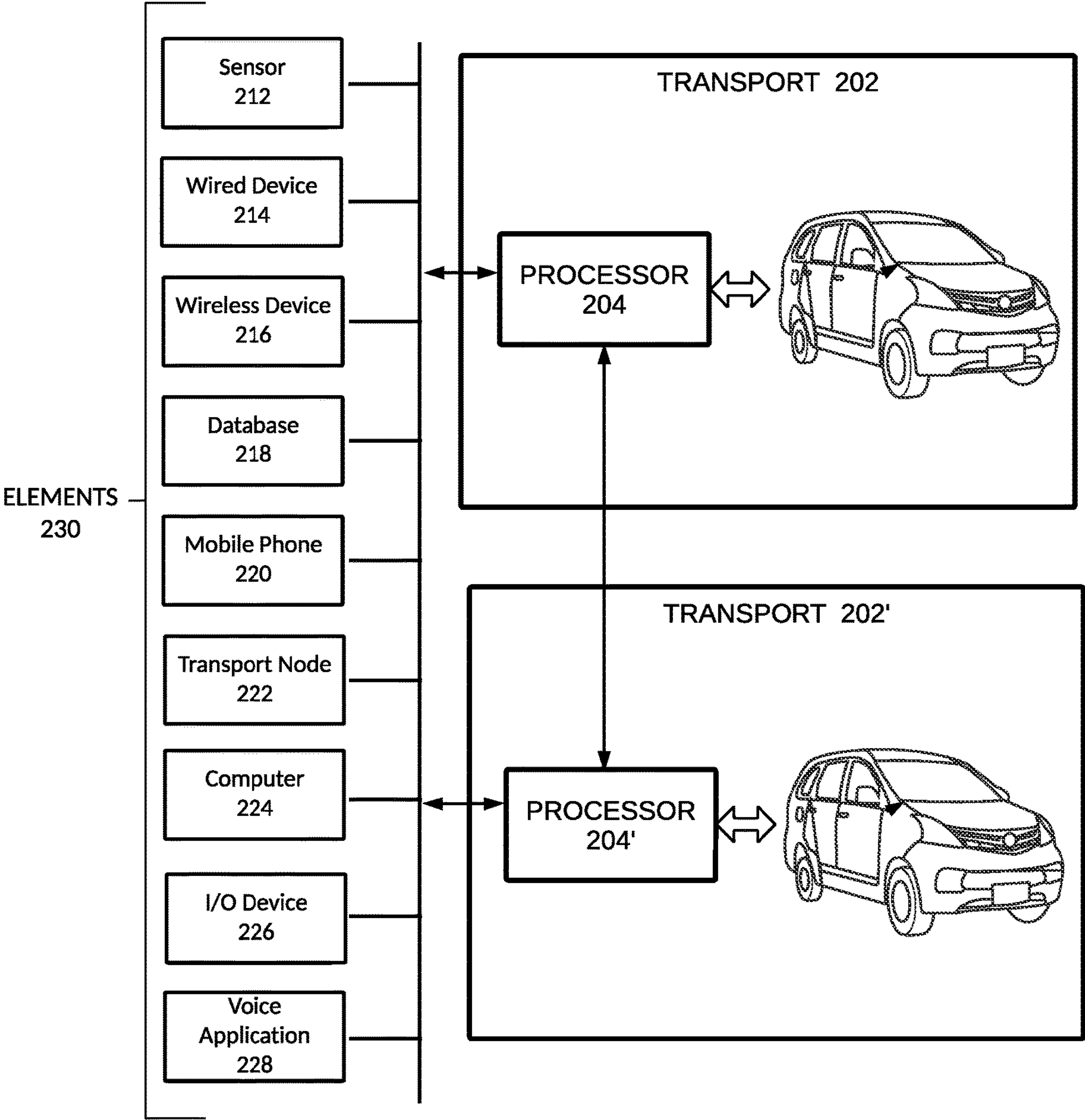


FIG. 2B

240

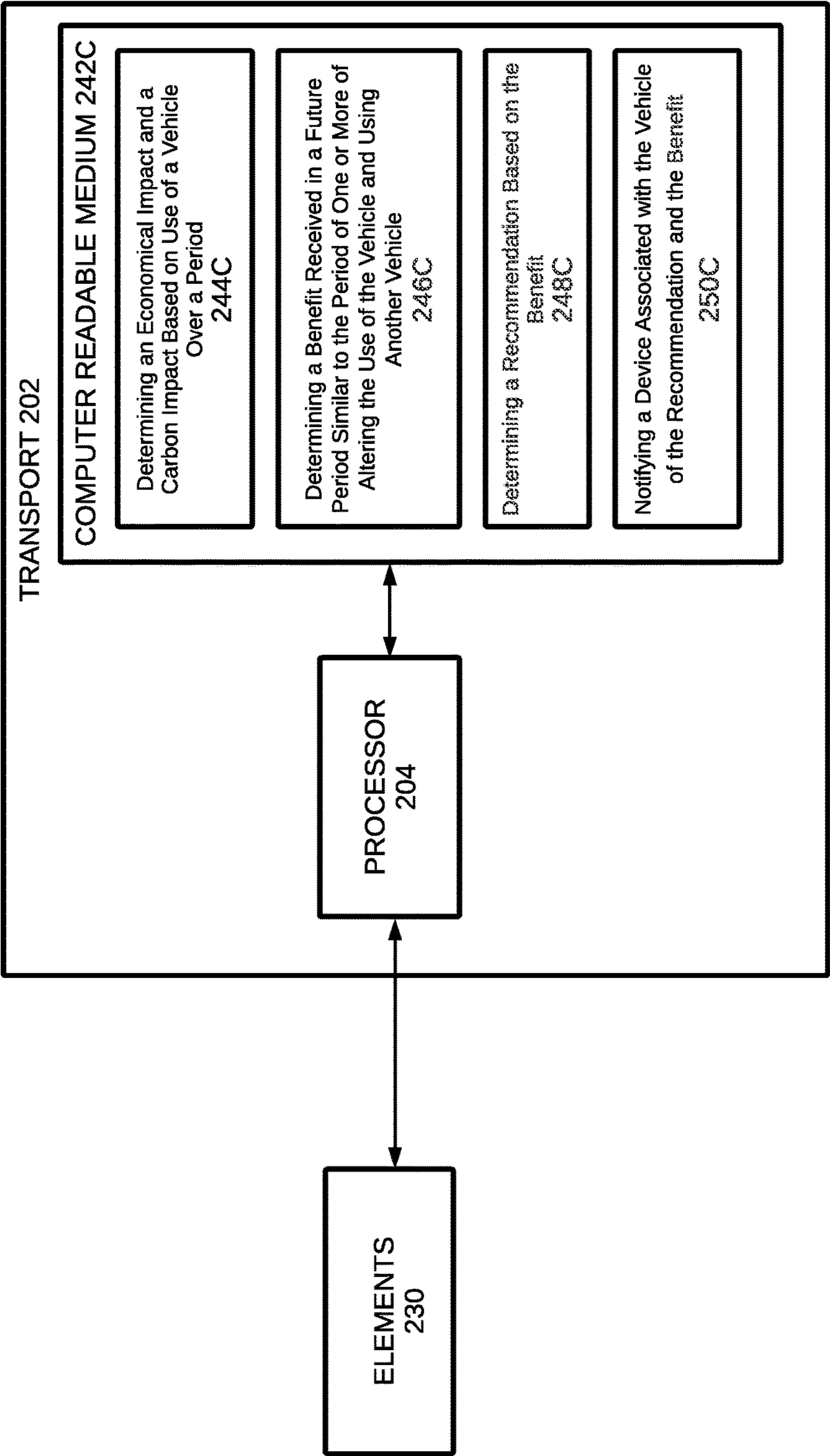


FIG. 2C

250

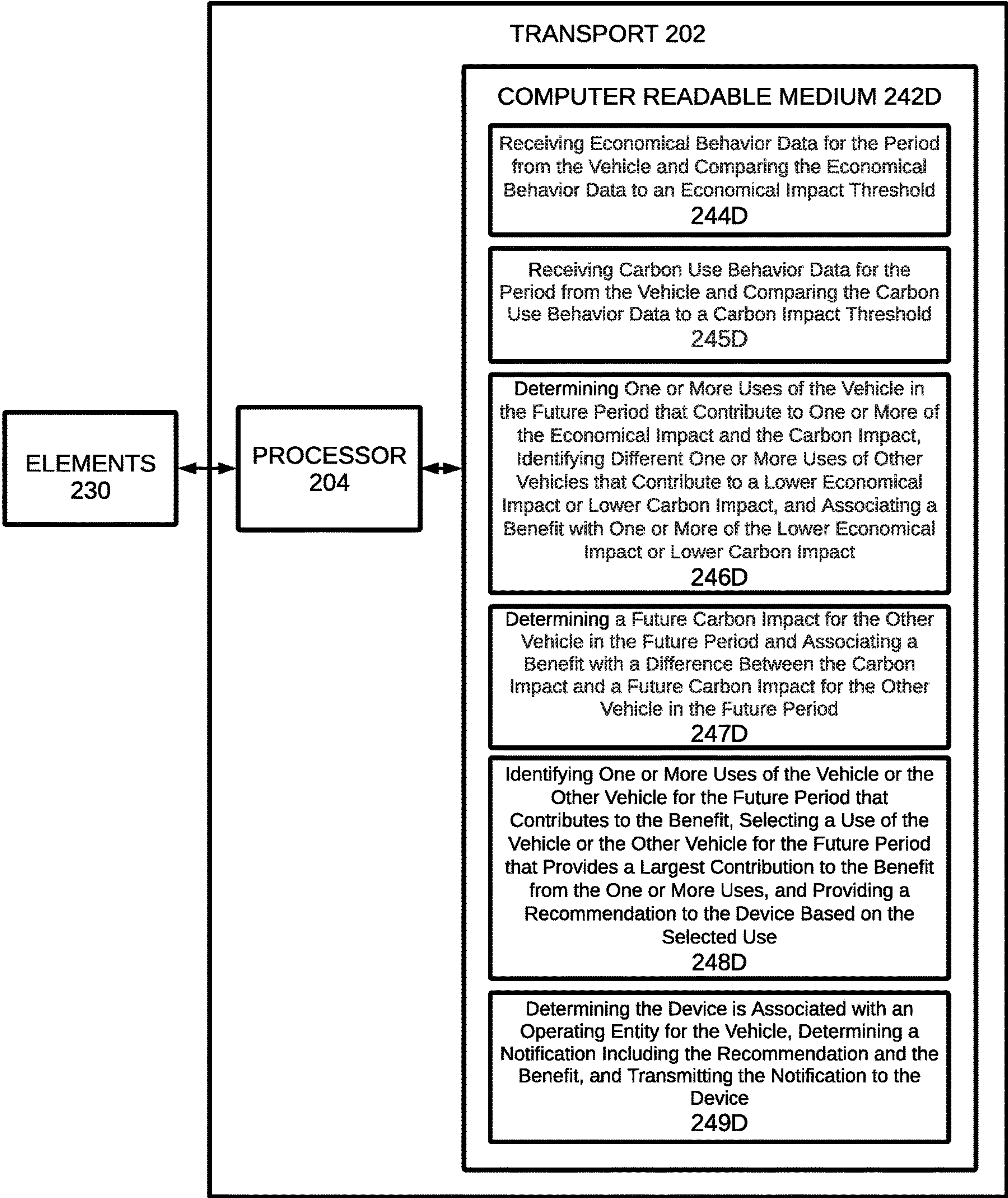


FIG. 2D

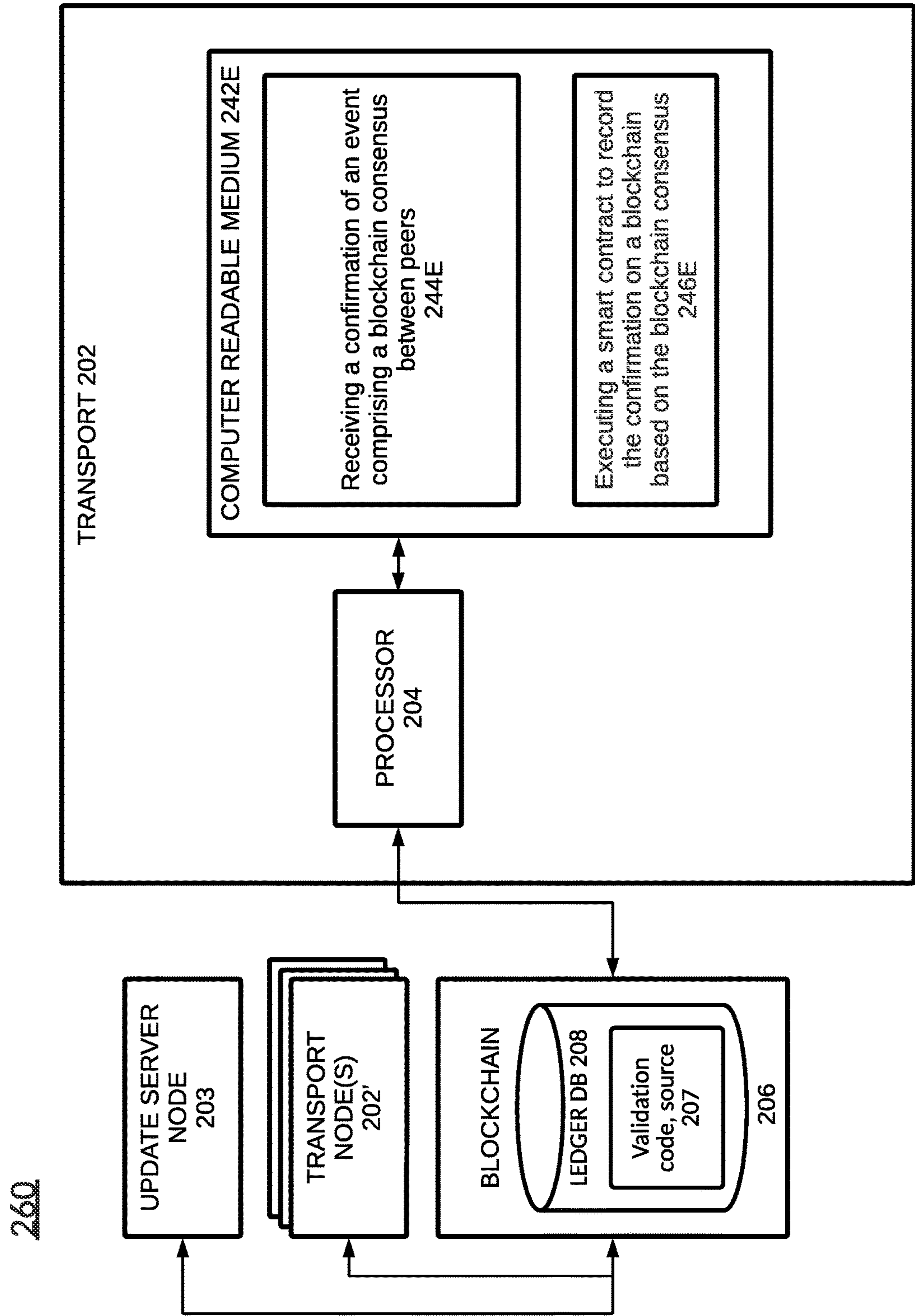


FIG. 2E

265

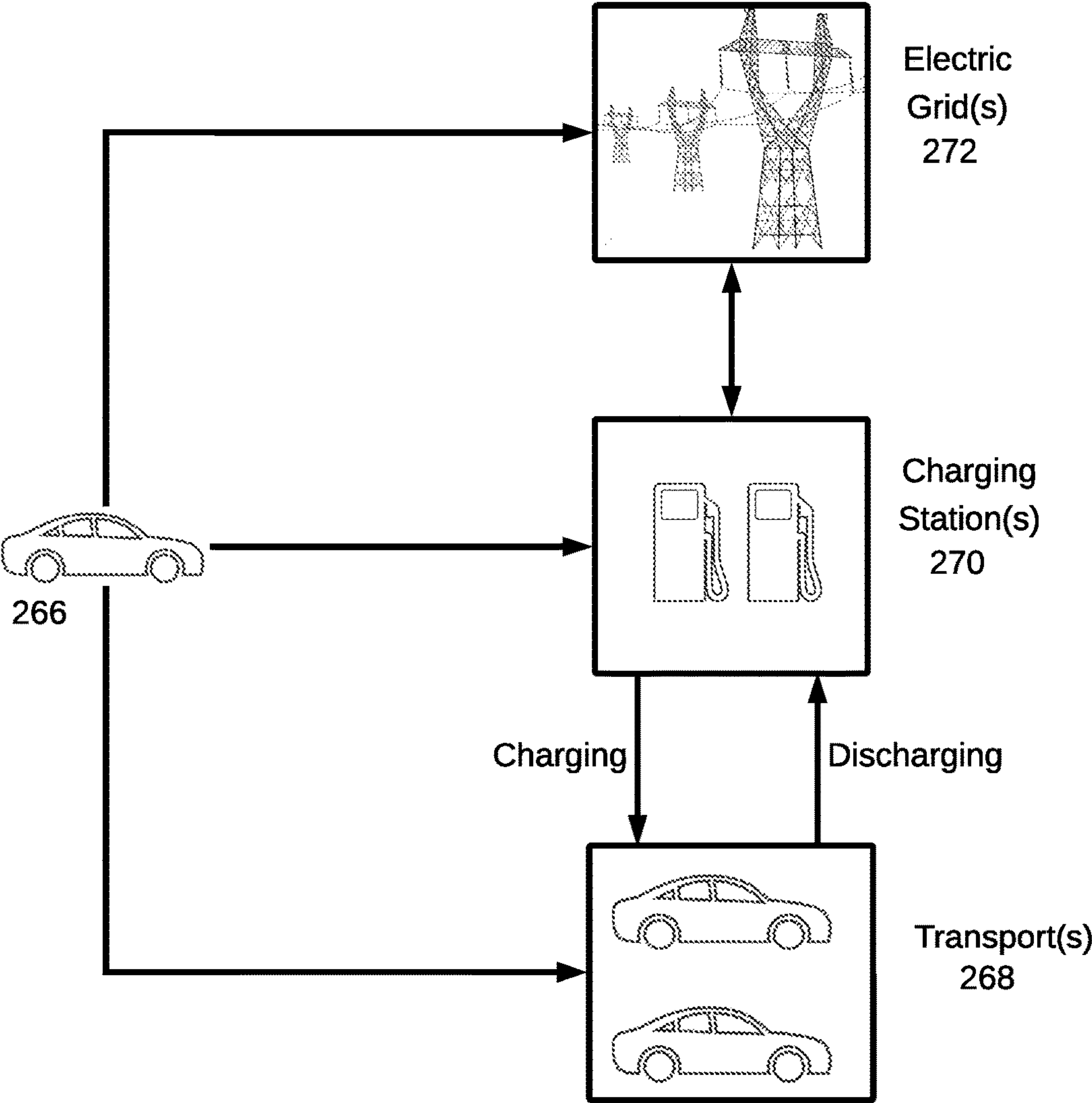


FIG. 2F

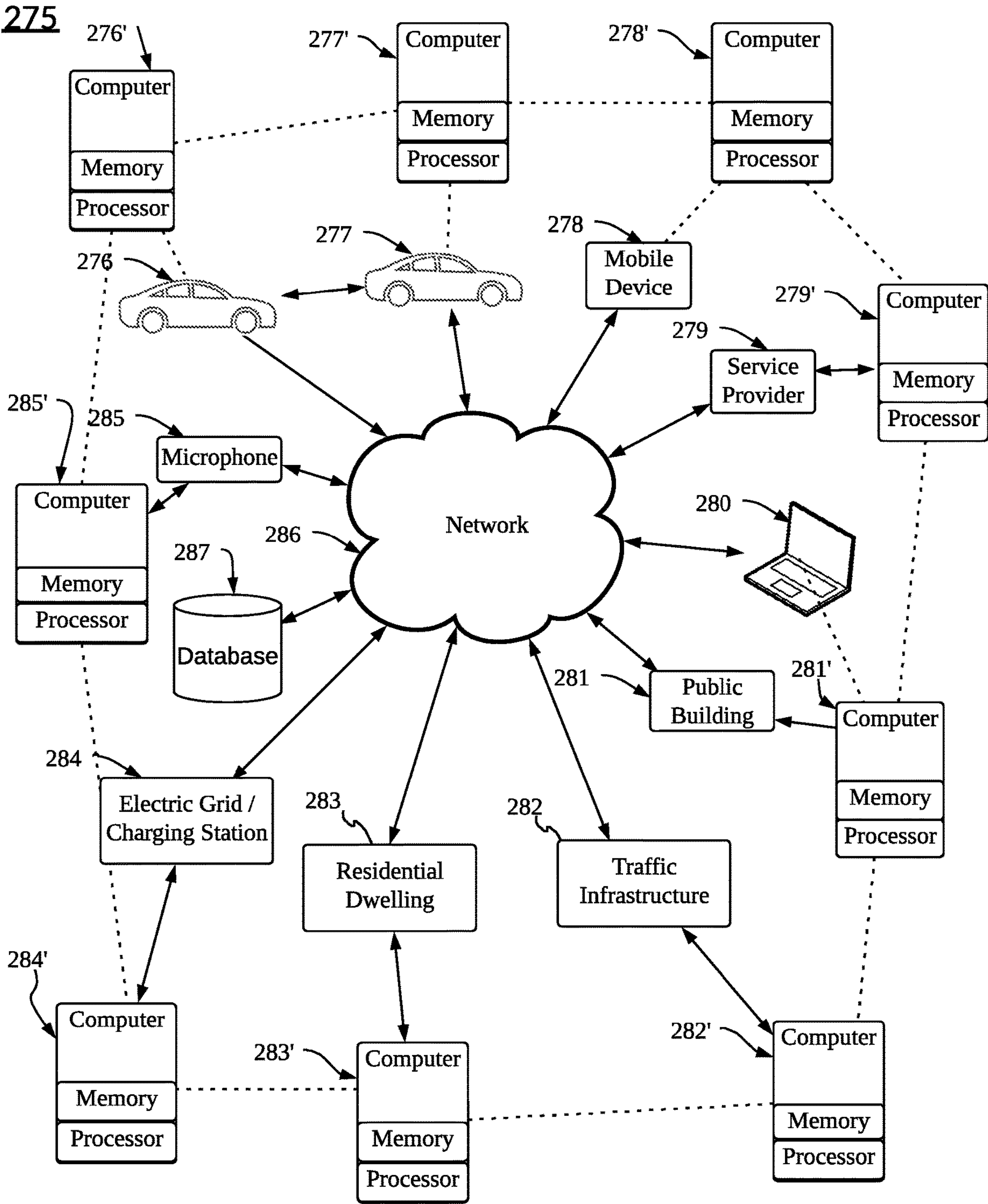


FIG. 2G

290

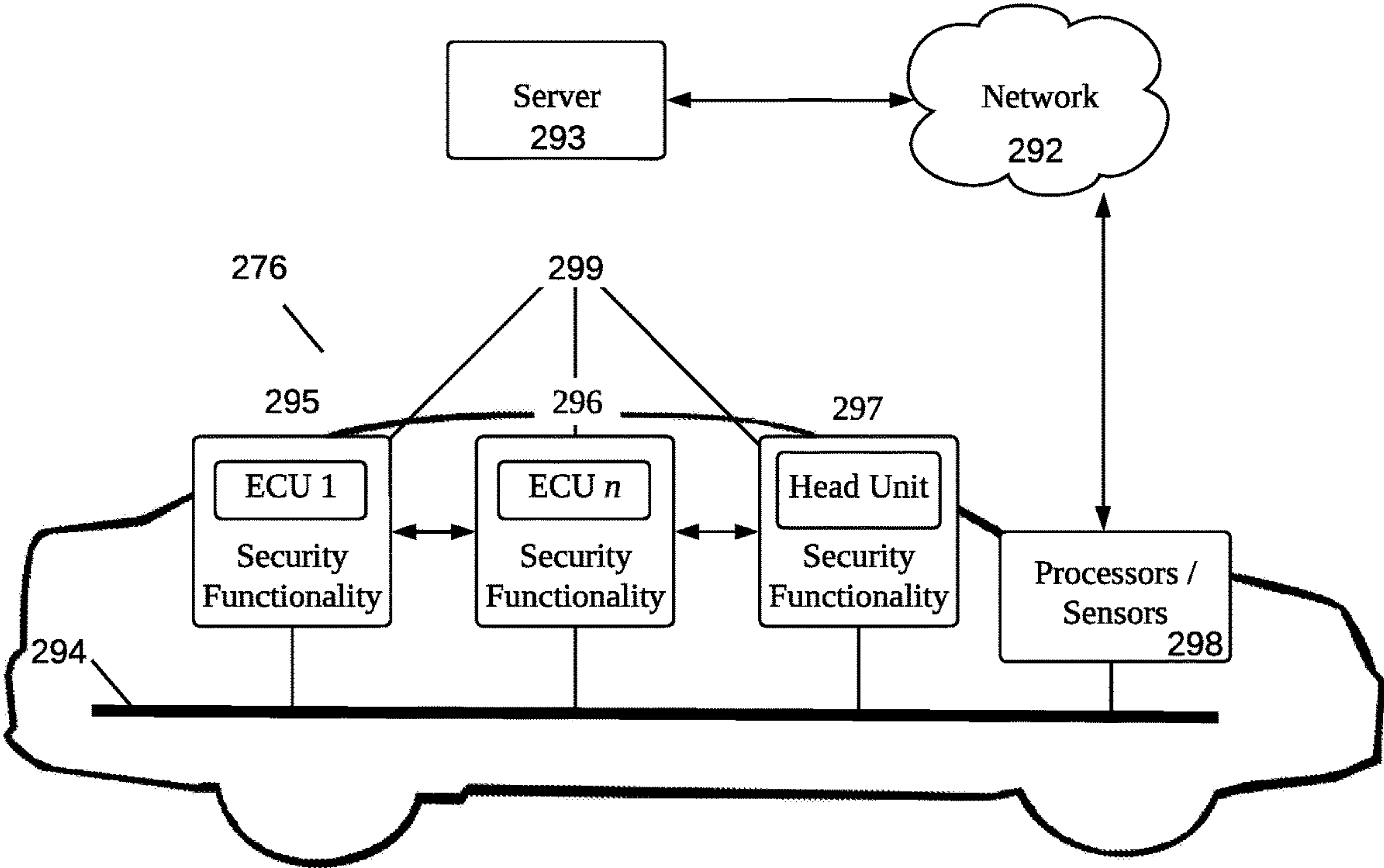


FIG. 2H

290A

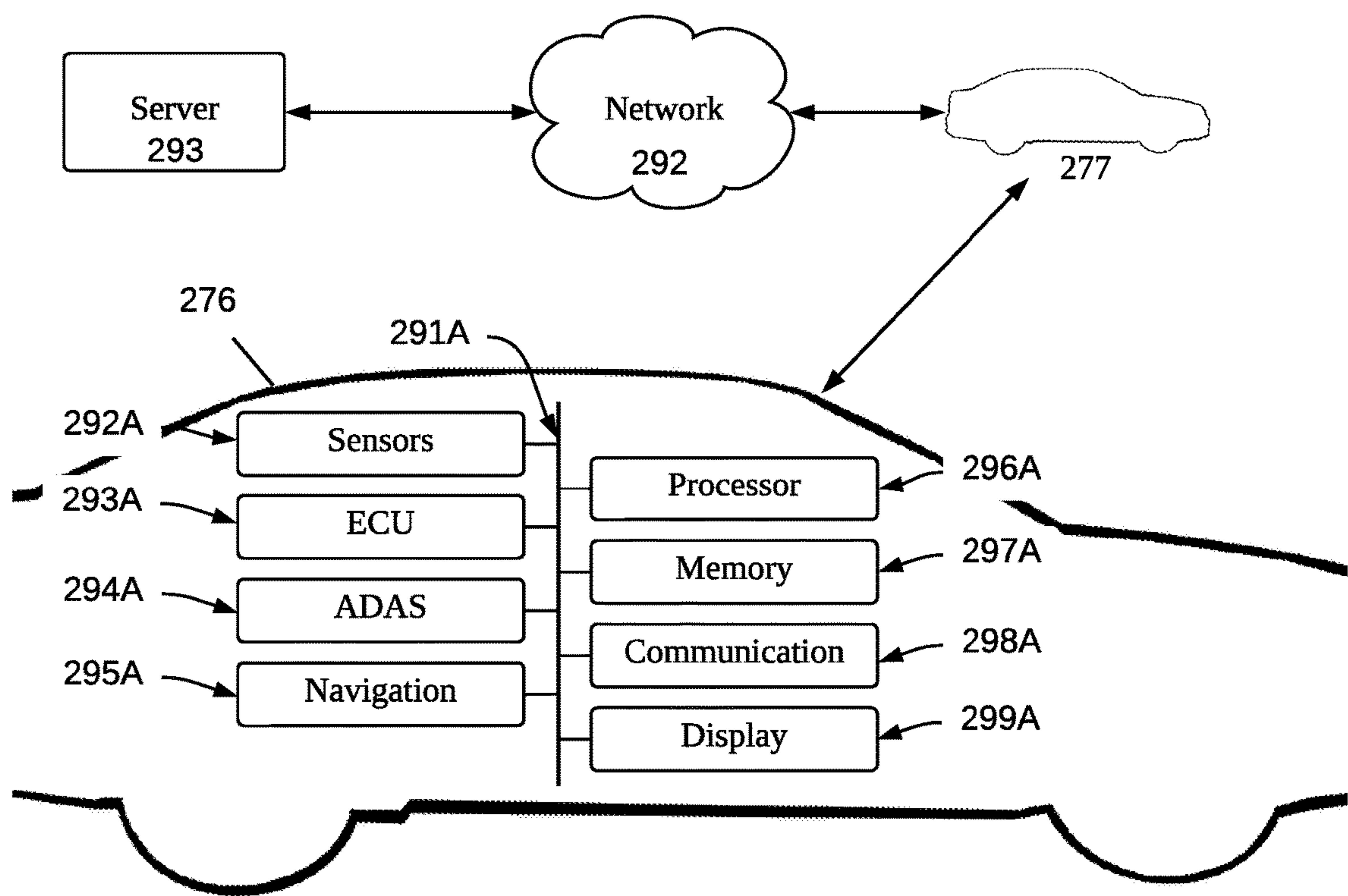


FIG. 2I

290B

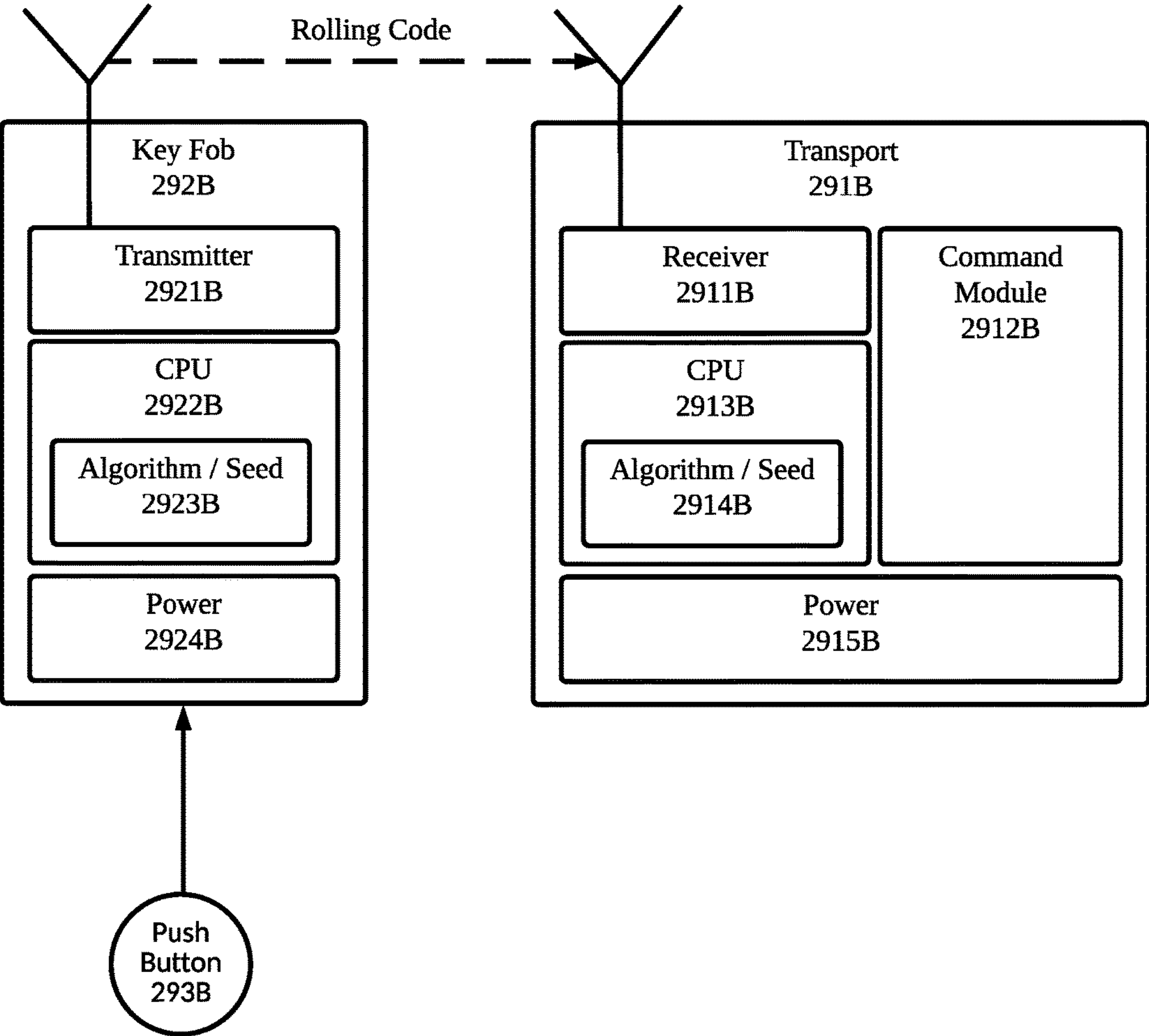


FIG. 2J

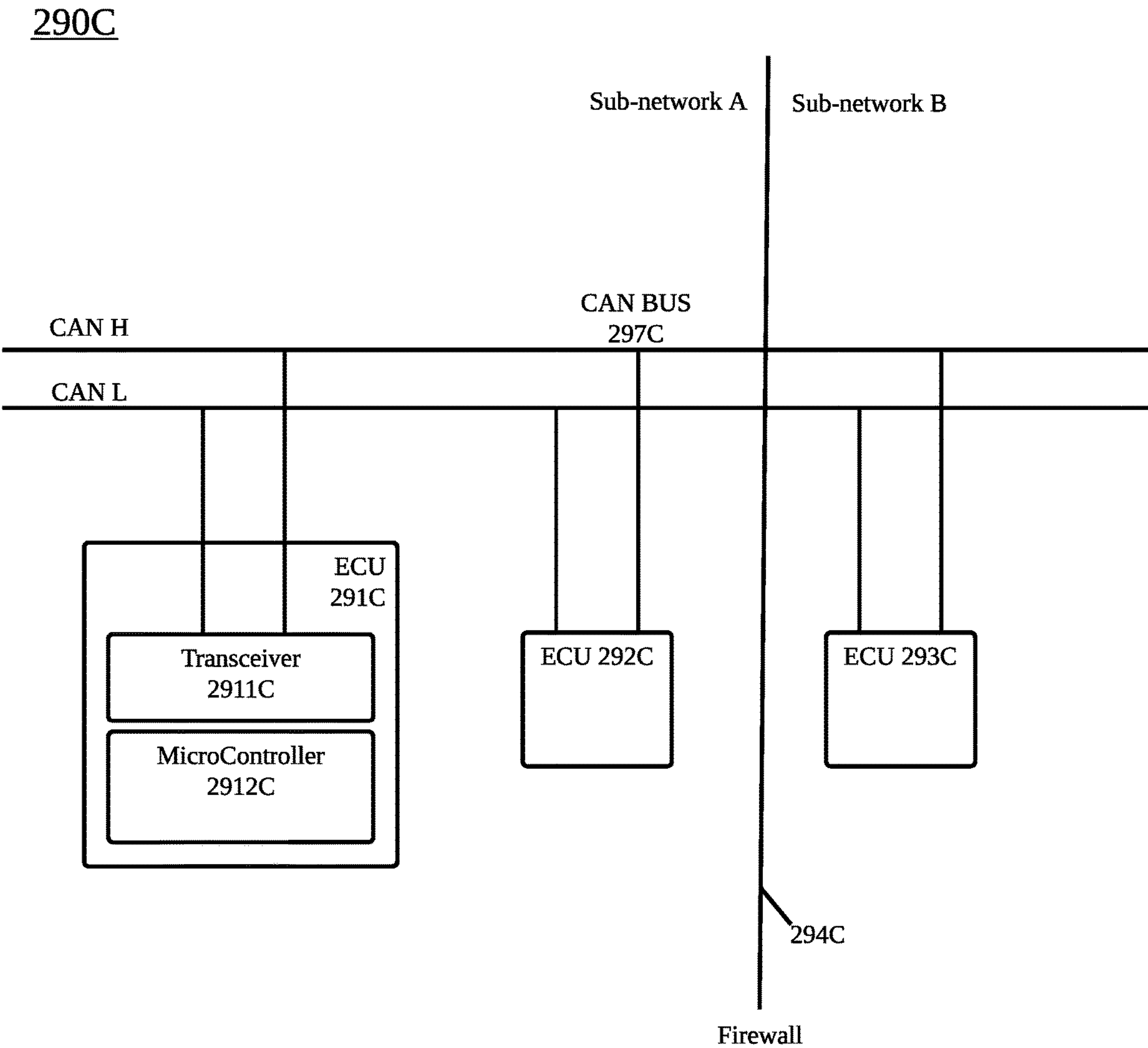


FIG. 2K

290D

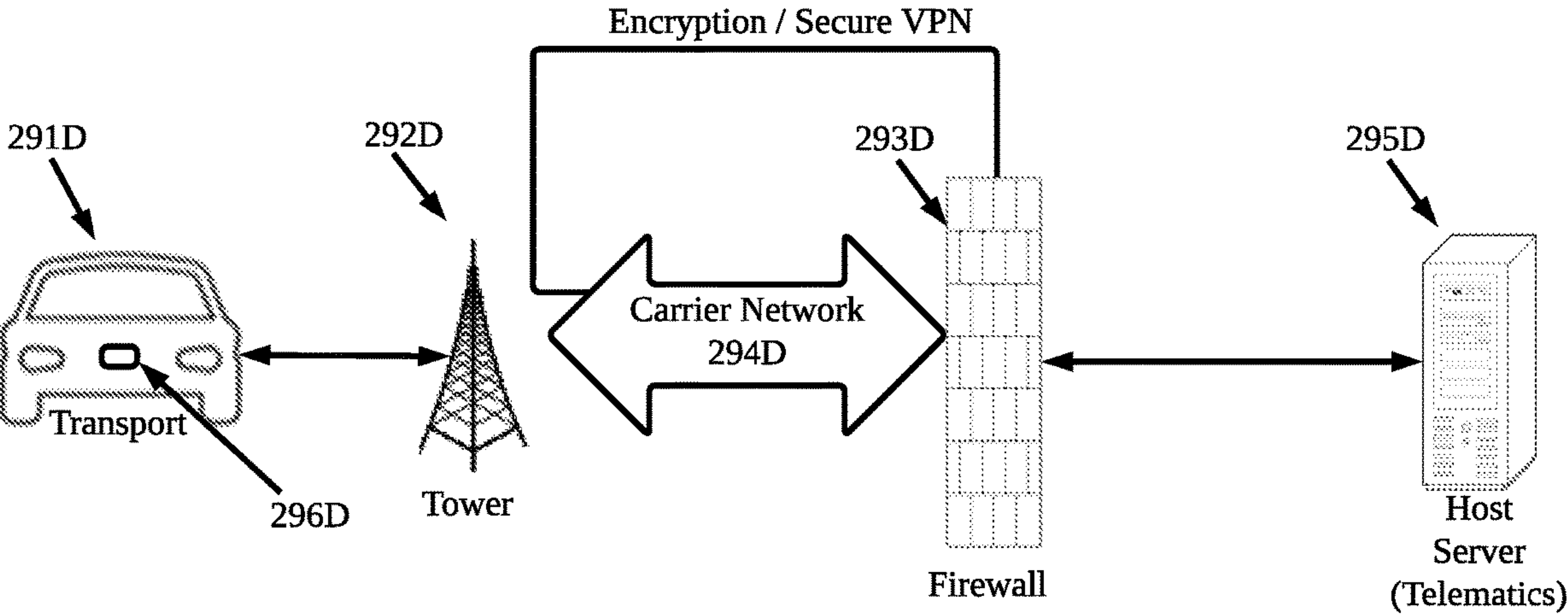


FIG. 2L

290E

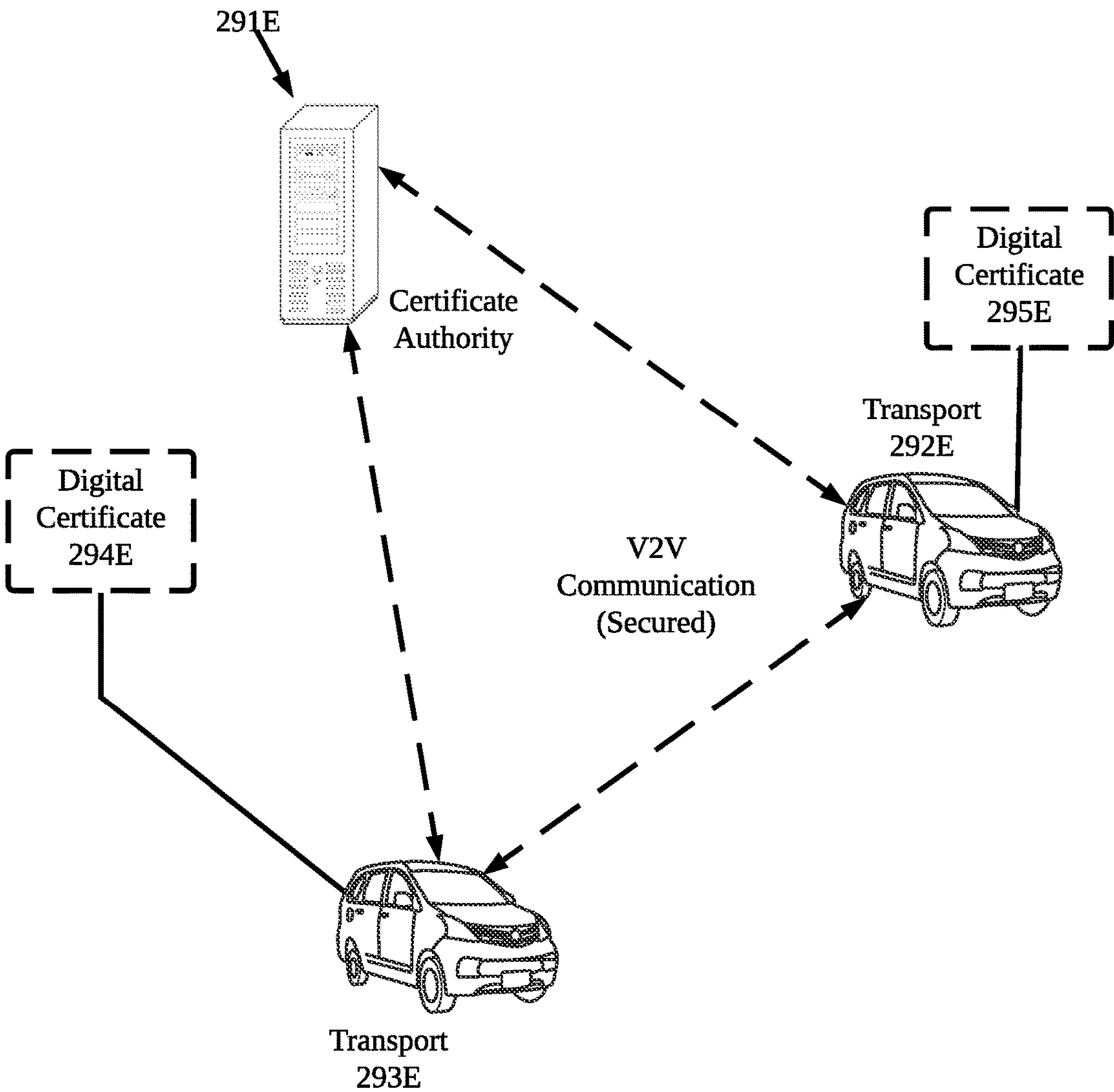


FIG. 2M

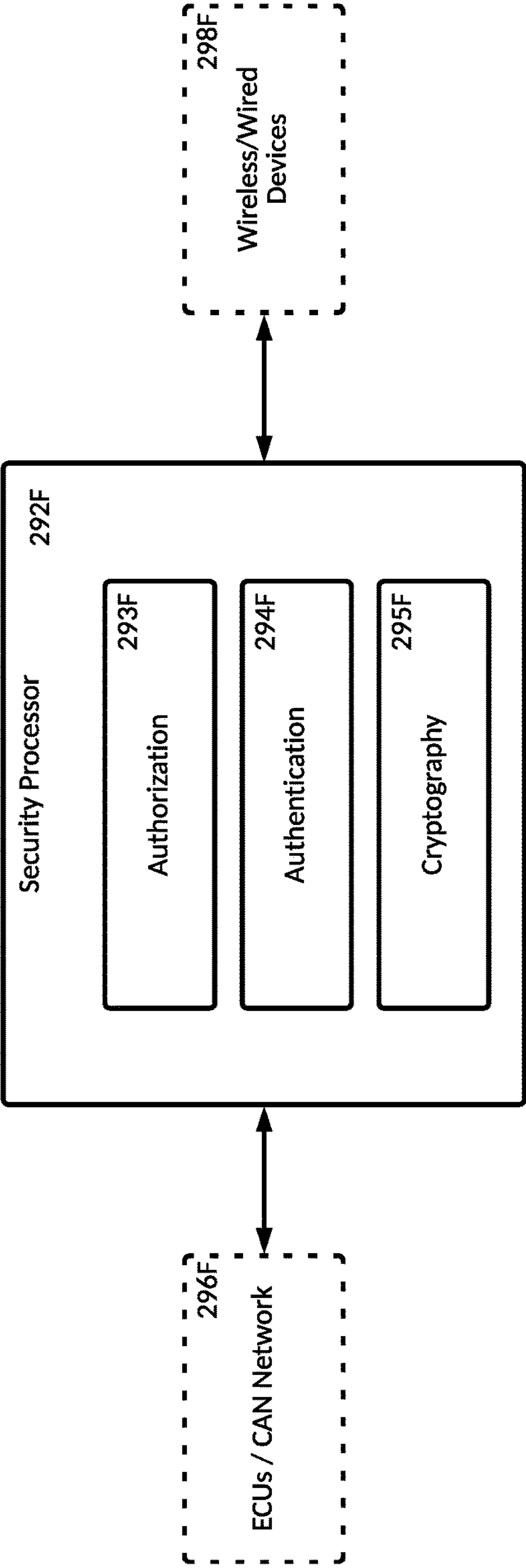


FIG. 2N

300

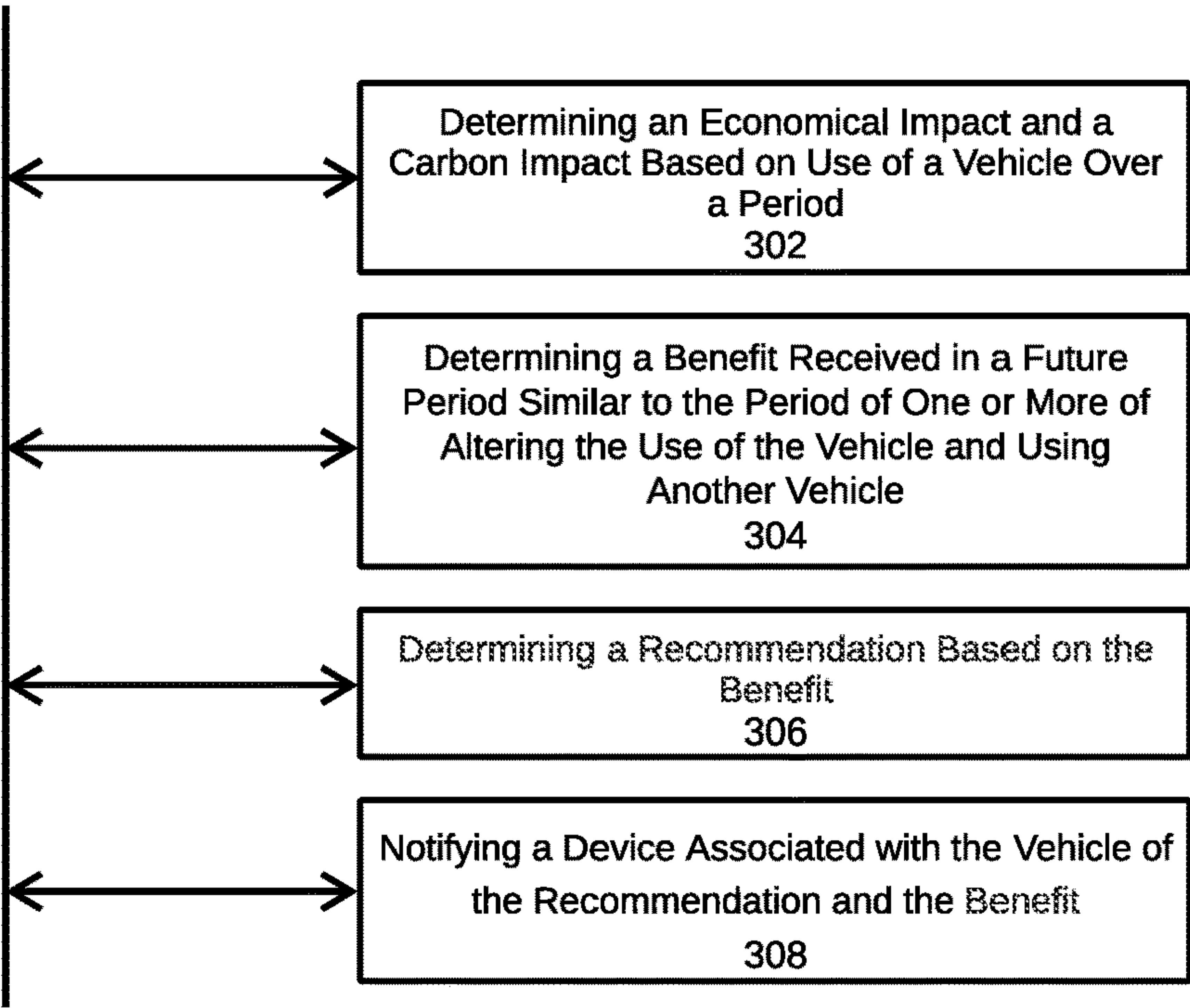


FIG. 3A

320

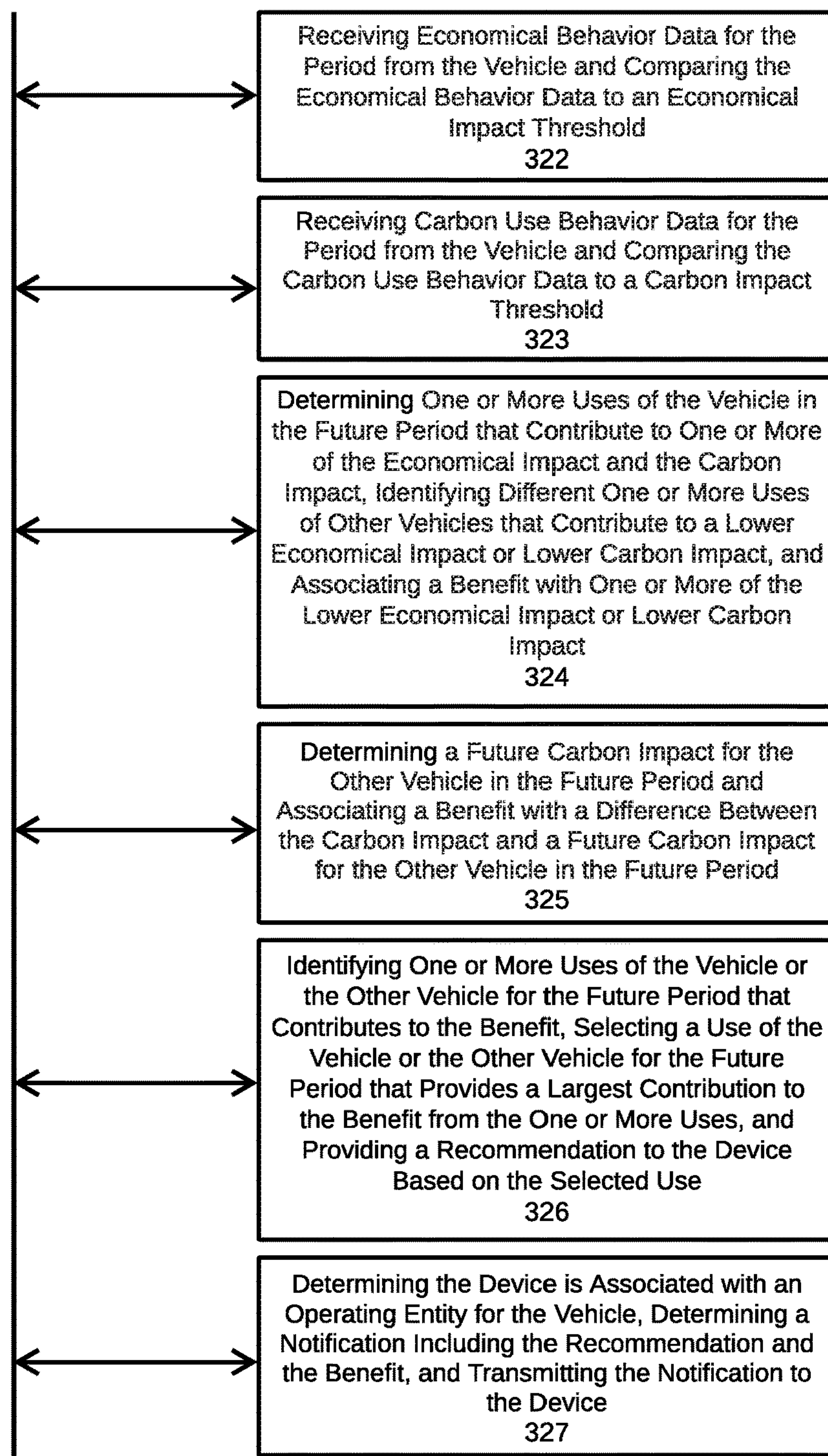


FIG. 3B

340

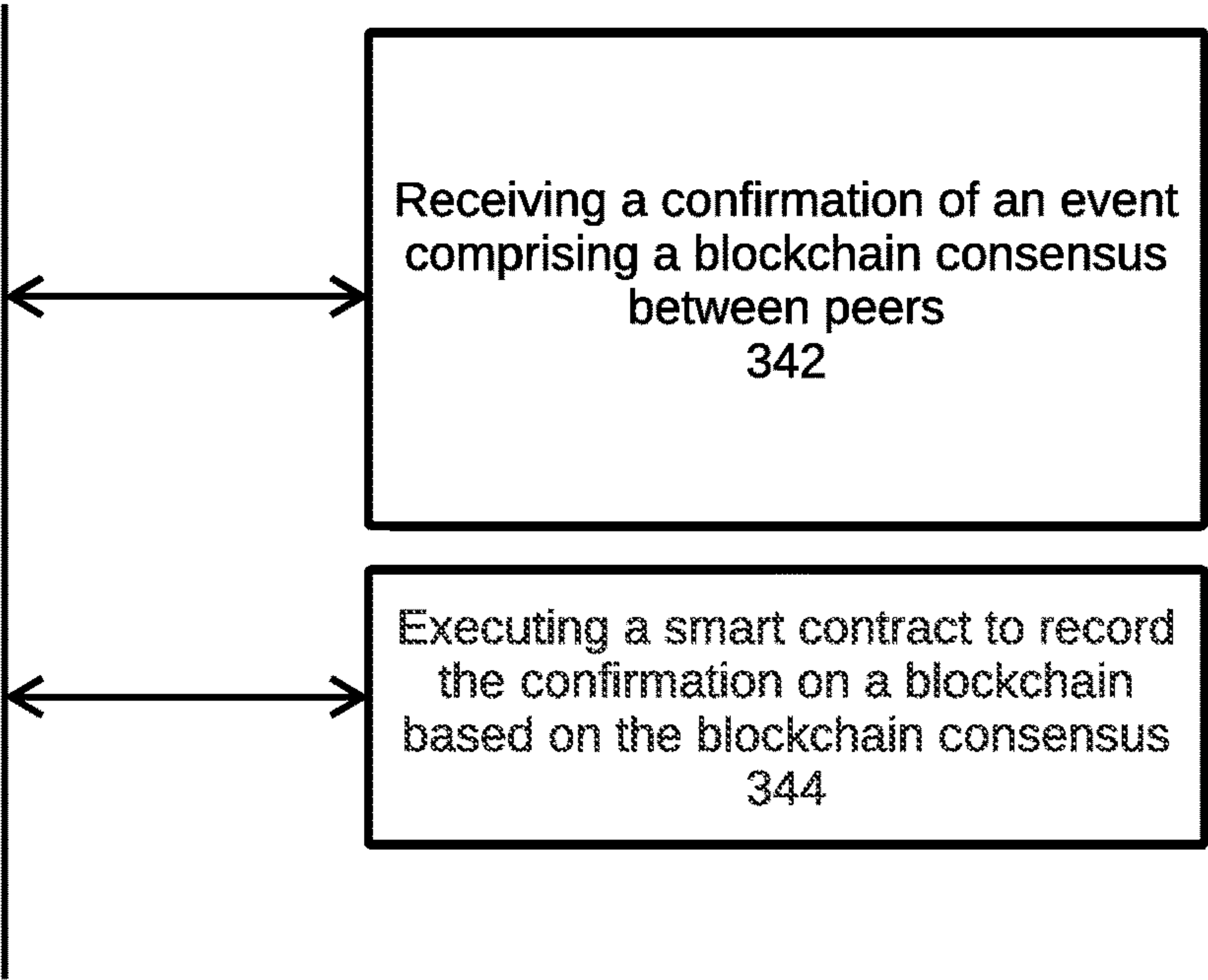


FIG. 3C

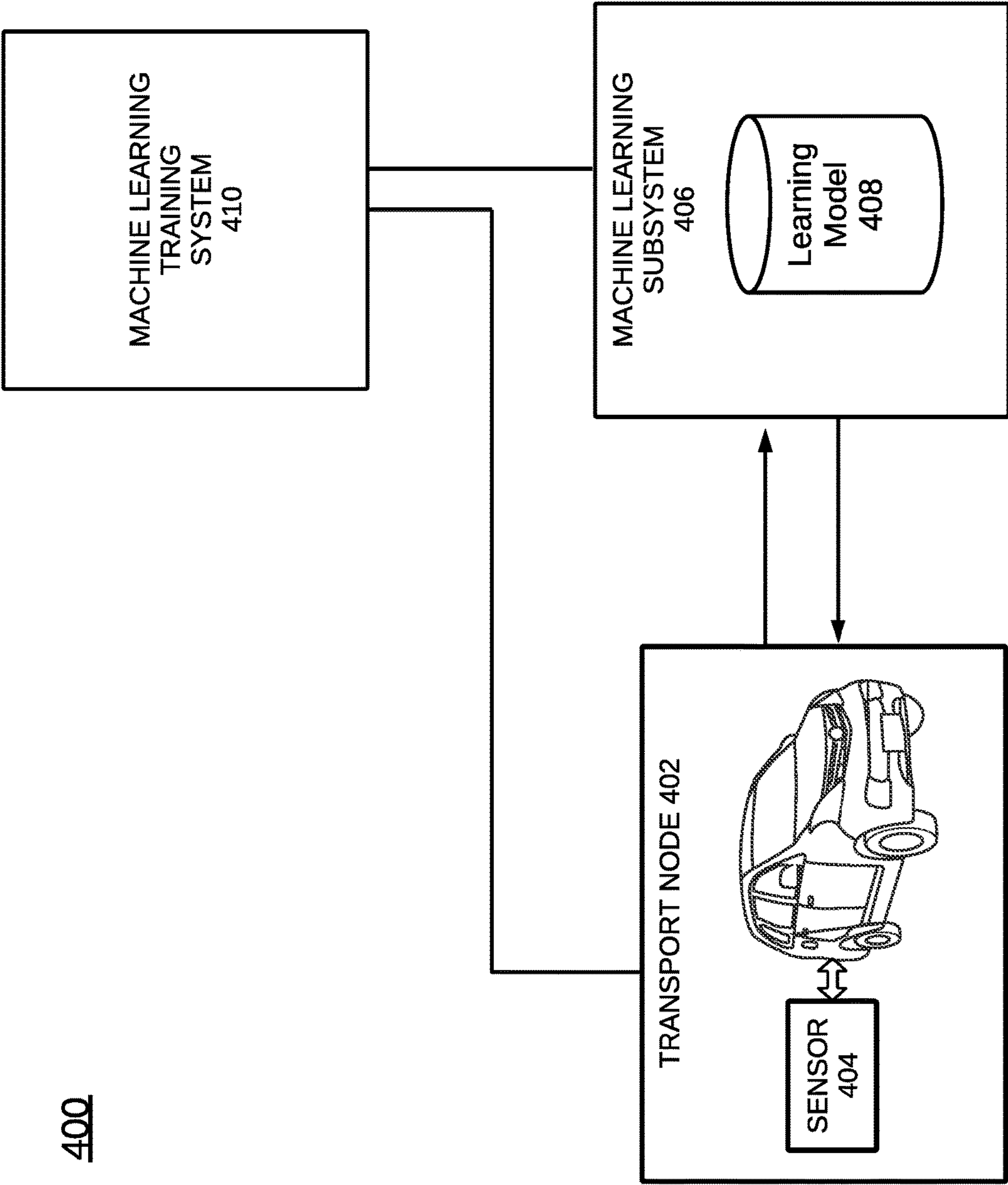


FIG. 4

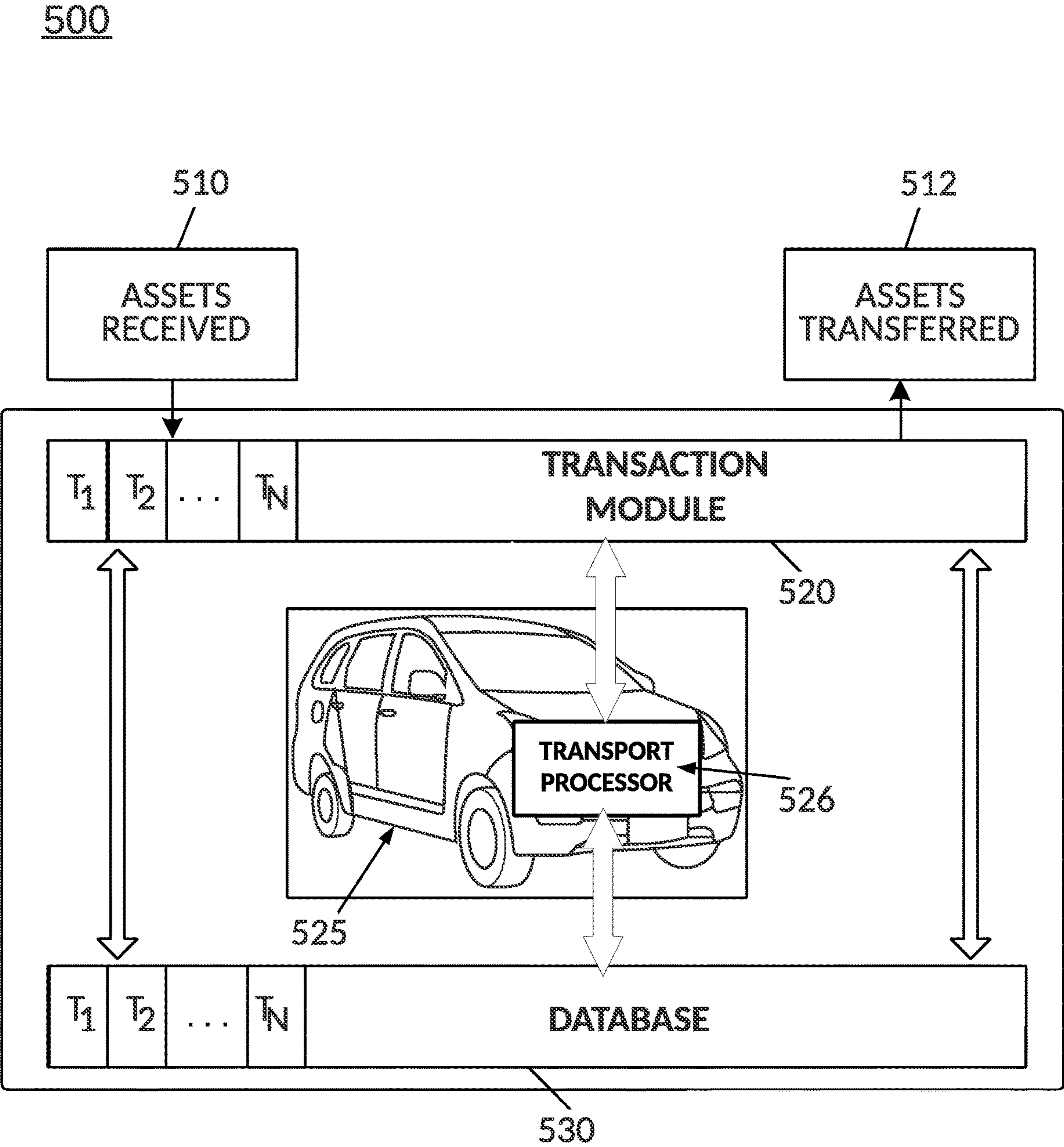


FIG. 5A

550

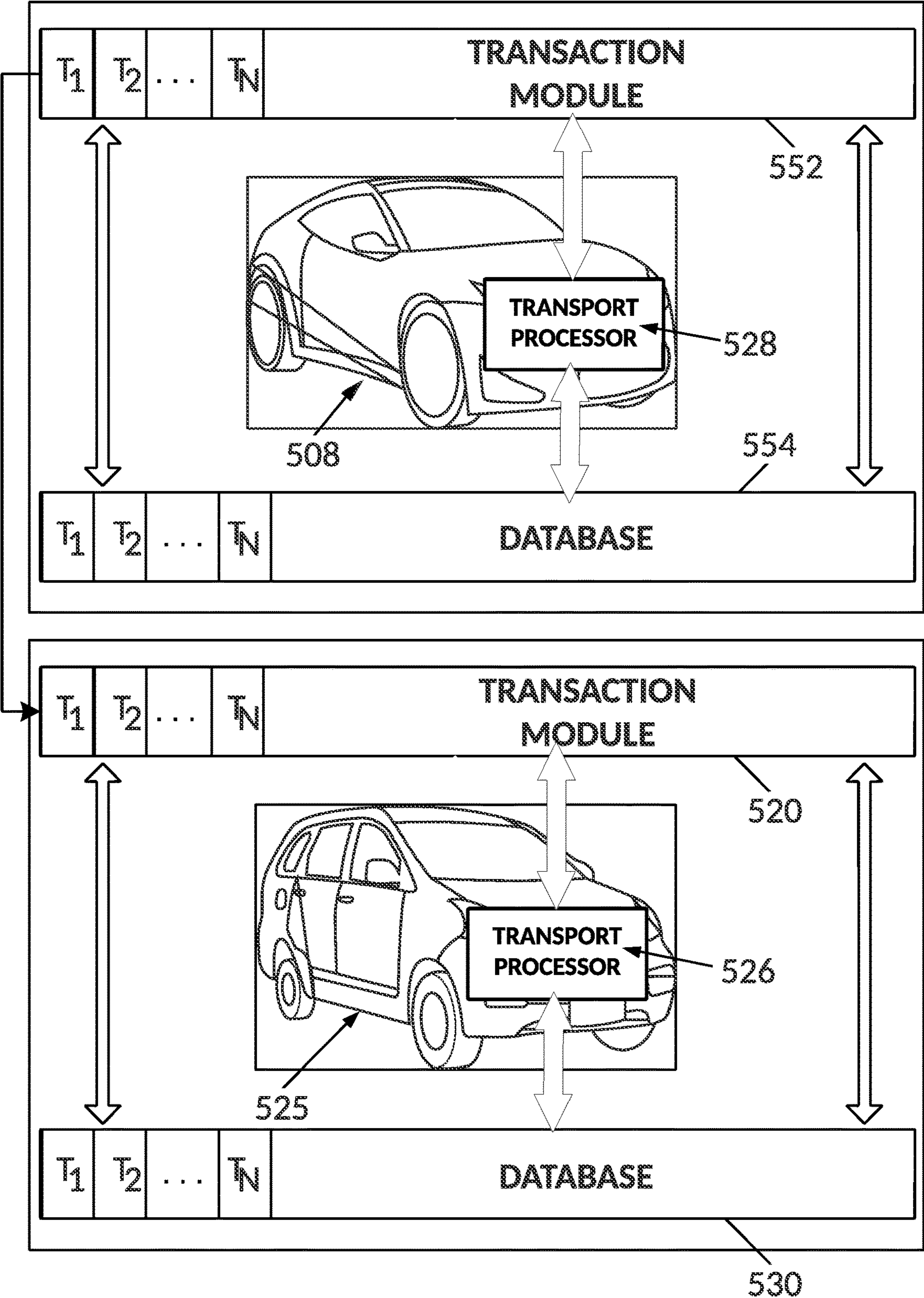


FIG. 5B

600

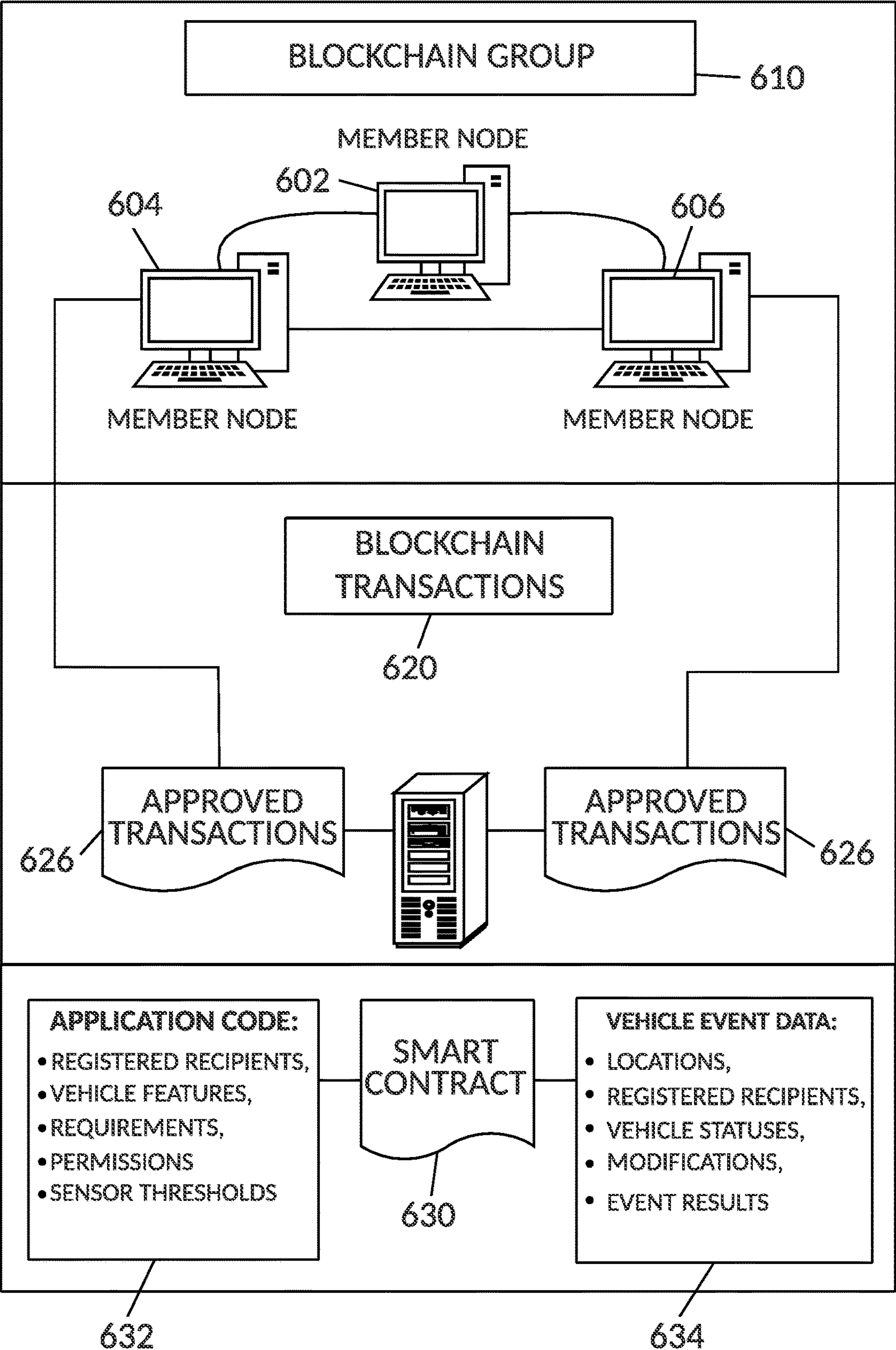


FIG. 6A

640

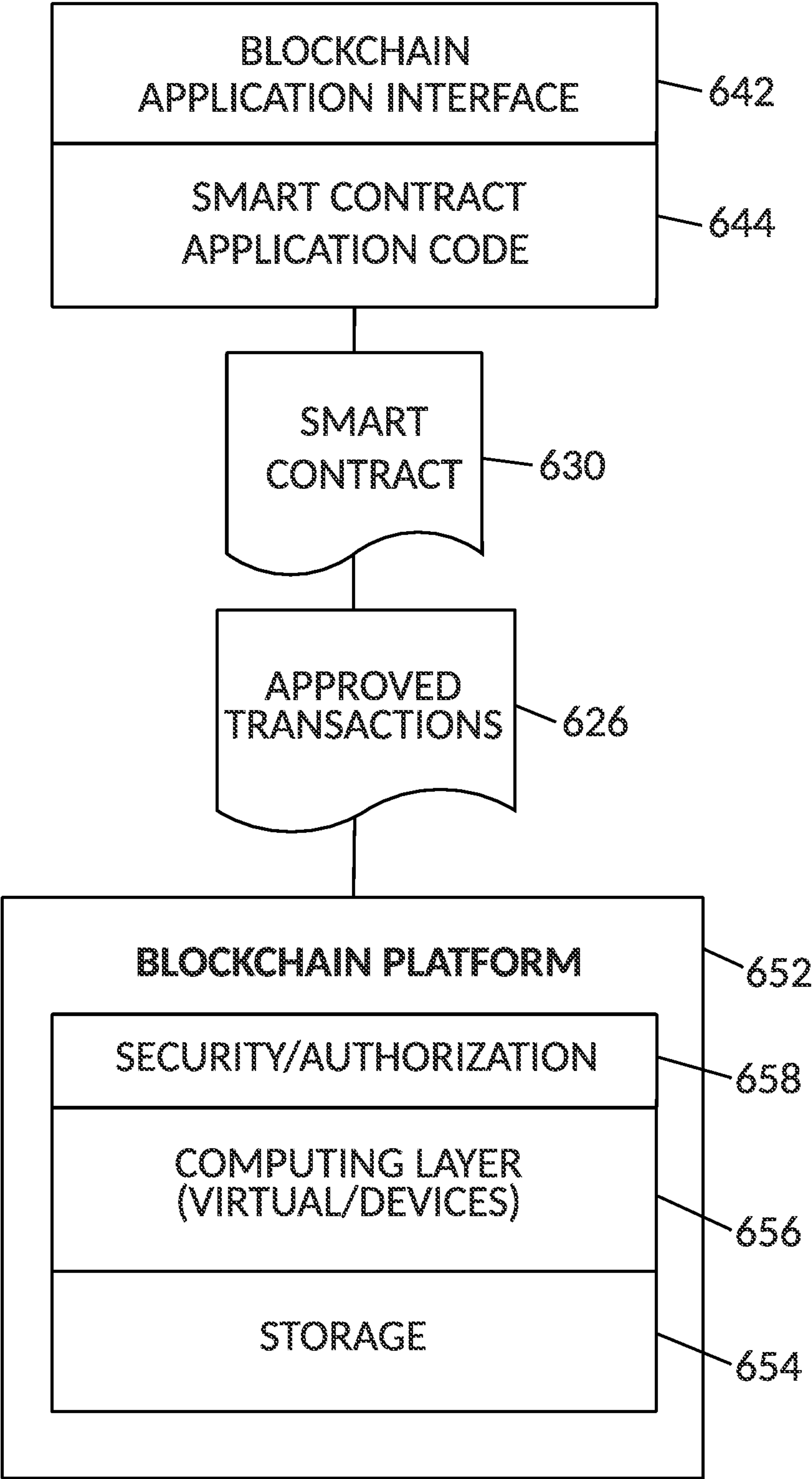


FIG. 6B

660

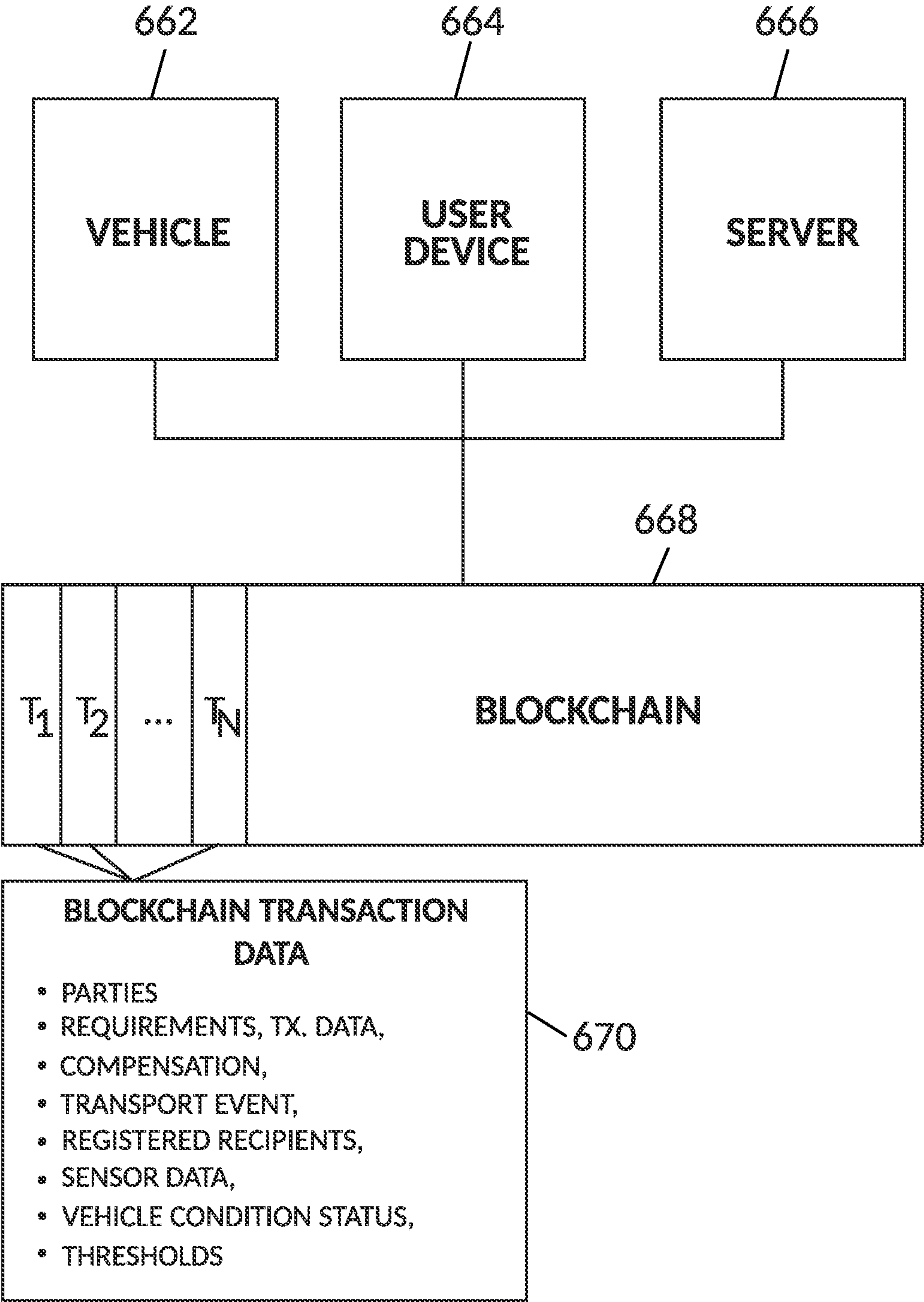
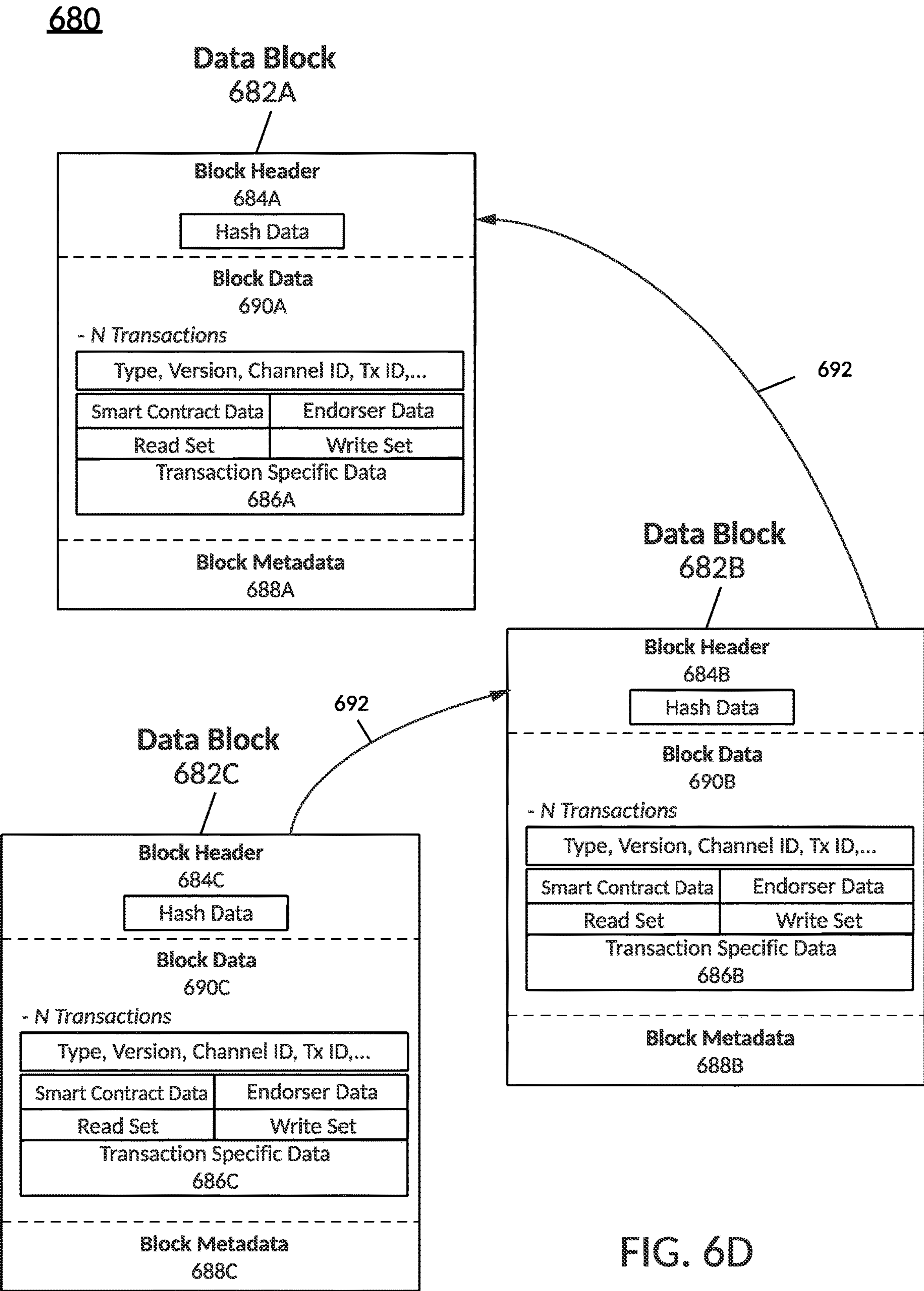


FIG. 6C



700

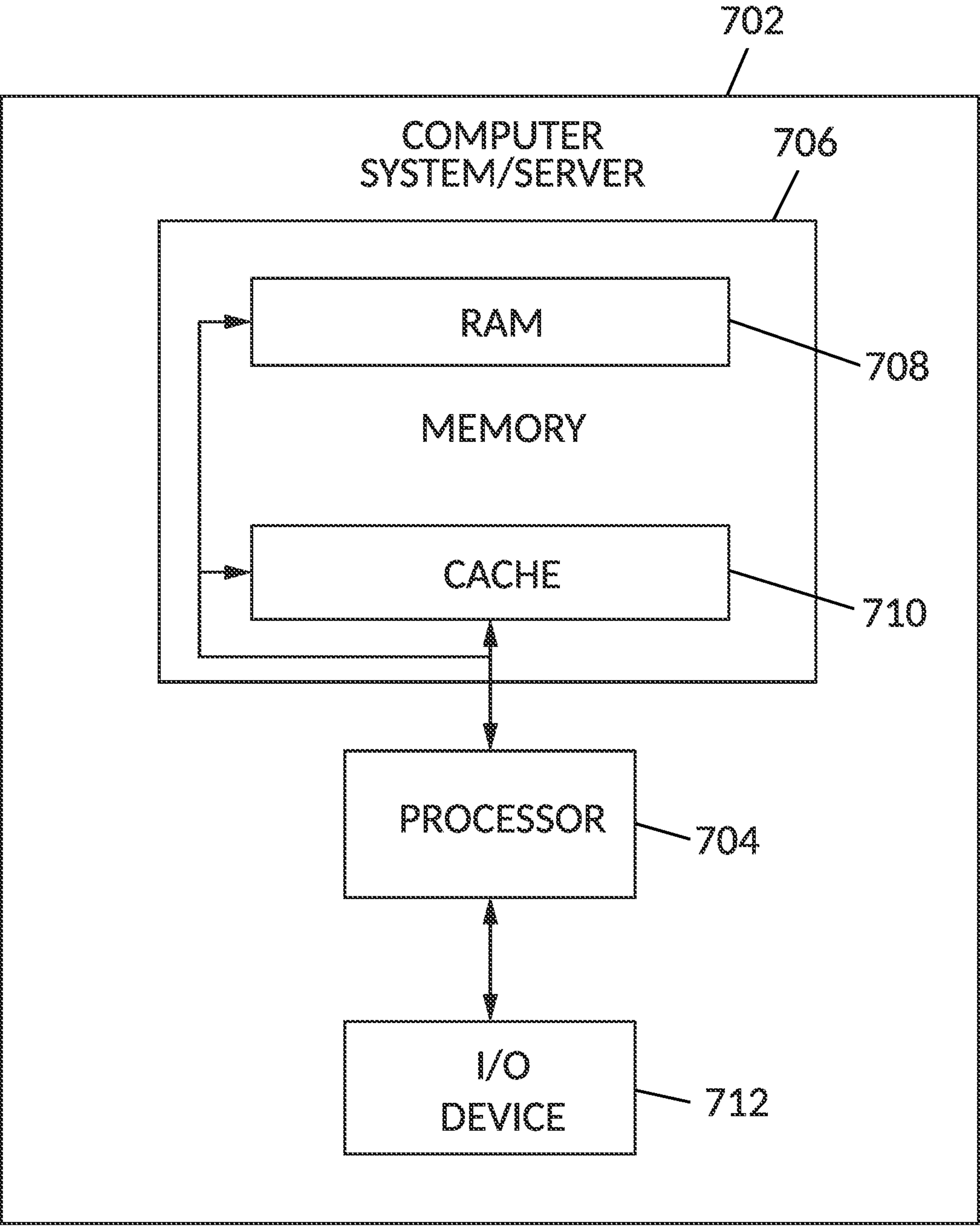


FIG. 7

VEHICLE CARBON USE LIMITATION

BACKGROUND

[0001] Vehicles or transports, such as cars, motorcycles, trucks, planes, trains, etc., generally provide transportation needs to occupants and/or goods in a variety of ways. Functions related to transports may be identified and utilized by various computing devices, such as a smartphone or a computer located on and/or off the transport.

SUMMARY

[0002] One example embodiment provides a method that includes one or more of determining an economical impact and a carbon impact based on a use of a vehicle over a period, determining a benefit received in a future period similar to the period of one or more of altering the use of the vehicle and using another vehicle, where the other vehicle uses less carbon, determining a recommendation, based on the benefit, and notifying a device associated with the vehicle, of the recommendation and the benefit.

[0003] Another example embodiment provides a system that includes a memory communicably coupled to a processor, wherein the processor performs one or more of determine an economical impact and a carbon impact based on a use of a vehicle over a period, determine a benefit received in a future period similar to the period of one or more of alter the use of the vehicle and use another vehicle, where the other vehicle uses less carbon, determine a recommendation, based on the benefit, and notify a device associated with the vehicle, of the recommendation and the benefit.

[0004] A further example embodiment provides a computer readable storage medium comprising instructions, that when read by a processor, cause the processor to perform one or more of determining an economical impact and a carbon impact based on a use of a vehicle over a period, determining a benefit received in a future period similar to the period of one or more of altering the use of the vehicle and using another vehicle, where the other vehicle uses less carbon, determining a recommendation, based on the benefit, and notifying a device associated with the vehicle, of the recommendation and the benefit.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0005] FIG. 1A illustrates an example diagram of vehicle carbon use limitation, according to example embodiments.

[0006] FIG. 1B illustrates a further example diagram of vehicle carbon use limitation, according to example embodiments.

[0007] FIG. 2A illustrates a transport network diagram, according to example embodiments.

[0008] FIG. 2B illustrates another transport network diagram, according to example embodiments.

[0009] FIG. 2C illustrates yet another transport network diagram, according to example embodiments.

[0010] FIG. 2D illustrates a further transport network diagram, according to example embodiments.

[0011] FIG. 2E illustrates yet a further transport network diagram, according to example embodiments.

[0012] FIG. 2F illustrates a diagram depicting electrification of one or more elements, according to example embodiments.

[0013] FIG. 2G illustrates a diagram depicting interconnections between different elements, according to example embodiments.

[0014] FIG. 2H illustrates a further diagram depicting interconnections between different elements, according to example embodiments.

[0015] FIG. 2I illustrates yet a further diagram depicting interconnections between elements, according to example embodiments.

[0016] FIG. 2J illustrates yet a further diagram depicting a keyless entry system, according to example embodiments.

[0017] FIG. 2K illustrates yet a further diagram depicting a CAN within a transport, according to example embodiments.

[0018] FIG. 2L illustrates yet a further diagram depicting an end-to-end communication channel, according to example embodiments.

[0019] FIG. 2M illustrates yet a further diagram depicting an example of transports performing secured V2V communications using security certificates, according to example embodiments.

[0020] FIG. 2N illustrates yet a further diagram depicting an example of a transport interacting with a security processor and a wireless device, according to example embodiments.

[0021] FIG. 3A illustrates a flow diagram, according to example embodiments.

[0022] FIG. 3B illustrates another flow diagram, according to example embodiments.

[0023] FIG. 3C illustrates yet another flow diagram, according to example embodiments.

[0024] FIG. 4 illustrates a machine learning transport network diagram, according to example embodiments.

[0025] FIG. 5A illustrates an example vehicle configuration for managing database transactions associated with a vehicle, according to example embodiments.

[0026] FIG. 5B illustrates another example vehicle configuration for managing database transactions conducted among various vehicles, according to example embodiments.

[0027] FIG. 6A illustrates a blockchain architecture configuration, according to example embodiments.

[0028] FIG. 6B illustrates another blockchain configuration, according to example embodiments.

[0029] FIG. 6C illustrates a blockchain configuration for storing blockchain transaction data, according to example embodiments.

[0030] FIG. 6D illustrates example data blocks, according to example embodiments.

[0031] FIG. 7 illustrates an example system that supports one or more of the example embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0032] It will be readily understood that the instant components, as generally described and illustrated in the figures herein, may be arranged and designed in a wide variety of different configurations. Thus, the following detailed description of the embodiments of at least one of a method, apparatus, computer readable storage medium and system, as represented in the attached figures, is not intended to limit the scope of the application as claimed but is merely representative of selected embodiments. Multiple embodiments depicted herein are not intended to limit the scope of the solution. The computer-readable storage medium may be

a non-transitory computer readable medium or a non-transitory computer readable storage medium.

[0033] Communications between the transport(s) and certain entities, such as remote servers, other transports and local computing devices (e.g., smartphones, personal computers, transport-embedded computers, etc.) may be sent and/or received and processed by one or more ‘components’ which may be hardware, firmware, software or a combination thereof. The components may be part of any of these entities or computing devices or certain other computing devices. In one example, consensus decisions related to blockchain transactions may be performed by one or more computing devices or components (which may be any element described and/or depicted herein) associated with the transport(s) and one or more of the components outside or at a remote location from the transport(s).

[0034] The instant features, structures, or characteristics described in this specification may be combined in any suitable manner in one or more embodiments. For example, the usage of the phrases “example embodiments,” “some embodiments,” or other similar language, throughout this specification refers to the fact that a particular feature, structure, or characteristic described in connection with the embodiment may be included in at least one example. Thus, appearances of the phrases “example embodiments”, “in some embodiments”, “in other embodiments,” or other similar language, throughout this specification do not necessarily all refer to the same group of embodiments, and the described features, structures, or characteristics may be combined in any suitable manner in one or more embodiments. In the diagrams, any connection between elements can permit one-way and/or two-way communication, even if the depicted connection is a one-way or two-way arrow. In the current solution, a vehicle or transport may include one or more of cars, trucks, walking area battery electric vehicle (BEV), e-Palette, fuel cell bus, motorcycles, scooters, bicycles, boats, recreational vehicles, planes, and any object that may be used to transport people and or goods from one location to another.

[0035] In addition, while the term “message” may have been used in the description of embodiments, other types of network data, such as, a packet, frame, datagram, etc. may also be used. Furthermore, while certain types of messages and signaling may be depicted in exemplary embodiments they are not limited to a certain type of message and signaling.

[0036] Example embodiments provide methods, systems, components, non-transitory computer readable medium, devices, and/or networks, which provide at least one of a transport (also referred to as a vehicle or car herein), a data collection system, a data monitoring system, a verification system, an authorization system, and a vehicle data distribution system. The vehicle status condition data received in the form of communication messages, such as wireless data network communications and/or wired communication messages, may be processed to identify vehicle/transport status conditions and provide feedback on the condition and/or changes of a transport. In one example, a user profile may be applied to a particular transport/vehicle to authorize a current vehicle event, service stops at service stations, to authorize subsequent vehicle rental services, and enable vehicle-to-vehicle communications.

[0037] Within the communication infrastructure, a decentralized database is a distributed storage system which

includes multiple nodes that communicate with each other. A blockchain is an example of a decentralized database, which includes an append-only immutable data structure (i.e., a distributed ledger) capable of maintaining records between untrusted parties. The untrusted parties are referred to herein as peers, nodes, or peer nodes. Each peer maintains a copy of the database records, and no single peer can modify the database records without a consensus being reached among the distributed peers. For example, the peers may execute a consensus protocol to validate blockchain storage entries, group the storage entries into blocks, and build a hash chain via the blocks. This process forms the ledger by ordering the storage entries, as is necessary, for consistency. In public or permissionless blockchains, anyone can participate without a specific identity. Public blockchains can involve crypto-currencies and use consensus-based on various protocols such as proof of work (PoW). Conversely, a permissioned blockchain database can secure interactions among a group of entities, which share a common goal, but which do not or cannot fully trust one another, such as businesses that exchange funds, goods, information, and the like. The instant solution can function in a permissioned and/or a permissionless blockchain setting.

[0038] Smart contracts are trusted distributed applications which leverage tamper-proof properties of the shared or distributed ledger (which may be in the form of a blockchain) and an underlying agreement between member nodes, which is referred to as an endorsement or endorsement policy. In general, blockchain entries are “endorsed” before being committed to the blockchain while entries, which are not endorsed are disregarded. A typical endorsement policy allows smart contract executable code to specify endorsers for an entry in the form of a set of peer nodes that are necessary for endorsement. When a client sends the entry to the peers specified in the endorsement policy, the entry is executed to validate the entry. After validation, the entries enter an ordering phase in which a consensus protocol produces an ordered sequence of endorsed entries grouped into blocks.

[0039] Nodes are the communication entities of the blockchain system. A “node” may perform a logical function in the sense that multiple nodes of different types can run on the same physical server. Nodes are grouped in trust domains and are associated with logical entities that control them in various ways. Nodes may include different types, such as a client or submitting-client node, which submits an entry-invocation to an endorser (e.g., peer), and broadcasts entry proposals to an ordering service (e.g., ordering node). Another type of node is a peer node, which can receive client submitted entries, commit the entries and maintain a state and a copy of the ledger of blockchain entries. Peers can also have the role of an endorser. An ordering-service-node or orderer is a node running the communication service for all nodes and which implements a delivery guarantee, such as a broadcast to each of the peer nodes in the system when committing entries and modifying a world state of the blockchain. The world state can constitute the initial blockchain entry, which normally includes control and setup information.

[0040] A ledger is a sequenced, tamper-resistant record of all state transitions of a blockchain. State transitions may result from smart contract executable code invocations (i.e., entries) submitted by participating parties (e.g., client nodes, ordering nodes, endorser nodes, peer nodes, etc.). An entry

may result in a set of asset key-value pairs being committed to the ledger as one or more operands, such as creates, updates, deletes, and the like. The ledger includes a blockchain (also referred to as a chain), which stores an immutable, sequenced record in blocks. The ledger also includes a state database, which maintains a current state of the blockchain. There is typically one ledger per channel. Each peer node maintains a copy of the ledger for each channel of which they are a member.

[0041] A chain is an entry log structured as hash-linked blocks, and each block contains a sequence of N entries where N is equal to or greater than one. The block header includes a hash of the blocks' entries, as well as a hash of the prior block's header. In this way, all entries on the ledger may be sequenced and cryptographically linked together. Accordingly, it is not possible to tamper with the ledger data without breaking the hash links. A hash of a most recently added blockchain block represents every entry on the chain that has come before it, making it possible to ensure that all peer nodes are in a consistent and trusted state. The chain may be stored on a peer node file system (i.e., local, attached storage, cloud, etc.), efficiently supporting the append-only nature of the blockchain workload.

[0042] The current state of the immutable ledger represents the latest values for all keys that are included in the chain entry log. Since the current state represents the latest key values known to a channel, it is sometimes referred to as a world state. Smart contract executable code invocations execute entries against the current state data of the ledger. To make these smart contract executable code interactions efficient, the latest values of the keys may be stored in a state database. The state database may be simply an indexed view into the chain's entry log and can therefore be regenerated from the chain at any time. The state database may automatically be recovered (or generated if needed) upon peer node startup and before entries are accepted.

[0043] A blockchain is different from a traditional database in that the blockchain is not a central storage but rather a decentralized, immutable, and secure storage, where nodes must share in changes to records in the storage. Some properties that are inherent in blockchain and which help implement the blockchain include, but are not limited to, an immutable ledger, smart contracts, security, privacy, decentralization, consensus, endorsement, accessibility, and the like.

[0044] Example embodiments provide a service to a particular vehicle and/or a user profile that is applied to the vehicle. For example, a user may be the owner of a vehicle or the operator of a vehicle owned by another party. The vehicle may require service at certain intervals, and the service needs may require authorization before permitting the services to be received. Also, service centers may offer services to vehicles in a nearby area based on the vehicle's current route plan and a relative level of service requirements (e.g., immediate, severe, intermediate, minor, etc.). The vehicle needs may be monitored via one or more vehicle and/or road sensors or cameras, which report sensed data to a central controller computer device in and/or apart from the vehicle. This data is forwarded to a management server for review and action. A sensor may be located on one or more of the interior of the transport, the exterior of the transport, on a fixed object apart from the transport, and on another transport proximate the transport. The sensor may also be associated with the transport's speed, the transport's brak-

ing, the transport's acceleration, fuel levels, service needs, the gear-shifting of the transport, the transport's steering, and the like. A sensor, as described herein, may also be a device, such as a wireless device in and/or proximate to the transport. Also, sensor information may be used to identify whether the vehicle is operating safely and whether an occupant has engaged in any unexpected vehicle conditions, such as during a vehicle access and/or utilization period. Vehicle information collected before, during and/or after a vehicle's operation may be identified and stored in a transaction on a shared/distributed ledger, which may be generated and committed to the immutable ledger as determined by a permission granting consortium, and thus in a "decentralized" manner, such as via a blockchain membership group.

[0045] Each interested party (i.e., owner, user, company, agency, etc.) may want to limit the exposure of private information, and therefore the blockchain and its immutability can be used to manage permissions for each particular user vehicle profile. A smart contract may be used to provide compensation, quantify a user profile score/rating/review, apply vehicle event permissions, determine when service is needed, identify a collision and/or degradation event, identify a safety concern event, identify parties to the event and provide distribution to registered entities seeking access to such vehicle event data. Also, the results may be identified, and the necessary information can be shared among the registered companies and/or individuals based on a consensus approach associated with the blockchain. Such an approach could not be implemented on a traditional centralized database.

[0046] Various driving systems of the instant solution can utilize software, an array of sensors as well as machine learning functionality, light detection and ranging (Lidar) projectors, radar, ultrasonic sensors, etc. to create a map of terrain and road that a transport can use for navigation and other purposes. In some embodiments, GPS, maps, cameras, sensors and the like can also be used in autonomous vehicles in place of Lidar.

[0047] The instant solution includes, in certain embodiments, authorizing a vehicle for service via an automated and quick authentication scheme. For example, driving up to a charging station or fuel pump may be performed by a vehicle operator or an autonomous transport and the authorization to receive charge or fuel may be performed without any delays provided the authorization is received by the service and/or charging station. A vehicle may provide a communication signal that provides an identification of a vehicle that has a currently active profile linked to an account that is authorized to accept a service, which can be later rectified by compensation. Additional measures may be used to provide further authentication, such as another identifier may be sent from the user's device wirelessly to the service center to replace or supplement the first authorization effort between the transport and the service center with an additional authorization effort.

[0048] Data shared and received may be stored in a database, which maintains data in one single database (e.g., database server) and generally at one particular location. This location is often a central computer, for example, a desktop central processing unit (CPU), a server CPU, or a mainframe computer. Information stored on a centralized database is typically accessible from multiple different points. A centralized database is easy to manage, maintain,

and control, especially for purposes of security because of its single location. Within a centralized database, data redundancy is minimized as a single storing place of all data also implies that a given set of data only has one primary record. A blockchain may be used for storing transport-related data and transactions.

[0049] Any of the actions described herein may be performed by one or more processors (such as a microprocessor, a sensor, an Electronic Control Unit (ECU), a head unit, and the like), with or without memory, which may be located on-board the transport and/or off-board the transport (such as a server, computer, mobile/wireless device, etc.). The one or more processors may communicate with other memory and/or other processors on-board or off-board other transports to utilize data being sent by and/or to the transport. The one or more processors and the other processors can send data, receive data, and utilize this data to perform one or more of the actions described or depicted herein.

[0050] FIG. 1A illustrates an example diagram of vehicle carbon use limitation according to example embodiments. A system 100 may include one or more vehicles 104, a server 120, and a device 130. Vehicles 104 may include cars, trucks, recreational vehicles, construction vehicles, motorcycles, mopeds, powered bicycles, trains, aircraft, and the like. In one embodiment, any of the vehicles herein may be at least partially powered by electric energy (i.e., hybrid vehicles (PHEVs), electric vehicles (EVs), etc.).

[0051] The server 120 may include one or more processors and memory devices for storing applications and data. In one embodiment, the server 120 may be associated with a vehicle manufacturer, a town or municipality, a government entity, a business or group of businesses, an organization, and the like. In one embodiment, servers 120 may be located in a network or cloud, may be part of a vehicle 104, and/or in or connected to one or more vehicle charging stations. In one embodiment, the server 120 may represent any number of computing devices that may determine results and share data and determined results. The server 120 may communicate with one or more vehicles 104 in order to obtain various forms of behavior data, as discussed herein.

[0052] The device 130 may include one or more processors and memory devices for storing applications and data. In one embodiment, the device 130 may be associated with a vehicle owner, a vehicle driver, a vehicle occupant, and the like. The device 130 may be a device integrated with the vehicle 104 and/or the device 130 may be used in, and removed from the vehicle 104, such as a mobile device. The device 130 may include various forms of vehicle 104 displays, smartphones, smartwatches, tablets, wearable computers, notebook computers, and the like.

[0053] In one embodiment, the device 130 may include a device application, either inherently present on the device 130 or downloaded/installed from a website, that may provide a list of suggestions and insights to customers or users of the device 130 to encourage them to change their behavior in certain ways to reduce their carbon emissions and save money. For example, the server 120 may include an application that calculates exactly what the financial and carbon emissions savings would be for different types of changes in customer behavior related to a vehicle 104 and then suggest these changes to the customer through the device 130 and device application. An example recommendation from the device application to a device 130 user may be, for example, “We’ve noticed you charge your vehicle most often during

the day. If you charge overnight instead, we estimate you could reduce your monthly electric bill by \$8 and your carbon emissions by 10%.” Note that this example demonstrates a suggestion that may only be applicable to EV and PHEV drivers. In addition to displaying the recommendations in the device application or a website, or delivering the suggestions as application notifications, these recommendations may be delivered via e-mail on a weekly or monthly basis.

[0054] In one embodiment, either the server 120 application or the device 130 application may be used to share relatively simple, straightforward metrics such as how many miles the user drove over the previous week, month, year (time period), etc., how much electrical energy they used in kilowatt-hours (kWh) for PHEVs and BEVs or how many gallons of gas/diesel their vehicle 104 consumed over the previous week, month, year (time period), etc., what their average efficiency was in miles/kWh (for PHEVs and BEVs) or miles-per-gallon (mpg) for ICE and hybrid vehicles 104, their electrical energy cost (\$) for PHEVs and BEVs over the past week, month, year (time period), and/or how many trips were within the all-electric range of the PHEV (EV Ratio utilization). This is essentially very similar to the Sense Energy Usage report for homes, where the “Sense” is a consumer device that monitors energy usage in homes.

[0055] The present application attempts to offer a recommendation and convince the driver or occupant to alter their behavior based on concrete data offered by notifications from the system. The data is presented to the driver/occupant in a compelling way. The notification may be received via an email generated by the system, for example, and may include details of the current vehicle 104 and alternate vehicles that are similar but produce less carbon, such as a hybrid or fully electric version of the vehicle 104. The notification may also include an amount of money saved over a period by using the alternate vehicle, such as “\$2345 would be saved in fuel cost”. Other data may include environmental impact savings, such as “you would reduce your CO₂ emissions by 25%”, etc. The data is granular and is based on the driving behavior over a period of time, with more time for the analysis leading to more granular data.

[0056] Additional information in the notification may include a time when the carbon footprint of the vehicle will be offset and when the carbon footprint may be lower, as compared to the period of analysis. For example, the period of analysis of the current vehicle is 6 months. Over the next 6 months, if the recommended changes are made, the notification may show the savings as compared to where the individual would be without the changes. If the driver is currently at a deficit of carbon output, in 5 months, the driver would be at X carbon output, for example. One goal of the system is to motivate the driver to “level up” and possibly surpass where they are.

[0057] The system determines the behavior of the vehicle 104 in a time period. For example, how the driver is using the vehicle 104 over a period of time. The period may be days, weeks, months, and/or years. Based on the behavior, the system recommends (through a notification) different driving behaviors that may benefit the driver or vehicle 104 owner. The benefit may be an economic benefit where the driver/vehicle owner may save money and/or may be a benefit where fewer carbon emissions are generated. The notification is specific to the driver and is based on the data obtained over the period of time. The recommendation may

also include a benefit that is received when the user begins to use another vehicle, whereas the new vehicle may be a vehicle that uses less carbon, such as an electric vehicle.

[0058] In one embodiment, vehicles 104 may provide economical behavior data 108 and/or carbon use behavioral data 112 to the server 120. The economical behavior data 108 may include current or historical operating data for the vehicle 104 that may affect a financial cost to operate the vehicle 104. Lower financial costs may be preferable in order to reduce the operating costs for the vehicle 104. The carbon use behavioral data 112 may include current or historical operating data for the vehicle 104 that may affect carbon emissions produced by the vehicle 104. Lower carbon emissions may be preferable when considering green energy use related to the vehicle 104. When driving a vehicle 104, carbon emissions may be based on a driving style of the vehicle 104. For example, if the vehicle 104 accelerates at a high speed often, the vehicle 104 may produce greater emissions. The overall use of the vehicle 104 may affect the gas mileage of the vehicle 104 as well, which also affects the carbon emissions, such as a route that is taken, use of the HVAC, and the like.

[0059] In one embodiment, the server 120 may receive the economical behavior data 108 and the carbon use behavior data 112 and, in response, determine one or more benefits 124 and recommendations 116. The server 120 may provide a notification to the device 130 that includes one or more benefits 124 and one or more recommendations 116, and the device 130 may provide the one or more benefits 124 and one or more recommendations 116 to a user associated with the device 130 and/or the vehicle 104 (i.e., presented on a display of the device 130 and/or presented audibly through the device 130 and/or the vehicle 104).

[0060] In one embodiment, the device 130 may include an application, such as a “Carbon Coach” smartphone application, which may present the results of the servers’ 120 analysis. The analysis may consider a user’s driving style, driving route history, heating, ventilation, and air conditioning (HVAC) usage, electrical charger usage, and pair this on-board vehicle 104 data with other off-vehicle data (e.g., server 120 data) to quantify exactly how much modifying certain vehicle 104 usage behaviors can save money and reduce carbon emissions. The problem the carbon coach application solves is reducing vehicle 104 fuel and operating costs and reducing the vehicle’s total carbon emissions.

[0061] Prior to user device 130 applications, previous generations of vehicles 104 may have included an on-board vehicular “Eco Score” displayed in certain vehicles, such as Toyota hybrid vehicles. For example, the Eco Score was originally rolled out in the Toyota 2012 Prius model C. The Eco Score is a number out of 100 and appeared in model-year 2019 Toyota hybrids equipped with a 7-inch digital display, such as the Avalon and Camry sedans, RAV4 SUV, and Prius and Prius Prime hatchbacks. It is also available on the 2020 Corolla Hybrid sedan. For the Prius AWD-E, the feature appears in what Toyota calls the Hybrid System Indicator, a section of the display that also includes information on current battery charge status and a meter split into regenerative charging, electric-only driving, and gas-powered driving. The score is determined by three statuses broken out below the number: Eco-Start, Eco-Cruise, and Eco-Stop.

[0062] The Eco statuses are part of an algorithm that determines how efficiently a vehicle 104 is being driven. The

idea is to condition a driver into using smooth, even acceleration and deceleration while avoiding sudden activation of the gas or brake pedals at speed. Additionally, the vehicles 104 that include the feature provide a rating for how much the vehicle’s 104 air conditioning is operated. For example, operating air conditioning requires electrical power, and consuming electrical power negatively impacts vehicle 104 operating efficiency. The less the air conditioning is operated, the better off you are (energy-wise, at least). The current Eco Score technology focuses on a primary concept: changing driving style to improve the fuel economy of conventional hybrid vehicles.

[0063] Driving style, however, is not the only factor that influences overall vehicle 104 operating cost and emissions. There are a number of other factors that contribute to overall vehicle 104 emissions and costs, such as driving route (e.g., how the vehicle 104 moved from location A to location B), driving speed, the time of day during which electric vehicle (EV) or plug-in hybrid electric vehicle (PHEV) charging takes place, the type of charger used (for EV/PHEV) vehicles, defroster and air conditioner usage, tire pressure, cargo weight, cruise control usage, usage of a garage or covered parking space when the vehicle 104 is not in use, and the source of electricity used to charge EV/PHEVs. The improvement is that the “Carbon Coach” application has the potential to reduce fuel and operating costs and vehicle emissions to a much larger degree than the existing “Eco Score” feature, which is based on driving style alone.

[0064] Another new feature disclosed herein is the ability to place EV/PHEV vehicle product promotion in the “Carbon Coach” application. For example, if a user is currently driving an internal combustion engine (ICE) or a HYBRID vehicle, the application may calculate current fuel consumption costs based on their actual mileage and route history and then predict the expected savings by switching over to a comparable PHEV or EV. For example, the application could make a recommendation such as: “We see you’re driving a RAV4 Hybrid. If you had an RAV 4 Prime (PHEV), you could drive 78% of your miles on electricity alone, yielding annual cost savings of . . .”. Although a user may perform simple calculations at this time to estimate cost savings when switching to a new vehicle 104, the key difference here is that the application can make very precise predictions based on many obtained driver/vehicle data parameters that may be retrieved from memory devices and/or sensors. The vehicle 104 may be able to obtain the driver route history, driving style, climate, etc.

[0065] Yet another improvement over the current “Eco Score” in-vehicle application stems from the fact the insights and suggestions offered by the “Carbon Coach” would not be delivered to the driver in real-time while he or she is driving but would instead be presented in a smartphone application or from an accessible website. The data and suggestions may be offered in a much richer, more visually appealing manner and would not be limited to the restrictions imposed by a small in-vehicle display that drivers are only expected to glance at for a second or two at a time.

[0066] FIG. 1B illustrates an example diagram of vehicle carbon use limitation according to example embodiments. A system 150 may include one or more vehicle processors 160, a server 120, and a device 130. The server 120 and the device 130 were previously described with respect to FIG. 1A. The vehicle processor 160 may be associated with a

vehicle **104** and may include a navigation processor, a communication processor, a head unit processor, an ECU processor, a sensor processor, and the like. The vehicle processor **160**, the server **120**, and the device **130** may communicate over wired and/or wireless communication media. For example, when a vehicle **104** is receiving electrical charge at a charging location, the vehicle **104** may be coupled to a charging station through a suitable charging cable, and the charging station may be communicably coupled to the server **120** through a WI-FI or BLUETOOTH connection. The charging cable may include electrical pathway(s) to transfer electrical charge as well as one or more wired communication pathways (e.g., USB, Ethernet, etc.) to provide bidirectional communication to/from the vehicle processor **160**. As another example, the vehicle **104** may not be coupled to a charging station, such as while traveling, and may communicate wirelessly with the server **120** such as via WI-FI, BLUETOOTH, other wireless communication interfaces, and the like.

[0067] In one embodiment, raw vehicle **104** data (i.e., CAN messages) may be stored on the vehicle **104**, and then uploaded to the cloud, whenever possible, via a cellular modem or external facing WI-FI radio. It is important to note that the data does not have to be uploaded in real-time, since the feedback is not provided to the driver in real-time. The system **150** has the flexibility to upload data from the vehicle processor **160** to the server **120** perhaps as infrequently as once a week. The flexibility may even allow for all data to be uploaded via WI-FI if it's available when the vehicle **104** is parked at a vehicle owner's home. Uploading data via WI-FI would eliminate cellular data costs. The actual data processing, analysis, and calculations may take place either on the vehicle **104** itself (i.e., before uploading) or in the cloud (i.e., after uploading), or both. The results would then be presented to the end user in an application on the device **130** or through a website. Multiple types of analysis could be conducted by the server **120** and/or the vehicle processor **160**, as described herein.

[0068] In one embodiment, the vehicle **104** driving the most fuel-efficient route may be analyzed. For example, in the fall of 2021, Google Maps was updated so that, in addition to showing the fastest route, Google Maps also displays the route that's the most fuel-efficient, if it doesn't happen to also be the fastest. Knowing each user's driving history, the server **120** or vehicle processor **160** may analyze the routes they've driven over the past week, month, etc., and determine if they've used the most fuel-efficient routes. If the users have not used the most fuel-efficient routes, then the server **120** or vehicle processor **160** may offer a recommendation like, "Based on your driving history over the past month, you could have reduced your fuel/energy consumption by 7% last month had you chosen to take the "most-efficient" route in Maps. This would have only increased your trip time by 4 minutes, on average."

[0069] In one embodiment, the vehicle **104** may analyze the vehicle operating at a slower speed. Most individuals know that driving more slowly and braking gradually may improve fuel economy. But what if we could quantify exactly how much a driver could save in terms of dollars and carbon emissions and share that with them? The application could make recommendations like, "Based on your driving history, we noticed you are driving using fast acceleration. We estimate that if you were to accelerate more gradually, you could save \$30 a month and reduce your carbon

emissions by 13%." The server **120** or the vehicle processor **160** could even compare a driver's fuel economy to other customers in the same geographic area with the same type of vehicle **104**. For example, the application could produce an observation: "Your average fuel economy is lower than 80% of the other RAV4 drivers in your area". In one embodiment, the vehicle processor **160** may request a current vehicle **104** speed from an ECU or other automotive processor of the vehicle **104**. The ECU or other processor may access one or more engine sensors to measure engine revolutions-per-minute (RPMs) and transmission state and calculate current speed therefrom. The ECU or other processor transfers the current speed to the vehicle processor **160**.

[0070] In one embodiment, the vehicle **104** may analyze charging at different times. The cost and carbon emissions of charging an EV/PHEV may vary depending on the time of day a user charges their vehicle **104**. For example, depending upon where you live, it may be most advantageous—from a carbon emissions standpoint—to charge during the day if there is excess solar generation available. On the other hand, if you live in a region of the world with lots of wind energy, it may be best to charge at night. There's also a financial aspect of determining the "best" time to charge a vehicle **104**. For example, depending on the utility provider, it may be less costly to charge a vehicle **104** at night, but the optimal charging time for minimizing cost may or may not align with the optimal charging time for minimizing carbon emissions.

[0071] In one embodiment, the vehicle **104** may take advantage of more "opportunity charging". This may apply solely to PHEV drivers. The server **120** or vehicle processor **160** may analyze typical travel routes and destinations for a given driver and search for public chargers in a same vicinity as their common destinations. For example, the server **120** or vehicle processor **160** may store in an accessible device contact data (e.g., IP address, URL, level 1 charger, level 2 charger, etc.) for other processors associated with charging stations in a given area. The other processors may be servers or other computing devices associated with charging stations. The vehicle processor **160** may obtain the given area from a navigation processor of the vehicle **104** as the destination of a current or an upcoming trip. The application could make a recommendation like, "It looks like you could have taken advantage of charging at this common destination you visit . . . perhaps you're not aware but there's a level 2 charger at the Kroger you visited 6 times last month".

[0072] In one embodiment, the vehicle **104** may consider the type of charger the vehicle **104** uses. This would apply solely to EV and PHEV drivers. Some customers, especially PHEV owners, may not install a level 2 charger in their home right away, even if they have the resources to do so. The customers might feel a level 1 charger is sufficient for their needs. Level 1 chargers, however, are not as efficient as level 2 chargers. Therefore, any customer using a level 1 charger is missing an opportunity to further reduce their carbon emissions. They are also spending more in electricity (as compared to users of level 2 chargers), but the payback period for the installation cost of a level 2 charger must be considered as well. The application could offer suggestions like "We noticed you are using a level 1 charger to charge your RAV4 Prime. Did you know that you could reduce your annual electricity consumption by 300 kWh, or \$40 by

switching to a more efficient level 2 charger? You would also be reducing your annual carbon emissions by 3% or 400 gCO₂eq.”

[0073] In one embodiment, the vehicle 104 may consider defroster usage. For example, the Prius Prime (and perhaps the RAV4 Prime) has a setting that allows the driver to use the defroster at a slightly lower power output, but without turning on the engine. The application could spot trends like this and offer a suggestion to PHEV drivers “We’ve noticed you always use the defroster at full power output. Did you know that in some cases, you may be able to defrost your windshield with battery power alone? Try enabling the eco-defrost mode and avoid starting the gas engine. This would save you X gallons of gas per year and reduce your carbon emissions by 100 gCO₂eq or 10%.”

[0074] In one embodiment, the vehicle 104 may consider air conditioning (A/C) usage. For example, below certain speeds, it may be more efficient to roll down the vehicle’s windows rather than turn on the A/C. The application could analyze a user’s historical driver speeds, outdoor temperature, interior temperature, and A/C usage. The application may determine if a suggestion to roll down windows is warranted. For example, the vehicle processor 160 may request a current measurement for interior temperature, external temperature, and wind speed from an environmental climate processor of the vehicle 104 and window open/closed status and A/C state, and fan speed from various vehicle 104 sensors. The environmental climate processor may respond with the interior temperature, external temperature, and wind speed. The vehicle processor 160 may determine a difference between the interior temperature and the exterior temperature that is below a threshold value (e.g., 10 degrees), and as long as the wind speed is not above a wind threshold (e.g., 15 miles per hour and not gusty), the vehicle processor 160 may recommend lowering one or more windows of the vehicle 104 in lieu of operating the A/C. The application could suggest, “You use A/C even for many low-speed trips. You could reduce your emissions by X if you did not use A/C and instead rolled down your windows.”

[0075] In one embodiment, the vehicle 104 may consider tire pressure. Underinflated tires may reduce vehicle efficiency and therefore increase energy (fuel, electricity) usage and carbon emissions. For example, many vehicles 104 may have tire pressure monitoring systems. If the vehicle processor 160 determines that a customer has driven with underinflated tires for an extended period (e.g., a month), the application could make a suggestion like, “We noticed last month you were driving with underinflated tires. This cost you \$13.56. Please inflate your tires now to improve your mileage and reduce your carbon emissions by 3%”. The vehicle processor 160 may communicate with a processor associated with tire pressures on the vehicle 104, and/or access stored data in memory associated with the vehicle processor 160 to determine historical tire pressure on the vehicle 104.

[0076] In one embodiment, the vehicle 104 may consider unnecessary cargo weight. For example, if there were a way to sense that a customer was hauling around heavy cargo for an extended period, perhaps by estimating the total vehicle mass and subtracting out the expected vehicle mass, the server 120 or vehicle processor 160 could suggest something like “It looks like you’re constantly hauling around a heavy load. This is increasing your fuel costs by X and your carbon

emissions by Y. Is this load something you’ve forgotten about and can it be removed from your vehicle?”. This may be more appropriate for pickup trucks or delivery trucks that routinely haul cargo items. For example, the vehicle processor 160 may obtain load data from sensors associated with each axle of the vehicle 104. The vehicle processor 160 may compare the load data to vehicle 104 empty and maximum load data stored in an accessible memory device. For load data within a % of the maximum load (e.g., 10%), the vehicle processor 160 may suggest removing one or more cargo items from the vehicle 104.

[0077] In one embodiment, the vehicle 104 may consider cruise control usage. The server 120 or vehicle processor 160 may be able to review a route driven by a customer, and estimate if there would have been a reduction in fuel usage had the driver had cruise control enabled over that same route. The application could then suggest usage of cruise control for a particular route and quantify the potential fuel savings. For example, the vehicle processor 160 may obtain and store speed data for a current or recent trip from an ECU of the vehicle 104. Significant variation in speed may indicate inefficient manual speed control by a driver of the vehicle 104, especially where the speed limit is fixed. The vehicle processor 160 may determine fuel usage for the trip by subtracting the remaining fuel at the end of the trip from the fuel in the vehicle 104 at the beginning of the trip. The vehicle processor 160 may store in an accessible memory device a predicted fuel usage amount for different operating speeds of the vehicle 104. The vehicle processor 160 may compare the predicted fuel usage amounts to the fuel usage for the trip and selected a predicted fuel usage amount less than the fuel usage for the trip, and recommend a cruise control speed that corresponds to the selected predicted fuel usage amount.

[0078] In one embodiment, the vehicle 104 may consider garage usage. For example, during the coldest parts of the year, parking a vehicle 104 in a garage may reduce the vehicle’s overall energy usage by either eliminating or reducing the time needed to idle a vehicle 104 and run the defroster. The application could make a suggestion like, “It looks like your car spent a total of 87 minutes last month idling with the defroster running. If you have access to a garage, consider parking there overnight to reduce the need to idle. This could reduce your fuel usage by as much as 5%.”

[0079] In one embodiment, the vehicle 104 may consider an electricity source used to charge a vehicle 104. For example, for PHEV and BEV vehicles, in states where consumers can choose their electricity suppliers, the application can prompt users to consider signing up for an electricity supplier that sources 100% renewable energy.

[0080] In one embodiment, the server 120 may specify a time period 154 (or a period) to the vehicle processor 160. The time period 154 may be stored in a memory device accessible to the server 120, and may reflect an evaluation period for economical behavior data and/or carbon use behavior data. For example, the time period 154 may be a day, a week, a month, a year, and the like. In one embodiment, the memory device coupled to the server 120 may store economical behavior data and/or carbon use behavior data for previous time periods 154. In another embodiment, the vehicle processor 160 may store the time period in an accessible memory device, but may be prompted to determine the economical behavior data 156 and/or the carbon

use behavior data 164 by a notification from the server 120 in lieu of the time period 154 notification.

[0081] In one embodiment, the vehicle processor 160 may receive the time period 154 and determine the economical behavior data 156 for the time period 154, as discussed herein. The vehicle processor 160 may transmit the economical behavior data 158 for the time period 154 to the server 120. The economical behavior data 158 may include an indication of the time period 154, the type and condition of the vehicle 104, and one or more areas of economical impact during the time period 154, such as tire wear, brake wear, fuel mileage, energy cost, and the like.

[0082] The type of the vehicle 104 may include a model year, a manufacturer, a vehicle model and trim level, an engine size, a number of axles, a number of tires, a tire size, a tire type (e.g., all-season radial, snow tires, studded tires, etc.), remaining tire tread life, and/or whether the tires have chains or cables attached. The condition of the vehicle 104 may include a total vehicle mileage, a distance traveled in the time period 154, an indication of factory-recommended maintenance items performed according to the factory maintenance schedule or not performed according to the maintenance schedule, an accident history, and the like.

[0083] The server 120 receives the economical behavior data 158 for the time period 154 and may compare the economical behavior data to an economical impact threshold 162 stored in an accessible memory device. In one embodiment, the economical impact may correspond to a difference between the economical behavior data 158 and the economical impact threshold.

[0084] The economical impact threshold may be a predetermined level that establishes if the cost of operating the vehicle 104 for the time period 154 warrants further determination. For example, the economical impact threshold may reflect “nominal” historical use of the vehicle type and condition of the vehicle 104 associated with the vehicle processor 160. If the server 120 determines the economical impact 158 exceeds the economical impact threshold, the server 120 may perform further economical benefit and recommendation determinations as described herein. If the server 120 determines the economical impact 158 does not exceed the economical impact threshold, the server 120 may take no further actions with benefit and recommendation determinations and store the economical impact 158, the time period 154, and the result of the economical impact comparison 162 to an accessible memory device for use in future determinations.

[0085] In one embodiment, the vehicle processor 160 may determine the carbon use behavior 164 for the time period 154, as discussed herein. The vehicle processor 160 may transmit the carbon use behavior data 166 for the time period 154 to the server 120. The carbon use behavior data 166 may include an indication of the time period 154, the type and condition of the vehicle 104, and one or more areas of carbon impact during the time period 154, such as amount of carbon produced by the vehicle 104, a distance traveled in the time period 154, and performance data for the vehicle 104 (e.g., acceleration, maximum speed, average speed, etc.) in the time period 154.

[0086] The server 120 receives the carbon use behavior data 166 and may compare the carbon use behavior data 166 to a carbon impact threshold 168 stored in an accessible memory device. The carbon impact threshold may be a predetermined level that establishes if the carbon impact of

operating the vehicle 104 for the time period 154 warrants further determination. In one embodiment, the carbon impact may correspond to a difference between the carbon use behavior data 166 and the carbon impact threshold. In one embodiment, the server 120 may store in an accessible memory device one or more thresholds that reflect “nominal” vehicle carbon use for the type and condition of the vehicle 104, as described herein. The server 120 may apply the “nominal” threshold based on the type and condition of the vehicle 104 to the comparison 168.

[0087] If the server 120 determines the carbon use behavior data 166 exceeds the carbon impact threshold, the server 120 may perform further carbon benefit and recommendation determinations as described herein. If the server 120 determines the carbon use behavior 166 does not exceed the carbon impact threshold, the server 120 may take no further actions with benefit and recommendation determinations and store the carbon use behavior data 166, the time period 154, and the result of the carbon impact comparison 168 to an accessible memory device for future determinations.

[0088] In one embodiment, based on the comparison of the economical behavior data to the economical impact threshold 162 and the carbon use behavior data to the carbon impact threshold 168, the server 120 may determine one or more benefits for a future time period 170. In one embodiment, the future time period may be the same as the time period 154. For example, this may beneficially allow benefits for the future period 170 to be compared to benefits for the time period 154. In another embodiment, the future time period may be shorter than the time period 154. For example, the server 120 may determine the difference between the compared economical impact data to the economical impact threshold 162 and/or the compared carbon impact data to the carbon impact threshold 168 is too great to accurately evaluate the economical impact or the carbon impact. For example, when the threshold has a value of ‘10’, there may be insufficient large granularity if the data 158, 166 has a value of ‘100’. In another embodiment, the future time period may be longer than the time period 154. For example, the server 120 may determine the difference between the compared economical behavior data to the economical impact threshold 162 and/or the compared carbon use behavior data to the carbon impact threshold 168 is too small to accurately evaluate the economical impact or the carbon impact. For example, when the threshold has a value of ‘10’ there may be insufficient small granularity if the data 158, 166 has a value of ‘9’. By modifying the future time period, the difference between the compared values 162, 168 may become statistically significant over time.

[0089] In one embodiment, determining the benefit received in the future period 170 may be based on altering the use of the vehicle 104. Determining the benefit 170 based on an altered use may include determining one or more uses of the vehicle 104 in the future period that contribute to one or more of the economical impact and the carbon impact, identifying different one or more uses of other vehicles that contribute to a lower economical impact or lower carbon impact, and associating a benefit with one or more of the lower economical impact or lower carbon impact. In one embodiment, it may be important to compare the vehicle 104 economical behavior data 158 and/or the carbon use behavior data 166 to other comparable vehicles (e.g., type and condition) in order to understand which parameters are likely to produce an economical benefit or a

carbon benefit. Comparable may mean a same/similar type of vehicle, model year, engine size, mileage, condition, or a vehicle operated in a same or similar area (weather, road conditions, speed limits, hilly vs flat, and or the like).

[0090] In one embodiment, determining the benefit received in the future period 170 may be based on using another vehicle. Determining the benefit 170 based on using another vehicle may include determining a future carbon impact for the other vehicle in the future period and associating a benefit with a difference between the carbon impact and a future carbon impact for the other vehicle in the future period.

[0091] In one embodiment, the server 120 may determine a recommendation based on the benefit 172. Determining the recommendation 172 may include identifying one or more uses of the vehicle 140 or the other vehicle for the future period that contributes to the benefit, selecting a use of the vehicle 140 or the other vehicle for the future period that provides a largest contribution to the benefit from the one or more uses, and providing a recommendation to the device 130 based on the selected use. Many uses of the vehicle 104 or the other vehicle may contribute to the benefit. For example, driving at a slower top speed (less speeding), slower acceleration, and softer braking/more coasting may all contribute to lower operating costs. For example, the largest potential gain may be from braking because the brakes may be extended for 6 months if slower braking is used. Therefore, the recommendation to the device 130 may be to use softer braking for the future time period.

[0092] In one embodiment, the server 120 may transmit a notification 174 to the device 130. The notification 174 may include the recommendation 172 and benefit 170 for the future period. The device 130 may receive the recommendation and benefit notification 174 and may notify a user associated with the device 130 of the recommendation and the benefit 176. In one embodiment, the device 130 may display the recommendation and the benefit 174. In another embodiment, the device 130 may audibly present the recommendation and the benefit 174 to a user of the device 130.

[0093] In one embodiment, the server 120 may notify the device 174 associated with the vehicle 104 of the recommendation and the benefit. Notifying the device 130 may include determining the device 130 is associated with an operating entity for the vehicle 104, determining a notification including the recommendation and the benefit, and transmitting the notification to the device 130.

[0094] With the recommendation 172 and the benefit 170 determined by the server 120, the notification must be sent to the proper device 130. Although the vehicle owner's device may be important and the notification 174 may be sent to the owner's devices as well, it may be more important to provide the notification 174 to the device 130 associated with the user who is currently operating the vehicle 104, if not the owner. For example, a business may own a fleet of business vehicles, but the behavioral improvements are likely performed by a driver or operator of the vehicle 104.

[0095] In one embodiment, determining the device 130 is associated with an operating entity for the vehicle 104 may include obtaining an identity of a driver of the vehicle 104 and associating the device 130 with the driver identity. In one embodiment, the vehicle processor 160 may execute a facial recognition application that identifies the driver from an interior camera image. An accessible memory device may

include an association between the driver identity and the driver's device 130. As part of providing the economical behavior data 158 and/or the carbon use behavior data 166, the data may include identification of the driver's device 130.

[0096] In one embodiment, the server 120 may determine the economical impact and the carbon impact are unreliable based on an infrequent use of the vehicle 104 over the period 154, determine a modified use of the vehicle 104 that corresponds to a reliable economical impact and carbon impact, and modify the future period based on the modified use of the vehicle 104. In one embodiment, infrequent use of the vehicle 104 may produce little or no economical behavior data 158 and/or carbon use behavior data 166. This may prevent the server 120 from making an accurate determination of economical impact and/or carbon use impact due to inefficient usage of the vehicle 104. For example, the economical behavior data 158 and/or carbon use behavior data 166 may include a number of days or hours the vehicle 104 was driven in the time period 154. The server 120 may consider analyzing the data only if the vehicle usage 104 satisfies a threshold (e.g., 18 days per month, or more). If the vehicle 104 was used less than the threshold value (e.g., 10 days), the server 120 may determine a modified use of the vehicle 104 should be determined. For example, for 10 days of use, a future period that may allow for reliable data to be analyzed may be days (i.e., 18 days of a nominal 30 day month time period is 60%. 10 days is 60% of approximately 17 days, so the future time period may be 17 days).

[0097] Flow diagrams depicted herein, such as FIG. 1A, FIG. 1B, FIG. 2C, FIG. 2D, FIG. 2E, FIG. 3A, FIG. 3B and FIG. 3C are separate examples but may be the same or different embodiments. Any of the operations in one flow diagram could be adopted and shared with another flow diagram. No example operation is intended to limit the subject matter of any embodiment or corresponding claim.

[0098] It is important to note that all the flow diagrams and corresponding processes are derived from FIG. 1A, FIG. 1i, FIG. 2C, FIG. 2D, FIG. 2E, FIG. 3A, FIG. 3B and FIG. 3C may be part of a same process or may share sub-processes with one another thus making the diagrams combinable into a single preferred embodiment that does not require any one specific operation but which performs certain operations from one example process and from one or more additional processes. All the example processes are related to the same physical system and can be used separately or interchangeably.

[0099] FIG. 2A illustrates a transport network diagram 200, according to example embodiments. The network comprises elements including a transport 202 including a processor 204, as well as a transport 202' including a processor 204'. The transports 202, 202' communicate with one another via the processors 204, 204', as well as other elements (not shown) including transceivers, transmitters, receivers, storage, sensors, and other elements capable of providing communication. The communication between the transports 202, and 202' can occur directly, via a private and/or a public network (not shown), or via other transports and elements comprising one or more of a processor, memory, and software. Although depicted as single transports and processors, a plurality of transports and processors may be present. One or more of the applications, features, steps, solutions, etc., described and/or depicted herein may be utilized and/or provided by the instant elements.

[0100] FIG. 2B illustrates another transport network diagram 210, according to example embodiments. The network comprises elements including a transport 202 including a processor 204, as well as a transport 202' including a processor 204'. The transports 202, 202' communicate with one another via the processors 204, 204', as well as other elements (not shown), including transceivers, transmitters, receivers, storage, sensors, and other elements capable of providing communication. The communication between the transports 202, and 202' can occur directly, via a private and/or a public network (not shown), or via other transports and elements comprising one or more of a processor, memory, and software. The processors 204, 204' can further communicate with one or more elements 230 including sensor 212, wired device 214, wireless device 216, database 218, mobile phone 220, transport 222, computer 224, I/O device 226, and voice application 228. The processors 204, 204' can further communicate with elements comprising one or more of a processor, memory, and software.

[0101] Although depicted as single transports, processors and elements, a plurality of transports, processors and elements may be present. Information or communication can occur to and/or from any of the processors 204, 204' and elements 230. For example, the mobile phone 220 may provide information to the processor 204, which may initiate the transport 202 to take an action, may further provide the information or additional information to the processor 204', which may initiate the transport 202' to take an action, may further provide the information or additional information to the mobile phone 220, the transport 222, and/or the computer 224. One or more of the applications, features, steps, solutions, etc., described and/or depicted herein may be utilized and/or provided by the instant elements.

[0102] FIG. 2C illustrates yet another transport network diagram 240, according to example embodiments. The network comprises elements including a transport 202, a processor 204, and a non-transitory computer readable medium 242C. The processor 204 is communicably coupled to the computer readable medium 242C and elements 230 (which were depicted in FIG. 2B). The transport 202 could be a transport, server, or any device with a processor and memory.

[0103] The processor 204 performs one or more of determining an economical impact and a carbon impact based on a use of a vehicle over a period 244C, determining a benefit received in a future period similar to the period of one or more of altering the use of the vehicle and using another vehicle 246C, determining a recommendation, based on the benefit 248C, and notifying a device associated with the vehicle, of the recommendation and the benefit 250C.

[0104] FIG. 2D illustrates a further transport network diagram 250, according to example embodiments. The network comprises elements including a transport 202 a processor 204, and a non-transitory computer readable medium 242D. The processor 204 is communicably coupled to the computer readable medium 242D and elements 230 (which were depicted in FIG. 2B). The transport 202 could be a transport, server or any device with a processor and memory.

[0105] The processor 204 performs one or more of receiving economical behavior data for the period from the vehicle and comparing the economical behavior data to an economical impact threshold 244D, receiving carbon use behavior data for the period from the vehicle and comparing the carbon use behavior data to a carbon impact threshold 245D,

determining one or more uses of the vehicle in the future period that contribute to one or more of the economical impact and the carbon impact, identifying different one or more uses of other vehicles that contribute to a lower economical impact or lower carbon impact, and associating a benefit with one or more of the lower economical impact or lower carbon impact 246D, determining a future carbon impact for the other vehicle in the future period and associating a benefit with a difference between the carbon impact and a future carbon impact for the other vehicle in the future period 247D, identifying one or more uses of the vehicle or the other vehicle for the future period that contributes to the benefit, selecting a use of the vehicle or the other vehicle for the future period that provides a largest contribution to the benefit from the one or more uses, and providing a recommendation to the device based on the selected use 248D, and determining the device is associated with an operating entity for the vehicle, determining a notification including the recommendation and the benefit, and transmitting the notification to the device 249D.

[0106] FIG. 2E illustrates yet a further transport network diagram 260, according to example embodiments. Referring to FIG. 2E, the network diagram 260 includes a transport 202 connected to other transports 202' and to an update server node 203 over a blockchain network 206. The transports 202 and 202' may represent transports/vehicles. The blockchain network 206 may have a ledger 208 for storing software update validation data and a source 207 of the validation for future use (e.g., for an audit).

[0107] While this example describes in detail only one transport 202, multiple such nodes may be connected to the blockchain 206. It should be understood that the transport 202 may include additional components and that some of the components described herein may be removed and/or modified without departing from a scope of the instant application. The transport 202 may have a computing device or a server computer, or the like, and may include a processor 204, which may be a semiconductor-based microprocessor, a central processing unit (CPU), an application-specific integrated circuit (ASIC), a field-programmable gate array (FPGA), and/or another hardware device. Although a single processor 204 is depicted, it should be understood that the transport 202 may include multiple processors, multiple cores, or the like without departing from the scope of the instant application. The transport 202 could be a transport, server or any device with a processor and memory.

[0108] The processor 204 performs one or more of receiving a confirmation of an event from one or more elements described or depicted herein, wherein the confirmation comprises a blockchain consensus between peers represented by any of the elements 244E and executing a smart contract to record the confirmation on a blockchain-based on the blockchain consensus 246E. Consensus is formed between one or more of any element 230 and/or any element described or depicted herein, including a transport, a server, a wireless device, etc. In another example, the transport 202 can be one or more of any element 230 and/or any element described or depicted herein, including a server, a wireless device, etc.

[0109] The processors and/or computer readable medium 242E may fully or partially reside in the interior or exterior of the transports. The steps or features stored in the computer readable medium 242E may be fully or partially performed by any of the processors and/or elements in any order.

Additionally, one or more steps or features may be added, omitted, combined, performed at a later time, etc.

[0110] FIG. 2F illustrates a diagram 265 depicting the electrification of one or more elements. In one example, a transport 266 may provide power stored in its batteries to one or more elements, including other transport(s) 268, charging station(s) 270, and electric grid(s) 272. The electric grid(s) 272 is/are coupled to one or more of the charging stations 270, which may be coupled to one or more of the transports 268. This configuration allows the distribution of electricity/power received from the transport 266. The transport 266 may also interact with the other transport(s) 268, such as via Vehicle to Vehicle (V2V) technology, communication over cellular, WiFi, and the like. The transport 266 may also interact wirelessly and/or wired with other transports 268, the charging station(s) 270 and/or with the electric grid(s) 272. In one example, the transport 266 is routed (or routes itself) in a safe and efficient manner to the electric grid(s) 272, the charging station(s) 270, or the other transport(s) 268. Using one or more embodiments of the instant solution, the transport 266 can provide energy to one or more of the elements depicted herein in various advantageous ways as described and/or depicted herein. Further, the safety and efficiency of the transport may be increased, and the environment may be positively affected as described and/or depicted herein.

[0111] The term ‘energy’ may be used to denote any form of energy received, stored, used, shared, and/or lost by the transport(s). The energy may be referred to in conjunction with a voltage source and/or a current supply of charge provided from an entity to the transport(s) during a charge/use operation. Energy may also be in the form of fossil fuels (for example, for use with a hybrid transport) or via alternative power sources, including but not limited to lithium-based, nickel-based, hydrogen fuel cells, atomic/nuclear energy, fusion-based energy sources, and energy generated on-the-fly during an energy sharing and/or usage operation for increasing or decreasing one or more transports energy levels at a given time.

[0112] In one example, the charging station 270 manages the amount of energy transferred from the transport 266 such that there is sufficient charge remaining in the transport 266 to arrive at a destination. In one example, a wireless connection is used to wirelessly direct an amount of energy transfer between transports 268, wherein the transports may both be in motion. In one embodiment, wireless charging may occur via a fixed charger and batteries of the transport in alignment with one another (such as a charging mat in a garage or parking space). In one example, an idle vehicle, such as a vehicle 266 (which may be autonomous) is directed to provide an amount of energy to a charging station 270 and return to the original location (for example, its original location or a different destination). In one example, a mobile energy storage unit (not shown) is used to collect surplus energy from at least one other transport 268 and transfer the stored surplus energy at a charging station 270. In one example, factors determine an amount of energy to transfer to a charging station 270, such as distance, time, as well as traffic conditions, road conditions, environmental/weather conditions, the vehicle’s condition (weight, etc.), an occupant(s) schedule while utilizing the vehicle, a prospective occupant(s) schedule waiting for the vehicle, etc. In one

example, the transport(s) 268, the charging station(s) 270 and/or the electric grid(s) 272 can provide energy to the transport 266.

[0113] In one embodiment, a location such as a building, a residence, or the like (not depicted), communicably coupled to one or more of the electric grid 272, the transport 266, and/or the charging station(s) 270. The rate of electric flow to one or more of the location, the transport 266, the other transport(s) 268 is modified, depending on external conditions, such as weather. For example, when the external temperature is extremely hot or extremely cold, raising the chance for an outage of electricity, the flow of electricity to a connected vehicle 266/268 is slowed to help minimize the chance for an outage.

[0114] In one example, the solutions described and depicted herein can be utilized to determine load effects on the transport and/or the system, to provide energy to the transport and/or the system based on future needs and/or priorities, and provide intelligence between an apparatus containing a module and a vehicle allowing the processor of the apparatus to wirelessly communicate with a vehicle regarding an amount of energy store in a battery on the vehicle. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to provide charge to a location from a transport based on factors such as the temperature at the location, the cost of the energy, and the power level at the location. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to manage an amount of energy remaining in a transport after a portion of the charge has been transferred to a charging station. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to notify a vehicle to provide an amount of energy from batteries on the transport, wherein the amount of energy to transfer is based on the distance of the transport to a module to receive the energy.

[0115] In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to use a mobile energy storage unit that uses a determined path to travel to transports with excess energy and deposit the stored energy into the electric grid. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to determine a priority of the transport’s determination of the need to provide energy to grid and the priority of a current need of the transport, such as the priority of a passenger or upcoming passenger, or current cargo, or upcoming cargo. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to determine that when a vehicle is idle, the vehicle decides to maneuver to a location to discharge excess energy to the energy grid, then return to the previous location. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to determine an amount of energy needed by a transport to provide another transport with needed energy via transport to transport energy transfer based on one or more conditions such as weather, traffic, road conditions, car conditions, and occupants and/or goods in another transport, and instruct the transport to route to another transport and provide the energy. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to transfer energy from one vehicle in motion to another vehicle in motion. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to retrieve energy by a transport based on an expended energy by the transport to reach a meeting location with another transport, provide a service, and an estimated expended energy to return to an original location. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to provide a remaining distance needed to a charging station and the charging station to determine an amount of energy to be retrieved from the transport wherein the amount of charge remaining is based on the remaining distance. In one

example, the solutions can also be utilized to manage a transport that is concurrently charged by more than one point simultaneously, such as both a charging station via a wired connection and another transport via a wireless connection. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to apply a priority to the dispensing of energy to transports wherein a priority is given to those transports that will provide a portion of their stored charge to another entity such as an electric grid, a residence, and the like.

[0116] In one embodiment, transports **266** and **268** may be utilized as bidirectional transports. Bidirectional transports are those that may serve as mobile microgrids that can assist in the supplying of electrical power to the grid **272** and/or reduce the power consumption when the grid is stressed. Bidirectional transports incorporate bidirectional charging, which in addition to receiving a charge to the transport, the transport can take energy from the transport and “push” the energy back into the grid **272**, otherwise referred to as “V2G”. In bidirectional charging, the electricity flows both ways; to the transport and from the transport. When a transport is charged, alternating current (AC) electricity from the grid **272** is converted to direct current (DC). This may be performed by one or more of the transport’s own converter or a converter on the charger **270**. The energy stored in the transport’s batteries may be sent in an opposite direction back to the grid. The energy is converted from DC to AC through a converter usually located in the charger **270**, otherwise referred to as a bidirectional charger. Further, the instant solution as described and depicted with respect to FIG. 2F can be utilized in this and other networks and/or systems.

[0117] FIG. 2G is a diagram showing interconnections between different elements **275**. The instant solution may be stored and/or executed entirely or partially on and/or by one or more computing devices **278'**, **279'**, **281'**, **282'**, **283'**, **284'**, **276'**, **285'**, **287'** and **277'** associated with various entities, all communicably coupled and in communication with a network **286**. A database **287** is communicably coupled to the network and allows for the storage and retrieval of data. In one example, the database is an immutable ledger. One or more of the various entities may be a transport **276**, one or more service provider **279**, one or more public buildings **281**, one or more traffic infrastructure **282**, one or more residential dwellings **283**, an electric grid/charging station **284**, a microphone **285**, and/or another transport **277**. Other entities and/or devices, such as one or more private users using a smartphone **278**, a laptop **280**, an augmented reality (AR) device, a virtual reality (VR) device, and/or any wearable device may also interwork with the instant solution. The smartphone **278**, laptop **280**, the microphone **285**, and other devices may be connected to one or more of the connected computing devices **278'**, **279'**, **281'**, **282'**, **283'**, **284'**, **276'**, **285'**, **287'**, and **277'**. The one or more public buildings **281** may include various agencies. The one or more public buildings **281** may utilize a computing device **281'**. The one or more service provider **279** may include a dealership, a tow truck service, a collision center or other repair shop. The one or more service provider **279** may utilize a computing apparatus **279'**. These various computer devices may be directly and/or communicably coupled to one another, such as via wired networks, wireless networks, blockchain networks, and the like. The microphone **285** may be utilized as a virtual assistant, in one example. In one example, the one or more traffic infrastructure **282** may

include one or more traffic signals, one or more sensors including one or more cameras, vehicle speed sensors or traffic sensors, and/or other traffic infrastructure. The one or more traffic infrastructure **282** may utilize a computing device **282'**.

[0118] In one embodiment, anytime an electrical charge is given or received to/from a charging station and/or an electrical grid, the entities that allow that to occur are one or more of a vehicle, a charging station, a server, and a network communicably coupled to the vehicle, the charging station, and the electrical grid.

[0119] In one example, a transport **277/276** can transport a person, an object, a permanently or temporarily affixed apparatus, and the like. In one example, the transport **277** may communicate with transport **276** via V2V communication through the computers associated with each transport **276'** and **277'** and may be referred to as a transport, car, vehicle, automobile, and the like. The transport **276/277** may be a self-propelled wheeled conveyance, such as a car, a sports utility vehicle, a truck, a bus, a van, or other motor or battery-driven or fuel cell-driven transport. For example, transport **276/277** may be an electric vehicle, a hybrid vehicle, a hydrogen fuel cell vehicle, a plug-in hybrid vehicle, or any other type of vehicle with a fuel cell stack, a motor, and/or a generator. Other examples of vehicles include bicycles, scooters, trains, planes, boats, and any other form of conveyance that is capable of transportation. The transport **276/277** may be semi-autonomous or autonomous. For example, transport **276/277** may be self-manuevering and navigate without human input. An autonomous vehicle may have and use one or more sensors and/or a navigation unit to drive autonomously.

[0120] In one example, the solutions described and depicted herein can be utilized to determine an access to a transport via consensus of blockchain. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to perform profile validation before allowing an occupant to use a transport. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to have the transport indicate (visually, but also verbally in another example, etc.) on or from the transport for an action the user needs to perform (that could be pre-recorded) and verify that it is the correct action. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to provide an ability to for a transport to determine, based on the risk level associated with data and driving environment, how to bifurcate the data and distribute a portion of the bifurcated data with a lower risk level during a safe driving environment, to the occupant, and later distributing a remaining portion of the bifurcated data, with a higher risk level, to the occupant after the occupant has departed the transport. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to handle the transfer of a vehicle across boundaries (such as a country/state/etc.) through the use of blockchain and/or smart contracts and apply the rules of the new area to the vehicle.

[0121] In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to allow a transport to continue to operate outside a boundary when a consensus is reached by the transport based on the operation of the transport and characteristics of an occupant of the transport. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to analyze the available data upload/download speed of a transport, size of the file, and speed/direction the transport is traveling to determine the distance needed to complete a data upload/download and assign a secure area boundary for the data upload/download to be executed. In

one example, the solutions can also be utilized to perform a normally dangerous maneuver in a safe manner, such as when the system determines that an exit is upcoming and when the transport is seemingly not prepared to exit (e.g., in the incorrect lane or traveling at a speed that is not conducive to making the upcoming exit) and instruct the subject transport as well as other proximate transports to allow the subject transport to exit in a safe manner. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to use one or more vehicles to validate diagnostics of another transport while both the one or more vehicles and the other transport are in motion.

[0122] In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to detect lane usage at a location and time of day to either inform an occupant of a transport or direct the transport to recommend or not recommend a lane change. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to eliminate the need to send information through the mail and the need for a driver/occupant to respond by making a payment through the mail or in person. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to provide a service to an occupant of a transport, wherein the service provided is based on a subscription and wherein the permission is acquired from other transports connected to the profile of the occupant. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to record changes in the condition of a rented object. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to seek a blockchain consensus from other transports that are in proximity to a damaged transport. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to receive media, from a server such as an insurance entity server, from the transport computer, which may be related to an accident. The server accesses one or more media files to access the damage to the transport and stores the damage assessment onto a blockchain. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to obtain a consensus to determine the severity of an event from several devices over various times before the event related to a transport.

[0123] In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to solve a problem without video evidence for transport-related accidents. The current solution details the querying of media, by the transport involved in the accident, related to the accident from other transports that may have been proximate to the accident. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to utilize transports and other devices (for example, a pedestrian's cell phone, a streetlight camera, etc.) to record specific portions of a damaged transport.

[0124] In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to warn an occupant when a transport is navigating toward a dangerous area and/or event, allowing for a transport to notify occupants or a central controller of a potentially dangerous area on or near the current transport route. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to detect when a transport traveling at a high rate of speed, at least one other transport is used to assist in slowing down the transport in a manner that minimally affects traffic. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to identify a dangerous driving situation where media is captured by the vehicle involved in the dangerous driving situation. A geofence is established based on the distance of the dangerous driving situation, and additional media is captured by at least one other vehicle within the established geofence. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to send a notification to one or more occupants of a transport that that transport is approaching a traffic control marking on a road, then if a transport crosses a marking, receiving indications of poor driving from other,

nearby transports. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to make a transport partially inoperable by (in certain embodiments), limiting speed, limiting the ability to be near another vehicle, limiting speed to a maximum, and allowing only a given number of miles allowed per time period.

[0125] In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to overcome a need for reliance on software updates to correct issues with a transport when the transport is not being operated correctly. Through observing other transports on a route, a server will receive data from potentially multiple other transports observing an unsafe or incorrect operation of a transport. Through analysis, these observations may result in a notification to the transport when the data suggest an unsafe or incorrect operation. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to notify between a transport and a potentially dangerous situation involving a person external to the transport. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to send data to a server by devices either associated with an accident with a transport, or devices proximate to the accident. Based on the severity of the accident or near accident, the server notifies the senders of the data. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to provide recommendations for operating a transport to either a driver or occupant of a transport based on the data analysis. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to establish a geofence associated with a physical structure and determine payment responsibility to the transport. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to coordinate the ability to drop off a vehicle at a location using both the current state at the location and a proposed future state using navigation destinations of other vehicles. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to coordinate the ability to automatically arrange for the drop off of a vehicle at a location such as a transport rental entity.

[0126] In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to move transport to another location based on a user's event. More particularly, the system tracks a user's device and modifies the transport to be moved proximate to the user upon the conclusion of the original event or a modified event. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to allow for the validation of available locations within an area through the existing transports within the area. The approximate time when a location may be vacated is also determined based on verifications from the existing transports. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to move a transport to closer parking spaces as one becomes available and the elapsed time since initially parking is less than the average event time. Furthermore, moving the transport to a final parking space when the event is completed or according to a location of a device associated with at least one occupant of the transport. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to plan for the parking before the upcoming crowd. The system interacts with the transport to offer some services at a less than full price and/or guide the transport to alternative parking locations based on a priority of the transport, increasing optimization of the parking situation before arriving.

[0127] In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to sell fractional ownership in transports or determine pricing and availability in ride-sharing applications. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to provide accurate and timely reports of dealership sales activities well beyond what is currently available. In one example, the

solutions can also be utilized to allow a dealership to request an asset over the blockchain. By using the blockchain, a consensus is obtained before any asset is moved. Additionally, the process is automated, and payment may be initiated over the blockchain. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to arrange agreements that are made with multiple entities (such as service centers) wherein a consensus is acquired and an action performed (such as diagnostics). In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to associate digital keys with multiple users. A first user may be the transport operator, and a second user is a responsible party for the transport. These keys are authorized by a server where the proximity of the keys is validated against the location of a service provider. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to determine a needed service on a transport destination. One or more service locations are located that can provide the needed service that is both within an area on route to the destination and has availability to perform the service. The navigation of the transport is updated with the determined service location. A smart contract is identified that contains a compensation value for the service, and a blockchain transaction is stored in a distributed ledger for the transaction.

[0128] In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to interfacing a service provider transport with a profile of an occupant of a transport to determine services and goods which may be of interest to occupants in a transport. These services and goods are determined by an occupant's history and/or preferences. The transport then receives offers from the service provider transport and, in another example, meets the transport to provide the service/good. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to detect a transport within a range and send a service offer to the transport (such as a maintenance offer, a product offer, or the like). An agreement is made between the system and the transport, and a service provider is selected by the system to provide the agreement. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to assign one or more transports as a roadway manager, where the roadway manager assists in controlling traffic. The roadway manager may generate a roadway indicator (such as lights, displays, and sounds) to assist in the flow of traffic. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to alert a driver of a transport by a device, wherein the device may be the traffic light or near an intersection. The alert is sent upon an event, such as when a light turns green, and the transport in the front of a list of transports does not move.

[0129] FIG. 2H is another block diagram showing interconnections between different elements in one example **290**. A transport **276** is presented and includes ECUs **295**, **296**, and a Head Unit (otherwise known as an Infotainment System) **297**. An Electrical Control Unit (ECU) is an embedded system in automotive electronics controlling one or more of the electrical systems or subsystems in a transport. ECUs may include but are not limited to the management of a transport's engine, brake system, gearbox system, door locks, dashboard, airbag system, infotainment system, electronic differential, and active suspension. ECUs are connected to the transport's Controller Area Network (CAN) bus **294**. The ECUs may also communicate with a transport computer **298** via the CAN bus **294**. The transport's processors/sensors (such as the transport computer) **298** can communicate with external elements, such as a server **293** via a network **292** (such as the Internet). Each ECU **295**,

296, and Head Unit **297** may contain its own security policy. The security policy defines permissible processes that can be executed in the proper context. In one example, the security policy may be partially or entirely provided in the transport computer **298**.

[0130] ECUs **295**, **296**, and Head Unit **297** may each include a custom security functionality element **299** defining authorized processes and contexts within which those processes are permitted to run. Context-based authorization to determine validity if a process can be executed allows ECUs to maintain secure operation and prevent unauthorized access from elements such as the transport's Controller Area Network (CAN Bus). When an ECU encounters a process that is unauthorized, that ECU can block the process from operating. Automotive ECUs can use different contexts to determine whether a process is operating within its permitted bounds, such as proximity contexts such as nearby objects, distance to approaching objects, speed, and trajectory relative to other moving objects, and operational contexts such as an indication of whether the transport is moving or parked, the transport's current speed, the transmission state, user-related contexts such as devices connected to the transport via wireless protocols, use of the infotainment, cruise control, parking assist, driving assist, location-based contexts, and/or other contexts.

[0131] In one example, the solutions described and depicted herein can be utilized to make a transport partially inoperable by (in certain embodiments), limiting speed, limiting the ability to be near another vehicle, limiting speed to a maximum, and allowing only a given number of miles allowed per time period. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to use a blockchain to facilitate the exchange of vehicle possession wherein data is sent to a server by devices either associated with an accident with a transport, or devices proximate to the accident. Based on the severity of the accident or near accident, the server notifies the senders of the data. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to help the transport to avoid accidents, such as when the transport is involved in an accident by a server that queries other transports that are proximate to the accident. The server seeks to obtain data from the other transports, allowing the server to understand the nature of the accident from multiple vantage points. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to determine that sounds from a transport are atypical and transmit data related to the sounds and a possible source location to a server wherein the server can determine possible causes and avoid a potentially dangerous situation. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to establish a location boundary via the system when a transport is involved in an accident. This boundary is based on decibels associated with the accident. Multimedia content for a device within the boundary is obtained to assist in further understanding the scenario of the accident. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to associate a vehicle with an accident, then capture media obtained by devices proximate to the location of the accident. The captured media is saved as a media segment. The media segment is sent to another computing device which builds a sound profile of the accident. This sound profile will assist in understanding more details surrounding the accident.

[0132] In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to utilize sensors to record audio, video, motion, etc. to record an area where a potential event has occurred, such as if a transport comes in contact or may come in contact with

another transport (while moving or parked), the system captures data from the sensors which may reside on one or more of the transports and/or on fixed or mobile objects. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to determine that a transport has been damaged by using sensor data to identify a new condition of the transport during a transport event and comparing the condition to a transport condition profile, making it possible to safely and securely capture critical data from a transport that is about to be engaged in a detrimental event.

[0133] In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to warn occupants of a transport when the transport, via one or more sensors, has determined that it is approaching or going down a one-way road the incorrect way. The transport has sensors/cameras/maps interacting with the system of the current solution. The system knows the geographic location of one-way streets. The system may audibly inform the occupants, “Approaching a one-way street,” for example. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to allow the transport to get paid, allowing autonomous vehicle owners to monetize the data their vehicle sensors collect and store, creating an incentive for vehicle owners to share their data and provide entities with additional data through which to improve the performance of future vehicles, provide services to the vehicle owners, etc.

[0134] In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to either increase or decrease a vehicle’s features according to the action of the vehicle over a period of time. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to assign a fractional ownership to a transport. Sensor data related to one or more transports and a device proximate to the transport are used to determine a condition of the transport. The fractional ownership of the transport is determined based on the condition, and a new transport responsibility is provided. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to provide data to a replacement/upfitting component, wherein the data attempts to subvert an authorized functionality of the replacement/upfitting component, and responsive to a non-subversion of the authorized functionality, permitting, by the component, use of the authorized functionality of the replacement/upfitting component.

[0135] In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to provide individuals the ability to ensure that an occupant should be in a transport and for that occupant to reach a particular destination. Further, the system ensures a driver (if a non-autonomous transport) and/or other occupants are authorized to interact with the occupant. Also, pickups, drop-offs and location are noted. All of the above are stored in an immutable fashion on a blockchain. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to determine the characteristics of a driver via an analysis of driving style and other elements to take action if the driver is not driving in a normal manner, such as a manner in which the driver has previously driven in a particular condition, for example during the day, at night, in the rain, in the snow, etc. Further, the attributes of the transport are also taken into account. Attributes include weather, whether the headlights are on, whether navigation is being used, a HUD is being used, the volume of media being played, etc. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to notify occupants in a transport of a dangerous situation when items inside the transport signify that the occupants may not be aware of the dangerous situation.

[0136] In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to mount calibration devices on a rig that is fixed to a vehicle, wherein the various sensors on the transport can automatically self-adjust based on what should be detected by the calibration devices as compared to what is actually detected. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to use a blockchain to require consensus from a plurality of service centers when a transport needing service sends malfunction information allowing remote diagnostic functionality wherein a consensus is required from other service centers on what a severity threshold is for the data. Once the consensus is received, the service center may send the malfunction security level to the blockchain to be stored. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to determine a difference in sensor data external to the transport and the transport’s own sensor data. The transport requests, from a server, a software to rectify the issue. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to allow for the messaging of transports that are either nearby or in the area when an event occurs (e.g., a collision).

[0137] Referring to FIG. 2I, an operating environment **290A** for a connected transport, is illustrated according to some embodiments. As depicted, the transport **276** includes a Controller Area Network (CAN) bus **291A** connecting elements **292A-299A** of the transport. Other elements may be connected to the CAN bus and are not depicted herein. The depicted elements connected to the CAN bus include a sensor set **292A**, Electronic Control Units **293A**, autonomous features or Advanced Driver Assistance Systems (ADAS) **294A**, and the navigation system **295A**. In some embodiments, the transport **276** includes a processor **296A**, a memory **297A**, a communication unit **298A**, and an electronic display **299A**.

[0138] The processor **296A** includes an arithmetic logic unit, a microprocessor, a general-purpose controller, and/or a similar processor array to perform computations and provide electronic display signals to a display unit **299A**. The processor **296A** processes data signals and may include various computing architectures, including a complex instruction set computer (CISC) architecture, a reduced instruction set computer (RISC) architecture, or an architecture implementing a combination of instruction sets. The transport **276** may include one or more processors **296A**. Other processors, operating systems, sensors, displays, and physical configurations that are communicably coupled to one another (not depicted) may be used with the instant solution.

[0139] Memory **297A** is a non-transitory memory storing instructions or data that may be accessed and executed by the processor **296A**. The instructions and/or data may include code to perform the techniques described herein. The memory **297A** may be a dynamic random-access memory (DRAM) device, a static random-access memory (SRAM) device, flash memory, or another memory device. In some embodiments, the memory **297A** also may include non-volatile memory or a similar permanent storage device and media, which may include a hard disk drive, a floppy disk drive, a CD-ROM device, a DVD-ROM device, a DVD-RAM device, a DVD-RW device, a flash memory device, or some other mass storage device for storing information on a permanent basis. A portion of the memory **297A** may be reserved for use as a buffer or virtual random-

access memory (virtual RAM). The transport **276** may include one or more memories **297A** without deviating from the current solution.

[0140] The memory **297A** of the transport **276** may store one or more of the following types of data: navigation route data **295A**, and autonomous features data **294A**. In some embodiments, the memory **297A** stores data that may be necessary for the navigation application **295A** to provide the functions.

[0141] The navigation system **295A** may describe at least one navigation route including a start point and an endpoint. In some embodiments, the navigation system **295A** of the transport **276** receives a request from a user for navigation routes wherein the request includes a starting point and an ending point. The navigation system **295A** may query a real-time data server **293** (via a network **292**), such as a server that provides driving directions, for navigation route data corresponding to navigation routes, including the start point and the endpoint. The real-time data server **293** transmits the navigation route data to the transport **276** via a wireless network **292**, and the communication system **298A** stores the navigation data **295A** in the memory **297A** of the transport **276**.

[0142] The ECU **293A** controls the operation of many of the systems of the transport **276**, including the ADAS systems **294A**. The ECU **293A** may, responsive to instructions received from the navigation system **295A**, deactivate any unsafe and/or unselected autonomous features for the duration of a journey controlled by the ADAS systems **294A**. In this way, the navigation system **295A** may control whether ADAS systems **294A** are activated or enabled so that they may be activated for a given navigation route.

[0143] The sensor set **292A** may include any sensors in the transport **276** generating sensor data. For example, the sensor set **292A** may include short-range sensors and long-range sensors. In some embodiments, the sensor set **292A** of the transport **276** may include one or more of the following vehicle sensors: a camera, a Lidar sensor, an ultrasonic sensor, an automobile engine sensor, a radar sensor, a laser altimeter, a manifold absolute pressure sensor, an infrared detector, a motion detector, a thermostat, a sound detector, a carbon monoxide sensor, a carbon dioxide sensor, an oxygen sensor, a mass airflow sensor, an engine coolant temperature sensor, a throttle position sensor, a crankshaft position sensor, a valve timer, an air-fuel ratio meter, a blind spot meter, a curb feeler, a defect detector, a Hall effect sensor, a parking sensor, a radar gun, a speedometer, a speed sensor, a tire-pressure monitoring sensor, a torque sensor, a transmission fluid temperature sensor, a turbine speed sensor (TSS), a variable reluctance sensor, a vehicle speed sensor (VSS), a water sensor, a wheel speed sensor, a GPS sensor, a mapping functionality, and any other type of automotive sensor. The navigation system **295A** may store the sensor data in the memory **297A**.

[0144] The communication unit **298A** transmits and receives data to and from the network **292** or to another communication channel. In some embodiments, the communication unit **298A** may include a DSRC transceiver, a DSRC receiver, and other hardware or software necessary to make the transport **276** a DSRC-equipped device.

[0145] The transport **276** may interact with other transports **277** via V2V technology. V2V communication includes sensing radar information corresponding to relative distances to external objects, receiving GPS information of

the transports, setting areas as areas where the other transports **277** are located based on the sensed radar information, calculating probabilities that the GPS information of the object vehicles will be located at the set areas, and identifying transports and/or objects corresponding to the radar information and the GPS information of the object vehicles based on the calculated probabilities, in one example.

[0146] In one example, the solutions described and depicted herein can be utilized to manage emergency scenarios and transport features when a transport is determined to be entering an area without network access. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to manage and provide features in a transport (such as audio, video, navigation, etc.) without network connection. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to determine when a profile of a person in proximity to the transport matches profile attributes of a profile of at least one occupant in the transport. A notification is sent from the transport to establish communication.

[0147] In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to analyze the availability of occupants in respective transports that are available for a voice communication based on an amount of time remaining in the transport and context of the communication to be performed. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to determine two levels of threat of roadway obstruction and receiving a gesture that may indicate that the obstruction is not rising to an alert above a threshold, and proceeding, by the transport along the roadway. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to delete sensitive data from a transport when the transport has had damage such that it is rendered unable to be used.

[0148] In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to verify that the customer data to be removed has truly been removed from all of the required locations within the enterprise, demonstrating GDPR compliance. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to provide consideration from one transport to another transport in exchange for data related to safety, important notifications, etc. to enhance the autonomous capabilities of the lower-level autonomous vehicle. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to provide an ability for a transport to receive data based on a first biometric associated with an occupant. Then the transport unencrypts the encrypted data based on a verification of a second biometric, wherein the second biometric is a continuum of the first biometric. The transport provides the unencrypted data to the occupant when only the occupant can receive the unencrypted data and deletes a sensitive portion of the unencrypted data as the sensitive portion is being provided and a non-sensitive portion after a period of time associated with the biometric elapses. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to provide an ability for a transport to validate an individual based on a weight and grip pressure applied to the steering wheel of the transport. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to provide a feature to a car that exists but is not currently enabled, presenting features to an occupant of the automobile that reflects the occupant's characteristics.

[0149] In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to allow for the modification of a transport, particularly the interior of the transport and the exterior of the transport to reflect and assist at least one occupant, in one example. In another example, recreating an occupant's work and/or home environment is disclosed. The system may attempt to "recreate" the user's work/home environment while the user

is in the transport if it determines that the user is in “work mode” or “home mode”. All data relating to the interior and exterior of the transport as well as the various occupants utilizing the transport are stored on a blockchain and executed via smart contracts. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to detect occupant gestures to assist in communicating with nearby transports wherein the transport may maneuver accordingly. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to provide the ability for a transport to detect intended gestures using a gesture definition datastore. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to provide an ability for a transport to take various actions based on a gait and a user’s gesture. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to ensure that a driver of a transport that is currently engaged in various operations (for example, driving while talking with navigation on, etc.) does not exceed an unsafe number of operations before being permitted to gesture.

[0150] In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to assign a status to each occupant in a transport and validating a gesture from an occupant based on the occupant’s status. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to collect details of sound related to a collision (in what location, in what direction, rising or falling, from what device, data associated with the device such as type, manufacturer, owner, as well as the number of contemporaneous sounds, and the times the sounds were emanated, etc.) and provide to the system where analysis of the data assists in determining details regarding the collision. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to determine whether a transport is unsafe to operate. The transport includes multiple components that interoperate to control the transport, and each component is associated with a separate component key. A cryptographic key is sent to the transport to decrease transport functionality. In response to receiving the cryptographic key, the transport disables one or more of the component keys. Disabling the one or more component keys results in one or more of limiting the transport to not move greater than a given speed, limiting the transport to not come closer than a distance to another transport, and limiting the transport to not travel greater than a threshold distance.

[0151] In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to provide an indication from one specific transport (that is about to vacate a location) to another specific transport (that is seeking to occupy a location), a blockchain is used to perform authentication and coordination. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to determine a fractional responsibility for a transport. Such as the case where multiple people own a single transport, and the use of the transport, which may change over a period of time, is used by the system to update the fractional ownership. Other embodiments will be included in the application, including a minimal ownership of a transport based on not the use of the transport but the availability of the transport, and the determination of the driver of the transport as well as others.

[0152] In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to permit in a transport a user to his/her subscriptions with a closed group of people such as family members or friends. For example, a user might want to share a membership, and if so, associated transactions are stored in a blockchain or traditional database. When the subscribed materials are requested by a user, who is not a primary subscriber, a blockchain node (i.e., a transport) can verify that a person requesting a service is an authorized person with whom the

subscriber has shared the profile. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to allow a person to utilize supplemental transport(s) to arrive at an intended destination. A functional relationship value (e.g., value that indicates the various parameters and their importance in determining what type of alternate transport to utilize) is used in determining the supplemental transport. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to allow the occupants in an accident to access other transports to continue to their initial destination.

[0153] In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to propagate a software/firmware upload to a first subset of transports. This first set of transports tests the update, and when the test is successful, the update is propagated to a further set of transports. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to propagate software/firmware updates to vehicles from a master transport where the update is propagated through the network of vehicles from a first subset, then a larger subset, etc. A portion of the update may be first sent, then the remaining portion sent from the same or another vehicle. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to provide an update for a transport’s computer to the transport and a transport operator’s/occupant’s device. The update is maybe authorized by all drivers and/or all occupants. The software update is provided to the vehicle and the device(s). The user does not have to do anything but go proximate to the vehicle and the functionality automatically occurs. A notification is sent to the device(s) indicating that the software update is completed. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to validate that an OTA software update is performed by a qualified technician and generation, by the one or more transport components, of a status related to an originator of the validation code, a procedure for wirelessly receiving the software update, information contained in the software update, and results of the validation.

[0154] In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to provide the ability to parse a software update located in a first component by a second component. Then verifying the first portion of critical updates and a second portion of non-critical updates, assigning the verified first portion to one process in the transport, running the verified first portion with the one process for a period of time, and responsive to positive results based on the period of time, running the verified first portion with other processes after the period of time. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to provide a selection of services to an occupant where the services are based on a profile of an occupant of the transport, and a shared profile that is shared with the profile of the occupant. In one example, the solutions can also be utilized to store user profile data in a blockchain and intelligently present offers and recommendations to a user based on the user’s automatically gathered history of purchases and preferences acquired from the user profile on the blockchain.

[0155] For a transport to be adequately secured, the transport must be protected from unauthorized physical access as well as unauthorized remote access (e.g., cyber-threats). To prevent unauthorized physical access, a transport is equipped with a secure access system such as a keyless entry in one example. Meanwhile, security protocols are added to a transport’s computers and computer networks to facilitate secure remote communications to and from the transport in one example.

[0156] Electronic Control Units (ECUs) are nodes within a transport that control tasks such as activating the windshield wipers to tasks such as an anti-lock brake system. ECUs are often connected to one another through the transport's central network, which may be referred to as a controller area network (CAN). State-of-the-art features such as autonomous driving are strongly reliant on implementing new, complex ECUs such as advanced driver-assistance systems (ADAS), sensors, and the like. While these new technologies have helped improve the safety and driving experience of a transport, they have also increased the number of externally-communicating units inside of the transport, making them more vulnerable to attack. Below are some examples of protecting the transport from physical intrusion and remote intrusion.

[0157] FIG. 2J illustrates a keyless entry system 290B to prevent unauthorized physical access to a transport 291B, according to example embodiments. Referring to FIG. 2J, a key fob 292B transmits commands to a transport 291B using radio frequency signals in one example. In this example, the key fob 292B includes a transmitter 2921B with an antenna that is capable of sending short-range wireless radio signals. The transport 291B includes a receiver 2911B with an antenna that is capable of receiving the short-range wireless signal transmitted from the transmitter 2921B. The key fob 292B and the transport 291B also include CPUs 2922B and 2913B, respectively, which control the respective devices. Here, a memory of the CPUs 2922B and 2913B (or accessible to the CPUs). Each of the key fob 292B and the transport 291B includes power supplies 2924B and 2915B for powering the respective devices in one example.

[0158] When the user presses a button 293B (or otherwise actuates the fob, etc.) on the key fob 292B, the CPU 2922B wakes up inside the key fob 292B and sends a data stream to the transmitter 2921B, which is output via the antenna. In other embodiments, the user's intent is acknowledged on the key fob 292B via other means, such as via a microphone that accepts audio, a camera that captures images and/or video, or other sensors that are commonly utilized in the art to detect intent from a user including receiving gestures, motion, eye movements, and the like. The data stream may be a 64-bit to 128-bit long signal, which includes one or more of a preamble, a command code, and a rolling code. The signal may be sent at a rate between 2 KHz and 20 KHz, but embodiments are not limited thereto. In response, the receiver 2911B of the transport 291B captures the signal from the transmitter 2921B, demodulates the signal, and sends the data stream to the CPU 2913B, which decodes the signal and sends commands (e.g., lock the door, unlock the door, etc.) to a command module 2912B.

[0159] If the key fob 292B and the transport 291B use a fixed code between them, replay attacks can be performed. In this case, if the attacker can capture/sniff the fixed code during the short-range communication, the attacker could replay this code to gain entry into the transport 291B. To improve security, the key fob and the transport 291B may use a rolling code that changes after each use. Here, the key fob 292B and the transport 291B are synchronized with an initial seed 2923B (e.g., a random number, pseudo-random number, etc.) This is referred to as pairing. The key fob 292B and the transport 291B also include a shared algorithm for modifying the initial seed 2914B each time the button 293B is pressed. The following keypress will take the result of the previous keypress as an input and transform it into the next

number in the sequence. In some cases, the transport 291B may store multiple next codes (e.g., 255 next codes) in case the keypress on the key fob 292B is not detected by the transport 291B. Thus, a number of keypress on the key fob 292B that are unheard by the transport 291B do not prevent the transport from becoming out of sync.

[0160] In addition to rolling codes, the key fob 292B and the transport 291B may employ other methods to make attacks even more difficult. For example, different frequencies may be used for transmitting the rolling codes. As another example, two-way communication between the transmitter 2921B and the receiver 2911B may be used to establish a secure session. As another example, codes may have limited expirations or timeouts. Further, the instant solution as described and depicted with respect to FIG. 2J can be utilized in this and other networks and/or systems, including those that are described and depicted herein.

[0161] FIG. 2K illustrates a controller area network (CAN) 290C within a transport, according to example embodiments. Referring to FIG. 2K, the CAN 290C includes a CAN bus 297C with a high and low terminal and a plurality of electronic control units (ECUs) 291C, 292C, 293C, etc. which are connected to the CAN bus 297C via wired connections. The CAN bus 297C is designed to allow microcontrollers and devices to communicate with each other in an application without a host computer. The CAN bus 297C implements a message-based protocol (i.e., ISO 11898 standards) that allows ECUs 291C-293C to send commands to one another at a root level. Meanwhile, the ECUs 291C-293C represent controllers for controlling electrical systems or subsystems within the transport. Examples of the electrical systems include power steering, anti-lock brakes, air-conditioning, tire pressure monitoring, cruise control, and many other features.

[0162] In this example, the ECU 291C includes a transceiver 2911C and a microcontroller 2912C. The transceiver may be used to transmit and receive messages to and from the CAN bus 297C. For example, the transceiver 2911C may convert the data from the microcontroller 2912C into a format of the CAN bus 297C and also convert data from the CAN bus 297C into a format for the microcontroller 2912C. Meanwhile, the microcontroller 2912C interprets the messages and also decide what messages to send using ECU software installed therein in one example.

[0163] To protect the CAN 290C from cyber threats, various security protocols may be implemented. For example, sub-networks (e.g., sub-networks A and B, etc.) may be used to divide the CAN 290C into smaller sub-CANs and limit an attacker's capabilities to access the transport remotely. In the example of FIG. 2K, ECUs 291C and 292C may be part of a same sub-network, while ECU 293C is part of an independent sub-network. Furthermore, a firewall 294C (or gateway, etc.) may be added to block messages from crossing the CAN bus 297C across sub-networks. If an attacker gains access to one sub-network, the attacker will not have access to the entire network. To make sub-networks even more secure, the most critical ECUs are not placed on the same sub-network, in one example.

[0164] Although not shown in FIG. 2K, other examples of security controls within a CAN include an intrusion detection system (IDS) which can be added to each sub-network and read all data passing to detect malicious messages. If a malicious message is detected, the IDS can notify the automobile user. Other possible security protocols include

encryption/security keys that can be used to obscure messages. As another example, authentication protocols are implemented that enables a message to authenticate itself, in one example.

[0165] In addition to protecting a transport's internal network, transports may also be protected when communicating with external networks such as the Internet. One of the benefits of having a transport connection to a data source such as the Internet is that information from the transport can be sent through a network to remote locations for analysis. Examples of transport information include GPS, onboard diagnostics, tire pressure, and the like. These communication systems are often referred to as telematics because they involve the combination of telecommunications and informatics. Further, the instant solution as described and depicted with respect to FIG. 2K can be utilized in this and other networks and/or systems, including those that are described and depicted herein.

[0166] FIG. 2L illustrates a secure end-to-end transport communication channel according to example embodiments. Referring to FIG. 2L, a telematics network 290D includes a transport 291D and a host server 295D that is disposed at a remote location (e.g., a web server, a cloud platform, a database, etc.) and connected to the transport 291D via a network such as the Internet. In this example, a device 296D associated with the host server 295D may be installed within the network inside the transport 291D. Furthermore, although not shown, the device 296D may connect to other elements of the transport 291D, such as the CAN bus, an onboard diagnostics (OBDII) port, a GPS system, a SIM card, a modem, and the like. The device 296D may collect data from any of these systems and transfer the data to the server 295D via the network.

[0167] Secure management of data begins with the transport 291D. In some embodiments, the device 296D may collect information before, during, and after a trip. The data may include GPS data, travel data, passenger information, diagnostic data, fuel data, speed data, and the like. However, the device 296D may only communicate the collected information back to the host server 295D in response to transport ignition and trip completion. Furthermore, communication may only be initiated by the device 296D and not by the host server 295D. As such, the device 296D will not accept communications initiated by outside sources in one example.

[0168] To perform the communication, the device 296D may establish a secured private network between the device 296D and the host server 295D. Here, the device 296D may include a tamper-proof SIM card that provides secure access to a carrier network 294D via a radio tower 292D. When preparing to transmit data to the host server 295D, the device 296D may establish a one-way secure connection with the host server 295D. The carrier network 294D may communicate with the host server 295D using one or more security protocols. As a non-limiting example, the carrier network 294D may communicate with the host server 295D via a VPN tunnel which allows access through a firewall 293D of the host server 295D. As another example, the carrier network 294D may use data encryption (e.g., AES encryption, etc.) when transmitting data to the host server 295D. In some cases, the system may use multiple security measures such as both a VPN and encryption to further secure the data.

[0169] In addition to communicating with external servers, transports may also communicate with each other. In

particular, transport-to-transport (V2V) communication systems enable transports to communicate with each other, roadside infrastructures (e.g., traffic lights, signs, cameras, parking meters, etc.), and the like, over a wireless network. The wireless network may include one or more of Wi-Fi networks, cellular networks, dedicated short-range communication (DSRC) networks, and the like. Transports may use V2V communication to provide other transports with information about a transport's speed, acceleration, braking, and direction, to name a few. Accordingly, transports can receive insight into the conditions ahead before such conditions become visible, thus greatly reducing collisions. Further, the instant solution as described and depicted with respect to FIG. 2L can be utilized in this and other networks and/or systems, including those that are described and depicted herein.

[0170] FIG. 2M illustrates an example 290E of transports 293E and 292E performing secured V2V communications using security certificates, according to example embodiments. Referring to FIG. 2M, the transports 293E and 292E may communicate via V2V communications over a short-range network, a cellular network, or the like. Before sending messages, the transports 293E and 292E may sign the messages using a respective public key certificate. For example, the transport 293E may sign a V2V message using a public key certificate 294E. Likewise, the transport 292E may sign a V2V message using a public key certificate 295E. The public key certificates 294E and 295E are associated with the transports 293E and 292E, respectively, in one example.

[0171] Upon receiving the communications from each other, the transports may verify the signatures with a certificate authority 291E or the like. For example, the transport 292E may verify with the certificate authority 291E that the public key certificate 294E used by transport 293E to sign a V2V communication is authentic. If the transport 292E successfully verifies the public key certificate 294E, the transport knows that the data is from a legitimate source. Likewise, the transport 293E may verify with the certificate authority 291E that the public key certificate 295E used by the transport 292E to sign a V2V communication is authentic. Further, the instant solution as described and depicted with respect to FIG. 2M can be utilized in this and other networks and/or systems including those that are described and depicted herein.

[0172] FIG. 2N illustrates yet a further diagram 290F depicting an example of a transport interacting with a security processor and a wireless device, according to example embodiments. In some embodiments, the computer 224 shown in FIG. 2B may include security processor 292F as shown in the process 290F of the example of FIG. 2N. In particular, the security processor 292F may perform authorization, authentication, cryptography (e.g., encryption), and the like, for data transmissions that are sent between ECUs and other devices on a CAN bus of a vehicle, and also data messages that are transmitted between different vehicles.

[0173] In the example of FIG. 2N, the security processor 292F may include an authorization module 293F, an authentication module 294F, and a cryptography module 295F. The security processor 292F may be implemented within the transport's computer and may communicate with other transport elements, for example, the ECUs/CAN network 296F, wired and wireless devices 298F such as wireless network interfaces, input ports, and the like. The security

processor **292F** may ensure that data frames (e.g., CAN frames, etc.) that are transmitted internally within a transport (e.g., via the ECUs/CAN network **296F**) are secure. Likewise, the security processor **292F** can ensure that messages transmitted between different transports and devices attached or connected via a wire to the transport's computer are also secured.

[0174] For example, the authorization module **293F** may store passwords, usernames, PIN codes, biometric scans, and the like for different transport users. The authorization module **293F** may determine whether a user (or technician) has permission to access certain settings such as a transport's computer. In some embodiments, the authorization module may communicate with a network interface to download any necessary authorization information from an external server. When a user desires to make changes to the transport settings or modify technical details of the transport via a console or GUI within the transport or via an attached/connected device, the authorization module **293F** may require the user to verify themselves in some way before such settings are changed. For example, the authorization module **293F** may require a username, a password, a PIN code, a biometric scan, a predefined line drawing or gesture, and the like. In response, the authorization module **293F** may determine whether the user has the necessary permissions (access, etc.) being requested.

[0175] The authentication module **294F** may be used to authenticate internal communications between ECUs on the CAN network of the vehicle. As an example, the authentication module **294F** may provide information for authenticating communications between the ECUs. As an example, the authentication module **294F** may transmit a bit signature algorithm to the ECUs of the CAN network. The ECUs may use the bit signature algorithm to insert authentication bits into the CAN fields of the CAN frame. All ECUs on the CAN network typically receive each CAN frame. The bit signature algorithm may dynamically change the position, amount, etc., of authentication bits each time a new CAN frame is generated by one of the ECUs. The authentication module **294F** may also provide a list of ECUs that are exempt (safe list) and that do not need to use the authentication bits. The authentication module **294F** may communicate with a remote server to retrieve updates to the bit signature algorithm and the like.

[0176] The encryption module **295F** may store asymmetric key pairs to be used by the transport to communicate with other external user devices and transports. For example, the encryption module **295F** may provide a private key to be used by the transport to encrypt/decrypt communications, while the corresponding public key may be provided to other user devices and transports to enable the other devices to decrypt/encrypt the communications. The encryption module **295F** may communicate with a remote server to receive new keys, updates to keys, keys of new transports, users, etc., and the like. The encryption module **295F** may also transmit any updates to a local private/public key pair to the remote server.

[0177] FIG. 3A illustrates a flow diagram **300**, according to example embodiments. Referring to FIG. 3A, the flow diagram **300** includes one or more of determining an economical impact and a carbon impact based on a use of a vehicle over a period **302**, determining a benefit received in a future period similar to the period of one or more of altering the use of the vehicle and using another vehicle **304**,

determining a recommendation, based on the benefit **306**, and notifying a device associated with the vehicle, of the recommendation and the benefit **308**.

[0178] FIG. 3B illustrates another flow diagram **320**, according to example embodiments. Referring to FIG. 3B, the flow diagram **320** includes one or more of receiving economical behavior data for the period from the vehicle and comparing the economical behavior data to an economical impact threshold **322**, receiving carbon use behavior data for the period from the vehicle and comparing the carbon use behavior data to a carbon impact threshold **323**, determining one or more uses of the vehicle in the future period that contribute to one or more of the economical impact and the carbon impact, identifying different one or more uses of other vehicles that contribute to a lower economical impact or lower carbon impact, and associating a benefit with one or more of the lower economical impact or lower carbon impact **324**, determining a future carbon impact for the other vehicle in the future period and associating a benefit with a difference between the carbon impact and a future carbon impact for the other vehicle in the future period **325**, identifying one or more uses of the vehicle or the other vehicle for the future period that contributes to the benefit, selecting a use of the vehicle or the other vehicle for the future period that provides a largest contribution to the benefit from the one or more uses, and providing a recommendation to the device based on the selected use **326**, and determining the device is associated with an operating entity for the vehicle, determining a notification including the recommendation and the benefit, and transmitting the notification to the device **327**.

[0179] FIG. 3C illustrates yet another flow diagram **340**, according to example embodiments. Referring to FIG. 3C, the flow diagram includes one or more of receiving a confirmation of an event from one or more elements described or depicted herein, wherein the confirmation comprises a blockchain consensus between peers represented by any of the elements **342** and executing a smart contract to record the confirmation on a blockchain-based on the blockchain consensus **344**.

[0180] FIG. 4 illustrates a machine learning transport network diagram **400**, according to example embodiments. The network **400** includes a transport **402** that interfaces with a machine learning subsystem **406**. The transport includes one or more sensors **404**.

[0181] The machine learning subsystem **406** contains a learning model **408**, which is a mathematical artifact created by a machine learning training system **410** that generates predictions by finding patterns in one or more training data sets. In some embodiments, the machine learning subsystem **406** resides in the transport **402**. In other embodiments, the machine learning subsystem **406** resides outside of the transport **402**.

[0182] The transport **402** sends data from the one or more sensors **404** to the machine learning subsystem **406**. The machine learning subsystem **406** provides the one or more sensor **404** data to the learning model **408**, which returns one or more predictions. The machine learning subsystem **406** sends one or more instructions to the transport **402** based on the predictions from the learning model **408**.

[0183] In a further embodiment, the transport **402** may send the one or more sensor **404** data to the machine learning training system **410**. In yet another example, the machine learning subsystem **406** may send the sensor **404** data to the

machine learning subsystem **410**. One or more of the applications, features, steps, solutions, etc., described and/or depicted herein may utilize the machine learning network **400** as described herein.

[0184] FIG. 5A illustrates an example vehicle configuration **500** for managing database transactions associated with a vehicle, according to example embodiments. Referring to FIG. 5A, as a particular transport/vehicle **525** is engaged in transactions (e.g., vehicle service, dealer transactions, delivery/pickup, transportation services, etc.), the vehicle may receive assets **510** and/or expel/transfer assets **512** according to a transaction(s). A transport processor **526** resides in the vehicle **525** and communication exists between the transport processor **526**, a database **530**, a transport processor **526** and the transaction module **520**. The transaction module **520** may record information, such as assets, parties, credits, service descriptions, date, time, location, results, notifications, unexpected events, etc. Those transactions in the transaction module **520** may be replicated into a database **530**. The database **530** can be one of a SQL database, an RDBMS, a relational database, a non-relational database, a blockchain, a distributed ledger, and may be on board the transport, may be off-board the transport, may be accessed directly and/or through a network, or be accessible to the transport.

[0185] FIG. 5B illustrates an example vehicle configuration **550** for managing database transactions conducted among various vehicles, according to example embodiments. The vehicle **525** may engage with another vehicle **508** to perform various actions such as to share, transfer, acquire service calls, etc. when the vehicle has reached a status where the services need to be shared with another vehicle. For example, the vehicle **508** may be due for a battery charge and/or may have an issue with a tire and may be in route to pick up a package for delivery. A transport processor **528** resides in the vehicle **508** and communication exists between the transport processor **528**, a database **554**, and the transaction module **552**. The vehicle **508** may notify another vehicle **525**, which is in its network and which operates on its blockchain member service. A transport processor **526** resides in the vehicle **525** and communication exists between the transport processor **526**, a database **530**, the transport processor **526** and a transaction module **520**. The vehicle **525** may then receive the information via a wireless communication request to perform the package pickup from the vehicle **508** and/or from a server (not shown). The transactions are logged in the transaction modules **552** and **520** of both vehicles. The credits are transferred from vehicle **508** to vehicle **525** and the record of the transferred service is logged in the database **530/554** assuming that the blockchains are different from one another, or are logged in the same blockchain used by all members. The database **554** can be one of a SQL database, an RDBMS, a relational database, a non-relational database, a blockchain, a distributed ledger, and may be on board the transport, may be off-board the transport, may be accessible directly and/or through a network.

[0186] FIG. 6A illustrates a blockchain architecture configuration **600**, according to example embodiments. Referring to FIG. 6A, the blockchain architecture **600** may include certain blockchain elements, for example, a group of blockchain member nodes **602-606** as part of a blockchain group **610**. In one example embodiment, a permissioned blockchain is not accessible to all parties but only to those

members with permissioned access to the blockchain data. The blockchain nodes participate in a number of activities, such as blockchain entry addition and validation process (consensus). One or more of the blockchain nodes may endorse entries based on an endorsement policy and may provide an ordering service for all blockchain nodes. A blockchain node may initiate a blockchain action (such as an authentication) and seek to write to a blockchain immutable ledger stored in the blockchain, a copy of which may also be stored on the underpinning physical infrastructure.

[0187] The blockchain transactions **620** are stored in memory of computers as the transactions are received and approved by the consensus model dictated by the members' nodes. Approved transactions **626** are stored in current blocks of the blockchain and committed to the blockchain via a committal procedure, which includes performing a hash of the data contents of the transactions in a current block and referencing a previous hash of a previous block. Within the blockchain, one or more smart contracts **630** may exist that define the terms of transaction agreements and actions included in smart contract executable application code **632**, such as registered recipients, vehicle features, requirements, permissions, sensor thresholds, etc. The code may be configured to identify whether requesting entities are registered to receive vehicle services, what service features they are entitled/required to receive given their profile statuses and whether to monitor their actions in subsequent events. For example, when a service event occurs and a user is riding in the vehicle, the sensor data monitoring may be triggered, and a certain parameter, such as a vehicle charge level, may be identified as being above/below a particular threshold for a particular period of time, then the result may be a change to a current status, which requires an alert to be sent to the managing party (i.e., vehicle owner, vehicle operator, server, etc.) so the service can be identified and stored for reference. The vehicle sensor data collected may be based on types of sensor data used to collect information about vehicle's status. The sensor data may also be the basis for the vehicle event data **634**, such as a location(s) to be traveled, an average speed, a top speed, acceleration rates, whether there were any collisions, was the expected route taken, what is the next destination, whether safety measures are in place, whether the vehicle has enough charge/fuel, etc. All such information may be the basis of smart contract terms **630**, which are then stored in a blockchain. For example, sensor thresholds stored in the smart contract can be used as the basis for whether a detected service is necessary and when and where the service should be performed.

[0188] FIG. 6B illustrates a shared ledger configuration, according to example embodiments. Referring to FIG. 6B, the blockchain logic example **640** includes a blockchain application interface **642** as an API or plug-in application that links to the computing device and execution platform for a particular transaction. The blockchain configuration **640** may include one or more applications, which are linked to application programming interfaces (APIs) to access and execute stored program/application code (e.g., smart contract executable code, smart contracts, etc.), which can be created according to a customized configuration sought by participants and can maintain their own state, control their own assets, and receive external information. This can be deployed as an entry and installed, via appending to the distributed ledger, on all blockchain nodes.

[0189] The smart contract application code **644** provides a basis for the blockchain transactions by establishing application code, which when executed causes the transaction terms and conditions to become active. The smart contract **630**, when executed, causes certain approved transactions **626** to be generated, which are then forwarded to the blockchain platform **652**. The platform includes a security/authorization **658**, computing devices, which execute the transaction management **656** and a storage portion **654** as a memory that stores transactions and smart contracts in the blockchain.

[0190] The blockchain platform may include various layers of blockchain data, services (e.g., cryptographic trust services, virtual execution environment, etc.), and underpinning physical computer infrastructure that may be used to receive and store new entries and provide access to auditors, which are seeking to access data entries. The blockchain may expose an interface that provides access to the virtual execution environment necessary to process the program code and engage the physical infrastructure. Cryptographic trust services may be used to verify entries such as asset exchange entries and keep information private.

[0191] The blockchain architecture configuration of FIGS. 6A and 6B may process and execute program/application code via one or more interfaces exposed, and services provided, by the blockchain platform. As a non-limiting example, smart contracts may be created to execute reminders, updates, and/or other notifications subject to the changes, updates, etc. The smart contracts can themselves be used to identify rules associated with authorization and access requirements and usage of the ledger. For example, the information may include a new entry, which may be processed by one or more processing entities (e.g., processors, virtual machines, etc.) included in the blockchain layer. The result may include a decision to reject or approve the new entry based on the criteria defined in the smart contract and/or a consensus of the peers. The physical infrastructure may be utilized to retrieve any of the data or information described herein.

[0192] Within smart contract executable code, a smart contract may be created via a high-level application and programming language, and then written to a block in the blockchain. The smart contract may include executable code that is registered, stored, and/or replicated with a blockchain (e.g., distributed network of blockchain peers). An entry is an execution of the smart contract code, which can be performed in response to conditions associated with the smart contract being satisfied. The executing of the smart contract may trigger a trusted modification(s) to a state of a digital blockchain ledger. The modification(s) to the blockchain ledger caused by the smart contract execution may be automatically replicated throughout the distributed network of blockchain peers through one or more consensus protocols.

[0193] The smart contract may write data to the blockchain in the format of key-value pairs. Furthermore, the smart contract code can read the values stored in a blockchain and use them in application operations. The smart contract code can write the output of various logic operations into the blockchain. The code may be used to create a temporary data structure in a virtual machine or other computing platform. Data written to the blockchain can be public and/or can be encrypted and maintained as private. The temporary data that is used/generated by the smart

contract is held in memory by the supplied execution environment, then deleted once the data needed for the blockchain is identified.

[0194] A smart contract executable code may include the code interpretation of a smart contract, with additional features. As described herein, the smart contract executable code may be program code deployed on a computing network, where it is executed and validated by chain validators together during a consensus process. The smart contract executable code receives a hash and retrieves from the blockchain a hash associated with the data template created by use of a previously stored feature extractor. If the hashes of the hash identifier and the hash created from the stored identifier template data match, then the smart contract executable code sends an authorization key to the requested service. The smart contract executable code may write to the blockchain data associated with the cryptographic details.

[0195] FIG. 6C illustrates a blockchain configuration for storing blockchain transaction data, according to example embodiments. Referring to FIG. 6C, the example configuration **660** provides for the vehicle **662**, the user device **664** and a server **666** sharing information with a distributed ledger (i.e., blockchain) **668**. The server may represent a service provider entity inquiring with a vehicle service provider to share user profile rating information in the event that a known and established user profile is attempting to rent a vehicle with an established rated profile. The server **666** may be receiving and processing data related to a vehicle's service requirements. As the service events occur, such as the vehicle sensor data indicates a need for fuel/charge, a maintenance service, etc., a smart contract may be used to invoke rules, thresholds, sensor information gathering, etc., which may be used to invoke the vehicle service event. The blockchain transaction data **670** is saved for each transaction, such as the access event, the subsequent updates to a vehicle's service status, event updates, etc. The transactions may include the parties, the requirements (e.g., 18 years of age, service eligible candidate, valid driver's license, etc.), compensation levels, the distance traveled during the event, the registered recipients permitted to access the event and host a vehicle service, rights/permissions, sensor data retrieved during the vehicle event operation to log details of the next service event and identify a vehicle's condition status, and thresholds used to make determinations about whether the service event was completed and whether the vehicle's condition status has changed.

[0196] FIG. 6D illustrates blockchain blocks **680** that can be added to a distributed ledger, according to example embodiments, and contents of block structures **682A** to **682n**. Referring to FIG. 6D, clients (not shown) may submit entries to blockchain nodes to enact activity on the blockchain. As an example, clients may be applications that act on behalf of a requester, such as a device, person or entity to propose entries for the blockchain. The plurality of blockchain peers (e.g., blockchain nodes) may maintain a state of the blockchain network and a copy of the distributed ledger. Different types of blockchain nodes/peers may be present in the blockchain network including endorsing peers, which simulate and endorse entries proposed by clients and committing peers which verify endorsements, validate entries, and commit entries to the distributed ledger. In this example, the blockchain nodes may perform the role of endorser node, committer node, or both.

[0197] The instant system includes a blockchain that stores immutable, sequenced records in blocks, and a state database (current world state) maintaining a current state of the blockchain. One distributed ledger may exist per channel and each peer maintains its own copy of the distributed ledger for each channel of which they are a member. The instant blockchain is an entry log, structured as hash-linked blocks where each block contains a sequence of N entries. Blocks may include various components such as those shown in FIG. 6D. The linking of the blocks may be generated by adding a hash of a prior block's header within a block header of a current block. In this way, all entries on the blockchain are sequenced and cryptographically linked together preventing tampering with blockchain data without breaking the hash links. Furthermore, because of the links, the latest block in the blockchain represents every entry that has come before it. The instant blockchain may be stored on a peer file system (local or attached storage), which supports an append-only blockchain workload.

[0198] The current state of the blockchain and the distributed ledger may be stored in the state database. Here, the current state data represents the latest values for all keys ever included in the chain entry log of the blockchain. Smart contract executable code invocations execute entries against the current state in the state database. To make these smart contract executable code interactions extremely efficient, the latest values of all keys are stored in the state database. The state database may include an indexed view into the entry log of the blockchain, it can therefore be regenerated from the chain at any time. The state database may automatically get recovered (or generated if needed) upon peer startup, before entries are accepted.

[0199] Endorsing nodes receive entries from clients and endorse the entry based on simulated results. Endorsing nodes hold smart contracts, which simulate the entry proposals. When an endorsing node endorses an entry, the endorsing nodes creates an entry endorsement, which is a signed response from the endorsing node to the client application indicating the endorsement of the simulated entry. The method of endorsing an entry depends on an endorsement policy that may be specified within smart contract executable code. An example of an endorsement policy is "the majority of endorsing peers must endorse the entry." Different channels may have different endorsement policies. Endorsed entries are forward by the client application to an ordering service.

[0200] The ordering service accepts endorsed entries, orders them into a block, and delivers the blocks to the committing peers. For example, the ordering service may initiate a new block when a threshold of entries has been reached, a timer times out, or another condition. In this example, blockchain node is a committing peer that has received a data block 682A for storage on the blockchain. The ordering service may be made up of a cluster of orderers. The ordering service does not process entries, smart contracts, or maintain the shared ledger. Rather, the ordering service may accept the endorsed entries and specifies the order in which those entries are committed to the distributed ledger. The architecture of the blockchain network may be designed such that the specific implementation of 'ordering' (e.g., Solo, Kafka, BFT, etc.) becomes a pluggable component.

[0201] Entries are written to the distributed ledger in a consistent order. The order of entries is established to ensure

that the updates to the state database are valid when they are committed to the network. Unlike a cryptocurrency blockchain system (e.g., Bitcoin, etc.) where ordering occurs through the solving of a cryptographic puzzle, or mining, in this example the parties of the distributed ledger may choose the ordering mechanism that best suits that network.

[0202] Referring to FIG. 6D, a block 682A (also referred to as a data block) that is stored on the blockchain and/or the distributed ledger may include multiple data segments such as a block header 684A to 684n, transaction-specific data 686A to 686n, and block metadata 688A to 688n. It should be appreciated that the various depicted blocks and their contents, such as block 682A and its contents are merely for purposes of an example and are not meant to limit the scope of the example embodiments. In some cases, both the block header 684A and the block metadata 688A may be smaller than the transaction-specific data 686A, which stores entry data; however, this is not a requirement. The block 682A may store transactional information of N entries (e.g., 100, 500, 1000, 2000, 3000, etc.) within the block data 690A to 690n. The block 682A may also include a link to a previous block (e.g., on the blockchain) within the block header 684A. In particular, the block header 684A may include a hash of a previous block's header. The block header 684A may also include a unique block number, a hash of the block data 690A of the current block 682A, and the like. The block number of the block 682A may be unique and assigned in an incremental/sequential order starting from zero. The first block in the blockchain may be referred to as a genesis block, which includes information about the blockchain, its members, the data stored therein, etc.

[0203] The block data 690A may store entry information of each entry that is recorded within the block. For example, the entry data may include one or more of a type of the entry, a version, a timestamp, a channel ID of the distributed ledger, an entry ID, an epoch, a payload visibility, a smart contract executable code path (deploy tx), a smart contract executable code name, a smart contract executable code version, input (smart contract executable code and functions), a client (creator) identify such as a public key and certificate, a signature of the client, identities of endorsers, endorser signatures, a proposal hash, smart contract executable code events, response status, namespace, a read set (list of key and version read by the entry, etc.), a write set (list of key and value, etc.), a start key, an end key, a list of keys, a Merkel tree query summary, and the like. The entry data may be stored for each of the N entries.

[0204] In some embodiments, the block data 690A may also store transaction-specific data 686A, which adds additional information to the hash-linked chain of blocks in the blockchain. Accordingly, the data 686A can be stored in an immutable log of blocks on the distributed ledger. Some of the benefits of storing such data 686A are reflected in the various embodiments disclosed and depicted herein. The block metadata 688A may store multiple fields of metadata (e.g., as a byte array, etc.). Metadata fields may include signature on block creation, a reference to a last configuration block, an entry filter identifying valid and invalid entries within the block, last offset persisted of an ordering service that ordered the block, and the like. The signature, the last configuration block, and the orderer metadata may be added by the ordering service. Meanwhile, a committer of the block (such as a blockchain node) may add validity/invalidity information based on an endorsement policy, verifi-

cation of read/write sets, and the like. The entry filter may include a byte array of a size equal to the number of entries in the block data **610A** and a validation code identifying whether an entry was valid/invalid.

[0205] The other blocks **682B** to **682_n** in the blockchain also have headers, files, and values. However, unlike the first block **682A**, each of the headers **684A** to **684_n** in the other blocks includes the hash value of an immediately preceding block. The hash value of the immediately preceding block may be just the hash of the header of the previous block or may be the hash value of the entire previous block. By including the hash value of a preceding block in each of the remaining blocks, a trace can be performed from the Nth block back to the genesis block (and the associated original file) on a block-by-block basis, as indicated by arrows **692**, to establish an auditable and immutable chain-of-custody.

[0206] The above embodiments may be implemented in hardware, in a computer program executed by a processor, in firmware, or in a combination of the above. A computer program may be embodied on a computer readable medium, such as a storage medium. For example, a computer program may reside in random access memory (“RAM”), flash memory, read-only memory (“ROM”), erasable programmable read-only memory (“EPROM”), electrically erasable programmable read-only memory (“EEPROM”), registers, hard disk, a removable disk, a compact disk read-only memory (“CD-ROM”), or any other form of storage medium known in the art.

[0207] An exemplary storage medium may be coupled to the processor such that the processor may read information from, and write information to, the storage medium. In the alternative, the storage medium may be integral to the processor. The processor and the storage medium may reside in an application-specific integrated circuit (“ASIC”). In the alternative, the processor and the storage medium may reside as discrete components. For example, FIG. 7 illustrates an example computer system architecture **700**, which may represent or be integrated in any of the above-described components, etc.

[0208] FIG. 7 is not intended to suggest any limitation as to the scope of use or functionality of embodiments of the application described herein. Regardless, the computing node **700** is capable of being implemented and/or performing any of the functionality set forth hereinabove.

[0209] In computing node **700** there is a computer system/server **702**, which is operational with numerous other general purpose or special purpose computing system environments or configurations. Examples of well-known computing systems, environments, and/or configurations that may be suitable for use with computer system/server **702** include, but are not limited to, personal computer systems, server computer systems, thin clients, thick clients, hand-held or laptop devices, multiprocessor systems, microprocessor-based systems, set-top boxes, programmable consumer electronics, network PCs, minicomputer systems, mainframe computer systems, and distributed cloud computing environments that include any of the above systems or devices, and the like.

[0210] Computer system/server **702** may be described in the general context of computer system-executable instructions, such as program modules, being executed by a computer system. Generally, program modules may include routines, programs, objects, components, logic, data structures, and so on that perform particular tasks or implement

particular abstract data types. Computer system/server **702** may be practiced in distributed cloud computing environments where tasks are performed by remote processing devices that are linked through a communications network. In a distributed cloud computing environment, program modules may be located in both local and remote computer system storage media including memory storage devices.

[0211] As shown in FIG. 7, computer system/server **702** in cloud computing node **700** is shown in the form of a general-purpose computing device. The components of computer system/server **702** may include, but are not limited to, one or more processors or processing units **704**, a system memory **706**, and a bus that couples various system components including system memory **706** to processor **704**.

[0212] The bus represents one or more of any of several types of bus structures, including a memory bus or memory controller, a peripheral bus, an accelerated graphics port, and a processor or local bus using any of a variety of bus architectures. By way of example, and not limitation, such architectures include Industry Standard Architecture (ISA) bus, Micro Channel Architecture (MCA) bus, Enhanced ISA (EISA) bus, Video Electronics Standards Association (VESA) local bus, and Peripheral Component Interconnects (PCI) bus.

[0213] Computer system/server **702** typically includes a variety of computer system readable media. Such media may be any available media that is accessible by computer system/server **702**, and it includes both volatile and non-volatile media, removable and non-removable media. System memory **706**, in one example, implements the flow diagrams of the other figures. The system memory **706** can include computer system readable media in the form of volatile memory, such as random-access memory (RAM) **708** and/or cache memory **710**. Computer system/server **702** may further include other removable/non-removable, volatile/non-volatile computer system storage media. By way of example only, memory **706** can be provided for reading from and writing to a non-removable, non-volatile magnetic media (not shown and typically called a “hard drive”). Although not shown, a magnetic disk drive for reading from and writing to a removable, non-volatile magnetic disk (e.g., a “floppy disk”), and an optical disk drive for reading from or writing to a removable, non-volatile optical disk such as a CD-ROM, DVD-ROM or other optical media can be provided. In such instances, each can be connected to the bus by one or more data media interfaces. As will be further depicted and described below, memory **706** may include at least one program product having a set (e.g., at least one) of program modules that are configured to carry out the functions of various embodiments of the application.

[0214] Program/utility, having a set (at least one) of program modules, may be stored in memory **706** by way of example, and not limitation, as well as an operating system, one or more application programs, other program modules, and program data. Each of the operating system, one or more application programs, other program modules, and program data or some combination thereof, may include an implementation of a networking environment. Program modules generally carry out the functions and/or methodologies of various embodiments of the application as described herein.

[0215] As will be appreciated by one skilled in the art, aspects of the present application may be embodied as a system, method, or computer program product. Accordingly, aspects of the present application may take the form of an

entirely hardware embodiment, an entirely software embodiment (including firmware, resident software, micro-code, etc.) or an embodiment combining software and hardware aspects that may all generally be referred to herein as a “circuit,” “module” or “system.” Furthermore, aspects of the present application may take the form of a computer program product embodied in one or more computer readable medium(s) having computer readable program code embodied thereon.

[0216] Computer system/server **702** may also communicate with one or more external devices via an I/O device **712** (such as an I/O adapter), which may include a keyboard, a pointing device, a display, a voice recognition module, etc., one or more devices that enable a user to interact with computer system/server **702**, and/or any devices (e.g., network card, modem, etc.) that enable computer system/server **702** to communicate with one or more other computing devices. Such communication can occur via I/O interfaces of the device **712**. Still yet, computer system/server **702** can communicate with one or more networks such as a local area network (LAN), a general wide area network (WAN), and/or a public network (e.g., the Internet) via a network adapter. As depicted, device **712** communicates with the other components of computer system/server **702** via a bus. It should be understood that although not shown, other hardware and/or software components could be used in conjunction with computer system/server **702**. Examples, include, but are not limited to: microcode, device drivers, redundant processing units, external disk drive arrays, RAID systems, tape drives, and data archival storage systems, etc.

[0217] Although an exemplary embodiment of at least one of a system, method, and non-transitory computer readable medium has been illustrated in the accompanied drawings and described in the foregoing detailed description, it will be understood that the application is not limited to the embodiments disclosed, but is capable of numerous rearrangements, modifications, and substitutions as set forth and defined by the following claims. For example, the capabilities of the system of the various figures can be performed by one or more of the modules or components described herein or in a distributed architecture and may include a transmitter, receiver or pair of both. For example, all or part of the functionality performed by the individual modules, may be performed by one or more of these modules. Further, the functionality described herein may be performed at various times and in relation to various events, internal or external to the modules or components. Also, the information sent between various modules can be sent between the modules via at least one of: a data network, the Internet, a voice network, an Internet Protocol network, a wireless device, a wired device and/or via plurality of protocols. Also, the messages sent or received by any of the modules may be sent or received directly and/or via one or more of the other modules.

[0218] One skilled in the art will appreciate that a “system” could be embodied as a personal computer, a server, a console, a personal digital assistant (PDA), a cell phone, a tablet computing device, a smartphone or any other suitable computing device, or combination of devices. Presenting the above-described functions as being performed by a “system” is not intended to limit the scope of the present application in any way but is intended to provide one example of many embodiments. Indeed, methods, systems and apparatuses

disclosed herein may be implemented in localized and distributed forms consistent with computing technology.

[0219] It should be noted that some of the system features described in this specification have been presented as modules to more particularly emphasize their implementation independence. For example, a module may be implemented as a hardware circuit comprising custom very-large-scale integration (VLSI) circuits or gate arrays, off-the-shelf semiconductors such as logic chips, transistors, or other discrete components. A module may also be implemented in programmable hardware devices such as field-programmable gate arrays, programmable array logic, programmable logic devices, graphics processing units, or the like.

[0220] A module may also be at least partially implemented in software for execution by various types of processors. An identified unit of executable code may, for instance, comprise one or more physical or logical blocks of computer instructions that may, for instance, be organized as an object, procedure, or function. Nevertheless, the executables of an identified module need not be physically located together but may comprise disparate instructions stored in different locations that, when joined logically together, comprise the module and achieve the stated purpose for the module. Further, modules may be stored on a computer-readable medium, which may be, for instance, a hard disk drive, flash device, random access memory (RAM), tape, or any other such medium used to store data.

[0221] Indeed, a module of executable code could be a single instruction, or many instructions, and may even be distributed over several different code segments, among different programs, and across several memory devices. Similarly, operational data may be identified and illustrated herein within modules and may be embodied in any suitable form and organized within any suitable type of data structure. The operational data may be collected as a single data set or may be distributed over different locations, including over different storage devices, and may exist, at least partially, merely as electronic signals on a system or network.

[0222] It will be readily understood that the components of the application, as generally described and illustrated in the figures herein, may be arranged and designed in a wide variety of different configurations. Thus, the detailed description of the embodiments is not intended to limit the scope of the application as claimed but is merely representative of selected embodiments of the application.

[0223] One having ordinary skill in the art will readily understand that the above may be practiced with steps in a different order and/or with hardware elements in configurations that are different from those which are disclosed. Therefore, although the application has been described based upon these preferred embodiments, it would be apparent to those of skill in the art that certain modifications, variations, and alternative constructions would be apparent.

[0224] While preferred embodiments of the present application have been described, it is to be understood that the embodiments described are illustrative only and the scope of the application is to be defined solely by the appended claims when considered with a full range of equivalents and modifications (e.g., protocols, hardware devices, software platforms etc.) thereto.

What is claimed is:

1. A method, comprising:

determining an economical impact and a carbon impact based on a use of a vehicle over a period;

determining a benefit received in a future period similar to the period of one or more of:
 altering the use of the vehicle; and
 using another vehicle, wherein the other vehicle uses less carbon;
 determining a recommendation, based on the benefit; and
 notifying a device associated with the vehicle, of the recommendation and the benefit.

2. The method of claim 1, wherein determining the economical impact based on the use of the vehicle over the period comprises:
 receiving economical behavior data for the period from the vehicle; and
 comparing the economical behavior data to an economical impact threshold,
 wherein the economical impact corresponds to a difference between the economical behavior data and the economical impact threshold.

3. The method of claim 1, wherein determining the carbon impact based on the use of the vehicle over the period comprises:
 receiving carbon use behavior data for the period from the vehicle; and
 comparing the carbon use behavior data to a carbon impact threshold,
 wherein the carbon impact corresponds to a difference between the carbon use behavior data and the carbon impact threshold.

4. The method of claim 1, wherein determining the benefit received in the future period of altering the use of the vehicle comprises:
 determining one or more uses of the vehicle in the future period that contribute to one or more of the economical impact and the carbon impact;
 identifying different one or more uses of other vehicles that contribute to a lower economical impact or lower carbon impact; and
 associating a benefit with one or more of the lower economical impact or lower carbon impact.

5. The method of claim 1, wherein determining the benefit received in the future period of using another vehicle comprises:
 determining a future carbon impact for the other vehicle in the future period; and
 associating a benefit with a difference between the carbon impact and a future carbon impact for the other vehicle in the future period.

6. The method of claim 1, wherein determining the recommendation comprises:
 identifying one or more uses of the vehicle or the other vehicle for the future period that contributes to the benefit;
 selecting a use of the vehicle or the other vehicle for the future period that provides a largest contribution to the benefit from the one or more uses; and
 providing a recommendation to the device based on the selected use.

7. The method of claim 1, wherein notifying the device associated with the vehicle of the recommendation and the benefit comprises:
 determining the device is associated with an operating entity for the vehicle;

determining a notification including the recommendation and the benefit; and
 transmitting the notification to the device.

8. A system, comprising:
 a processor; and
 a memory, coupled to the processor, comprising instructions that when executed by the processor are configured to:
 determine an economical impact and a carbon impact based on a use of a vehicle over a period;
 determine a benefit received in a future period similar to the period of one or more of:
 alter the use of the vehicle; and
 use another vehicle, wherein the other vehicle uses less carbon;
 determine a recommendation, based on the benefit; and
 notify a device associated with the vehicle, of the recommendation and the benefit.

9. The system of claim 8, wherein the processor determines the economical impact based on the use of the vehicle over the period comprises the instructions are configured to:
 receive economical behavior data for the period from the vehicle; and
 compare the economical behavior data to an economical impact threshold,
 wherein the economical impact corresponds to a difference between the economical behavior data and the economical impact threshold.

10. The system of claim 8, wherein the processor determines the carbon impact based on the use of the vehicle over the period comprises the instructions are configured to:
 receive carbon use behavior data for the period from the vehicle; and
 compare the carbon use behavior data to a carbon impact threshold,
 wherein the carbon impact corresponds to a difference between the carbon use behavior data and the carbon impact threshold.

11. The system of claim 8, wherein the processor determines the benefit received in the future period of altered use of the vehicle comprises the instructions are configured to:
 determine one or more uses of the vehicle in the future period that contribute to one or more of the economical impact and the carbon impact;
 identify different one or more uses of other vehicles that contribute to a lower economical impact or lower carbon impact; and
 associate a benefit with one or more of the lower economical impact or lower carbon impact.

12. The system of claim 8, wherein the processor determines the benefit received in the future period of another vehicle usage comprises the instructions are configured to:
 determine a future carbon impact for the other vehicle in the future period; and
 associate a benefit with a difference between the carbon impact and a future carbon impact for the other vehicle in the future period.

13. The system of claim 8, wherein the processor determines the recommendation comprises the instructions are configured to:
 identify one or more uses of the vehicle or the other vehicle for the future period that contributes to the benefit;

select a use of the vehicle or the other vehicle for the future period that provides a largest contribution to the benefit from the one or more uses; and
provide a recommendation to the device based on the selected use.

14. The system of claim **8**, wherein the processor notifies the device associated with the vehicle of the recommendation and the benefit comprises the instructions are configured to:

- determine the device is associated with an entity that operates the vehicle;
- determine a notification that includes the recommendation and the benefit; and
- transmit the notification to the device.

15. A computer readable storage medium comprising instructions, that when read by a processor, cause the processor to perform:

- determining an economical impact and a carbon impact based on a use of a vehicle over a period;
- determining a benefit received in a future period similar to the period of one or more of:
 - altering the use of the vehicle; and
 - using another vehicle, wherein the other vehicle uses less carbon;
- determining a recommendation, based on the benefit; and
- notifying a device associated with the vehicle, of the recommendation and the benefit.

16. The computer readable storage medium of claim **15**, wherein determining the economical impact based on the use of the vehicle over the period comprises the instructions cause the processor to perform:

- receiving economical behavior data for the period from the vehicle; and
- comparing the economical behavior data to an economical impact threshold,
- wherein the economical impact corresponds to a difference between the economical behavior data and the economical impact threshold.

17. The computer readable storage medium of claim **15**, wherein determining the carbon impact based on the use of the vehicle over the period comprises the instructions cause the processor to perform:

- receiving carbon use behavior data for the period from the vehicle; and

- comparing the carbon use behavior data to a carbon impact threshold,

- wherein the carbon impact corresponds to a difference between the carbon use behavior data and the carbon impact threshold.

18. The computer readable storage medium of claim **15**, wherein determining the benefit received in the future period of altering the use of the vehicle comprises the instructions cause the processor to perform:

- determining one or more uses of the vehicle in the future period that contribute to one or more of the economical impact and the carbon impact;

- identifying different one or more uses of other vehicles that contribute to a lower economical impact or lower carbon impact; and

- associating a benefit with one or more of the lower economical impact or lower carbon impact.

19. The computer readable storage medium of claim **15**, wherein determining the benefit received in the future period of using another vehicle comprises the instructions cause the processor to perform:

- determining a future carbon impact for the other vehicle in the future period; and

- associating a benefit with a difference between the carbon impact and a future carbon impact for the other vehicle in the future period.

20. The computer readable storage medium of claim **15**, wherein determining the recommendation comprises the instructions cause the processor to perform:

- identifying one or more uses of the vehicle or the other vehicle for the future period that contributes to the benefit;

- selecting a use of the vehicle or the other vehicle for the future period that provides a largest contribution to the benefit from the one or more uses; and

- providing a recommendation to the device based on the selected use.

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